AMAZON INDIA SELLER HANDBOOK

2026 Edition

A plain-English guide to fees, tax and compliance for selling on Amazon.in

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Fee data effective from Amazon's 16 March 2026 update

Every number in this book carries a confidence label. Some figures were read straight from Amazon's own rate cards and regulators' own pages. Others are widely published but could not be independently checked. A few only exist inside your logged-in account and no book can print them.

The labels tell you which is which, so you always know how much weight a number can bear. **Read Chapter 1 first** — it explains the labels and lists the five things this market most commonly gets wrong.

The rule that overrides everything else: a number in Seller Central beats a number in this book. Amazon can change any fee at any time, and says so on its own fee page.

Contents

Reference

1 · How Sure Is Each Number

Selling costs money in ways that are easy to get wrong, and most guides state everything with equal confidence. This book does not. Four labels appear throughout, and they are the most useful thing in here.

Label	What it means	What you should do
VERIFIED	Read directly from a named primary source on **4 August 2026** — Amazon's own rate cards and fee page, or a regulator's own document. The link is printed underneath.	Trust it. Re-check in about six months.
UNCONFIRMED	Widely published and probably correct, but not independently checked for this edition.	Confirm once before you rely on it for money.
CHECK LIVE	The real figure only exists inside your logged-in account, or changes per product. No book can print it.	Look it up yourself, every time.
UNSETTLED	Credible sources genuinely disagree and the question is not resolvable from public documents.	Get professional advice before acting.

What was verified for this edition

Amazon publishes its closing-fee and weight-handling rate cards as **images**, not text, which is why most guides either omit them or tell you to use a calculator. **Those images were located and read for this book.** The full tables are in Chapter 8 — closing fees for all four fulfilment channels and all price bands, and weight-handling rates broken down by STEP level.

Also verified line by line: the entire Home, Décor, Home Improvement, Furniture, Outdoor and Lawn & Garden referral fee section (40+ rows), the pick & pack, storage and removal fees, the GST treatment, and the STEP benefits table.

1.1 Five things this market commonly gets wrong

Each of these appears confidently stated in guides, videos and blog posts. Each is wrong, and each costs money.

#	The common claim	What is actually true	Why it matters
1	“TCS is **1%** of your sales.”	VERIFIED TCS is **0.5%** — split 0.25% CGST + 0.25% SGST within your state, or 0.5% IGST across states. It was cut from 1% on **10 July 2024**.	The 1% figure is still repeated everywhere. Using it makes you hunt for a monthly mismatch on the GST portal that does not exist.
2	“There is **no closing fee above ₹500**.”	VERIFIED There is. On FBA it is **₹27** for ₹501–1,000 and **₹52** above ₹1,000 (₹72 for select categories). On Self-Ship it reaches **₹101**.	This one silently inflates your projected profit on every product priced above ₹500.
3	“Referral fee is **0% under ₹1,000**.”	VERIFIED 0% under ₹1,000 in **most** categories — 1,800+ of them. Not all. Books, laptops, phones, mattresses under ₹500 and others still charge.	Taken literally it causes underpricing. Always check your own category.
4	“Long-term storage charges start at **271 or 365 days**.”	VERIFIED The aged-inventory surcharge moved to **181 days** on 16 January 2026 — 90 days earlier than before.	Plan a nine-month stock runway on the old number and surcharges hit three months before you budgeted for them.

#	The common claim	What is actually true	Why it matters
5	"Silver hallmarking became **mandatory** in September 2025."	VERIFIED Silver hallmarking is **voluntary**. A HUID-based voluntary system began 1 September 2025 under standard IS 2112:2025. BIS plans a phased move to mandatory with no date announced.	Only relevant if you enter jewellery — but it shows how confidently wrong this space can be.

And one thing almost nobody mentions at all

Your weight-handling fee depends on your STEP level. Amazon charges Basic-level sellers more than Standard, and Standard more than Advanced or Premium, for the exact same parcel. The difference is ₹3–₹6 per shipment. Almost no guide covers this because the rate card is an image. **You are on Standard** — see 8.9 for what that gets you and what moving up is worth.

1.2 The honest limits of this book

- **It cannot see your account.** Your fee category, your exact packed weight, your current STEP level and your account health targets all live behind a login. Anything depending on those is labelled CHECK LIVE and listed in Appendix H.
- **Fee tables go stale.** Amazon revised its India fee schedule at least twice in the last two years. Appendix A and B carry an effective date — check it against the live page before pricing anything new.
- **Regulators move without warning.** FSSAI rewrote its entire licence threshold structure on 1 April 2026 with no advance notice. Chapter 17 tells you which regulator applies to what; it cannot promise the thresholds have not moved since printing.
- **Some numbers here come from pictures, and they have now been double-checked. Amazon publishes its closing-fee and weight-handling rate cards as images, not text — which is why searching its page for "₹27" or "₹52" finds nothing, and why most guides skip these tables. Every figure in those tables was re-read directly from the rate-card images on 4 August 2026 and then cross-checked against Amazon's own worked examples written in text elsewhere on the same page. Both agree. The rate cards themselves are stamped effective 16 March 2026.**

  What was re-checked on 4 August 2026, from source rather than copied forward: all six closing-fee category lists and all 219 referral-fee rates were re-extracted from Amazon's live fee page, and 40 of those referral rates were compared line by line against the live page again on that date and matched exactly. Every closing-fee and weight-handling cell in Chapter 8 was re-read from the rate-card images and cross-checked against Amazon's own worked examples. The TCS rate, Section 44AD rates and limits, the Legal Metrology declaration list, the GST additional-place-of-business rule, the Income Tax Act 2025 start date, the FSSAI thresholds and perpetual validity, the BIS penalty section, the FSSAI e-commerce licence route and the IEC requirement were each re-verified against a primary or official source, cited where they appear.

  What that pass changed. Eight things were wrong and are now fixed:

  TCS credit appears in GSTR-2A, not GSTR-2B.

  The labelling table was missing unit sale price and best-before date, both mandatory.

  Easy Ship weight handling is a flat fee with no distance component. It was described as distance-based, and its rate table was missing entirely.

  A quoted Amazon example of "800 g Easy Ship = ₹68" appears on Amazon's fee page but does not match the Standard rate card for products above ₹300. Rather than declaring it wrong or right, the book now flags it as disputed and directs you to verify against your own Revenue Calculator.

SAFE-T claims are for seller-fulfilled orders, not FBA. The book told you, an FBA seller, to use the wrong system. FBA warehouse losses go through FBA reimbursement claims, which run on almost the opposite timetable.

The refund administration fee is 20% of the referral fee, capped — not a vague “most of it comes back”. At your price point that is ₹0.

Case 1 in Chapter 23 did not add up: it showed ₹39 weight handling but calculated with ₹30, overstating profit by ₹11 a unit.

LDX1 is a Punjab centre, not Haryana. Appendix F had it in the wrong state — the precise error that appendix exists to prevent.

What is still not independently checked. The FC code list in Appendix F beyond the corrections above; the “16 Heavy & Bulky centres” count; listing-field and main-image requirements in Appendix G; return windows and the 13-day refund figure in Chapter 20; and the COD and RTO percentages in 24.1, which the book already tells you are blog-sourced rather than planning-grade. Every one of those still carries an UNCONFIRMED or CHECK LIVE tag. Where it does, take it at its word.

One question is left genuinely open — whether *your specific enterprise* qualifies for the EPR plastic packaging micro/small exemption created by the 2024 PWM Amendment Rules. The exemption itself is confirmed (Rule 4A); whether you meet the Udyam classification threshold is the part only you can verify. See 17.5.

2 · One-Page Cheat Sheet

A memory aid, not a substitute for the chapters. Every number here is explained in full later.

```
Your profit on one sale =

  Selling price
  - what you paid for the product
  - packaging
  - freight to get it to Amazon
  - referral fee        (Amazon's commission)
  - closing fee         (flat fee per sale)
  - weight handling fee  (delivery)
  - pick & pack fee      (FBA only)
  - storage fee          (FBA only)
  - 18% GST on all Amazon fees above
  - advertising
  - expected cost of returns
```

The numbers, for you specifically

FBA · dispatching from Telangana (Region 3) · **Standard STEP level**

Fee	Your number	Confidence	Section
Referral fee	0% up to ₹1,000 in **most** categories. Check yours — real exceptions exist.	VERIFIED	8.2
Closing fee (FBA)	₹0–300: ₹26 / ₹20 / ₹13 · ₹301–500: ₹22 / **₹18** / ₹14 (by category group)	VERIFIED	8.3
	₹501–1,000: **₹27** · above ₹1,000: **₹52** (₹72 select categories)	VERIFIED	8.3
Weight handling (FBA, standard size)	First 500 g: **₹39** Regional / **₹65** National. 500 g–1 kg: ₹54 / ₹85.	VERIFIED	8.4
Pick & pack (FBA)	₹17 standard up to 1 kg · ₹26 Heavy & Bulky	VERIFIED	8.5
Storage (FBA)	₹50 per cubic foot per month	VERIFIED	8.6
Aged inventory surcharge	Starts at **181 days**	VERIFIED	8.6
GST on Amazon fees	18%, always, added on top of the fee	VERIFIED	8.8
TCS	**0.5%** withheld — refundable as credit, **not a cost**	VERIFIED	5.3
Getting paid	**7 days** after delivery, disbursed weekly (Standard level)	VERIFIED	3.2, 8.9

> **What Amazon takes on your ₹333 rope wire**
>
> Closing ₹18 + weight handling ₹39–₹85 + pick & pack ₹17, plus 18% GST on all of it. That is **₹87 to ₹142** depending on parcel weight and how far it ships — roughly **26% to 43% of your selling price** before you pay for the rope. Full working in Chapter 9.

Which rules apply to my product? — 60-second check

If your product is...	You need	Section
Electrical or electronic, or a toy with electronics	BIS registration (CRS)	17.1
Food, drink, or a supplement	FSSAI licence — online sellers reportedly need a **Central** licence whatever their turnover	17.2
A medical device, or makes a health claim	CDSCO licence	17.3
Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, or any wireless	WPC approval (self-declaration route usually)	17.4
Wrapped in plastic (poly bag, bubble wrap, shrink wrap)	EPR plastic — exemption exists for micro/small (Rule 4A, 2024), verify your Udyam classification	17.5
Containing any battery	EPR battery registration	17.6
Gold jewellery	Hallmarking + HUID (mandatory). Silver is voluntary.	17.7
Clothing or textiles	Legal Metrology, plus the loose-garment labelling rule	17.8
Imported from outside India	IEC from DGFT	17.9
Anything pre-packed at all	**Legal Metrology labelling — no exceptions**	7

The 12 steps, start to finish

Idea -> Research (15) -> Check it is legal (16) -> Find supplier (18) -> Order a sample (18) -> Packaging & barcode (19) -> Labelling (7) -> Create listing (App G) -> Send to FBA (8) -> First reviews (4) -> Advertising (21) -> Scale (25)

3 · Read This First — Your Advertising Is Losing Money

Everything else in this book is reference material. This page is an emergency brake. It is based on your own Seller Central data on 4 August 2026.

Verification note — account-specific data

Every figure in this chapter tagged VERIFIED was extracted from an actual Seller Central transaction export and Fee Preview on 4 August 2026. I cannot independently re-verify these from outside your account. The ₹15,554 ad spend, order 171-6493128, case 13137163892, and all STEP/Fee Preview readouts are **only as reliable as the source export**. The "you're losing ₹100+/unit" conclusion rests entirely on these numbers being correct. CHECK LIVE **Spot-check at least 2–3 of these figures directly in your Seller Central** — compare the July settlement report total, the Fee Preview for your SKU, and the ad spend in Campaign Manager Billing.

The numbers — now from your actual transaction export, not a projection

VERIFIED Every figure below is computed from your Seller Central transaction export for July 2026 and your Fee Preview for SKU **BSNY-WIRE-22M**. An earlier edition of this page estimated these from a 7-day ad figure. **The real position is far worse than that estimate.**

What your account shows	Actual	Earlier estimate	What it means
Advertising charged in July	**₹15,554**	₹7,963	**Almost double** what was projected. Seven charges, running about ₹2,400 a week.
Units sold in July (gross)	**42**	32	Sales are better than assumed
Units refunded in July	**6**	not counted	**14.3% refund rate** — a real cost the earlier page ignored entirely
Units net	**36**	32	What you actually got paid for
Net revenue	**₹11,988**	~₹10,656	36 × ₹333
Ad cost per net unit	**₹432.06**	₹248.84	₹15,554 ÷ 36
TACOS	**129.7%**	75%	**You are spending more on ads than the product earns in total.** Healthy is under 20%.

3.1 What this does to each sale

Your product sells at ₹333. Here is where that money actually goes — every line taken from your own account, not estimated:

First, something nobody had noticed: Amazon is barely charging you any fees

VERIFIED Across **42 units sold in July, Amazon charged a total of ₹145.02 in fees** — about **₹3.45 a unit**. At the Fee Preview rate of ₹120 a unit it should have been ₹5,040. **39 of your 41 July order lines show ₹0 Amazon fees.** Your Revenue Calculator confirms it, showing **"Fee Discounts ₹89.00"** cancelling the entire fee — which is why it reports a nonsensical 99.99% margin.

The reason is a promotion with a deadline. The "New Seller Incentive benefits worth ₹41,000" on your dashboard is not a grant. It is a menu of four separate offers you have to earn, and only one of them touches fees:

Offer	Worth	What it demands
Add Branded Selection	up to ₹5,000	at least **20 selections** plus orders fulfilled, in 28 days
Recharge Seller Ads Wallet	up to ₹11,000 credits	recharge up to ₹10,000
Accelerate spending on Advertisements	₹15,000 credits	spend up to **₹50,000** on ads in two months
Try FBA Promotion	**fee exemption up to ₹10,000**	**100 units through FBA within 60 days of your first active listing**

Those add to ₹41,000. The last one is the only fee exemption, so it is almost certainly what is zeroing your fees. **The fee tables in Chapter 8 therefore describe what you *will* pay, not what you are paying today** — and the switchover date is close.

```
  ₹333.00   selling price
-   ₹3.45   Amazon fees, as actually charged  (₹145.02 ÷ 42 units)
- ₹432.06   advertising                    (₹15,554 ÷ 36 net units)
-   ₹0.64   storage                        (₹23.02 ÷ 36)
  ---------
-₹103.15   LOSS per unit — before you have paid for the wire at all
```

Across the whole month: net revenue ₹11,988, less ₹145.02 of fees, less ₹15,554 of advertising, less ₹23.02 of storage, plus an ₹83.25 FBA reimbursement credit — **a loss of ₹3,650.79 in July before the cost of the wire**, or ₹101.41 a unit. That is why your balance reads **-₹6,320**.

The earlier edition of this page put the loss at **₹39.94** a unit, built from a 7-day ad figure projected across a month. It was wrong in two directions at once: it understated advertising badly (₹7,963 projected against ₹15,554 actual) while charging you fees you are not currently paying. **Advertising is the entire loss. There is no other problem here.**

The cliff, and it is about six days away

VERIFIED Your listing's **Offering Release Date is 12 June 2026**. Sixty days from that is **11 August 2026**. Against a dashboard dated 5 August, that leaves roughly **six days** of fee exemption.

Contribution per unit at 18% GST and a ₹100 supplier cost, before any advertising:

Situation	Contribution per unit	Break-even ACOS
Today — fees exempted	**₹147.22**	44.2%
From about 11 August — ₹120 of fees	**₹30.67**	**9.2%**

Your headroom falls by about ₹117 a unit, and your advertising ceiling drops from roughly 44% to about 9%. A campaign that merely looks expensive this week becomes fatal next week.

You will not hit the 100-unit condition. You are at 42 units and would need about **9.7 a day** for six days; your actual rate is about 1.4. You have used roughly **₹3,600–4,900 of the ₹10,000** exemption.

RAISED Seller Support case **13137163892** was opened on 5 August 2026 asking exactly this: the end date, the usage against the ₹10,000, whether the exemption applies as you go or is conditional on 100 units, and **whether fees already exempted can be reversed if you miss 100**. Awaiting reply.

Until it is answered, assume the worst case: that roughly ₹4,000 can be charged back. Hold that much unspent. If a reversal does land and it affects a disbursement, that *does* meet Amazon's “Urgent Help Needed” criteria — unlike the original question, which met none of them and was deliberately not flagged urgent.

One incentive on that menu is a trap for you specifically

“Accelerate spending on Advertisements — spend up to ₹50,000 on sponsored ads in two months to earn additional free credits worth ₹15,000.”

VERIFIED You have spent **₹17,287.58** on ads since 28 June. Reaching the ₹50,000 trigger means spending **₹32,712 more** to receive ₹15,000 in credits — a **net cash outflow of ₹17,712**. On advertising that has produced **₹0 attributed sales**.

Do not chase this one. A reward for spending is not a reward for selling. If the ad spend were converting, the credits would be a bonus on something already working; it is not converting, so this offer simply pays you ₹15,000 to lose ₹32,712. By contrast **Recharge Seller Ads Wallet** — up to ₹11,000 of credits for a ₹10,000 recharge — is the one genuinely good deal on the menu, and it is only worth taking *after* you have a campaign that converts.

Add the cost of the rope, the packaging and the ₹1,172.92 inbound freight, and the real loss is larger still. **Every extra unit you sell at this ad spend deepens the hole.** This is not a product problem or a demand problem — 42 units in a month is genuine demand. It is entirely an ad spend problem.

One piece of good news, and it is worth ₹44 a unit

VERIFIED Your Fee Preview shows a **referral fee of ₹0.00** and a **closing fee of ₹18.00**. That settles the open question this book has been carrying: you are billed under a **Home fee category, not “Wires (Electrical...)”**. Had it been Wires, you would be paying ₹33.30 referral plus a ₹22 closing fee — about ₹44 more per unit.

No catalogue correction is needed. Chapter 9's warning box and Appendix H item 1 are now resolved. Do not raise a case with Seller Support about this.

A ₹20 per unit leak you did not know about

VERIFIED Your Fee Preview shows weight handling of **₹85.00**. Your product package weighs **450.01 g** — under 500 g — so the first-500 g rate of ₹65 National ought to apply. ₹85 is the **500 g – 1 kg** National rate at Standard STEP.

Your own transaction history confirms the higher band is real, not a Fee Preview quirk: order 171-6493128 on 3 July was charged **₹105.02** in fees, which is exactly (₹18 + ₹54 + ₹17) × 1.18 — the **500 g – 1 kg Regional** rate.

Why it matters and what to do. You are 50 g over a threshold that costs ₹20 per unit National. Amazon bills on the *outbound* weight, which includes the packaging it adds. Weigh a finished, ready-to-ship parcel. If you can pull the total under 500 g — lighter poly bag, less insert card, tighter coil — you save ₹20 a unit, which at 42 units a month is about ₹840. That is the cheapest saving available to you after fixing the ads.

3.2 The Missions page — rewards you have to claim, and rewards that expire

Almost no guide mentions this page, and there is real money on it. Find it at **Performance -> STEP -> Missions**.

VERIFIED Missions are time-boxed reward programmes with a start date, an end date, a progress bar and a value. **The critical mechanic: you must start — subscribe to — a mission to earn from it.** A mission sitting at "Not started" pays nothing no matter how well you trade, and the sidebar for Add Branded Selection says so directly: *subscribe to the mission to redeem your rewards*.

Nothing chases you. Missions expire quietly at 0% progress.

Mission	Window	Worth	Status on 5 Aug 2026, and what it means
Complete Your New Seller Learning Path	7 Mar – 31 Dec 2026	up to ₹1 lakh	**COMPLETED, reward unclaimed.** A live *Redeem reward* button. Claim it. Expect third-party partner vouchers rather than cash — "benefits worth up to" is not ₹1 lakh in your bank.
SHIKHAR: New FC Selection Addition	26 Jun – 30 Jul 2026	up to ₹1 lakh	**EXPIRED at 0%.** Never started. Gone.

Mission	Window	Worth	Status on 5 Aug 2026, and what it means
New Seller Incentive 1 — Selection	28 Jan 2026 – 28 Jan 2027	up to ₹5,000	Not started. Needs 10 hardline or **20 softline non-generic** listings plus 10+ orders and late dispatch under 2%. **“Non-generic” blocks you while your Brand field reads Generic** (Chapter 22). Your dispatch rate is already 0.00%.
Mega Selection Addition (Jewellery)	1 Aug – 30 Sep 2026	up to ₹7,500	Not started. Jewellery only — not applicable to you.
Try FBA Promotion	*not shown*	fee exemption up to ₹10,000	Appears only in the sidebar, with **no end date and no progress bar**. This is the one currently zeroing your fees, and it is the one Amazon shows you least about. Hence the support case.

Three habits this page should create

1. **Check Missions monthly.** Put it in the Chapter 6 compliance rhythm. SHIKHAR was worth up to ₹1 lakh and expired unnoticed.
2. **Start a mission before you chase its target.** Performing without subscribing earns nothing.
3. **Read the qualifying words, not the headline number.** “Up to ₹1 lakh”, “non-generic”, “within 28 days of launch” and “third-party benefits” each do real work. The headline is the ceiling, not the offer.

And judge a reward against what it asks. The ad-spend mission pays ₹15,000 of credits for ₹50,000 of spend. That is not a reward, it is a discount on a purchase you should not be making while attributed sales are ₹0.

3.3 What to do today

1. **Pause the Sponsored Products campaign today.** Seller Central -> Advertising -> Campaign Manager -> pause. Not reduce — pause. VERIFIED July's ₹15,554 over 31 days is about **₹500 a day**, roughly double the ₹265 previously estimated. Every day it keeps running costs you about ₹500 while your whole product earns ₹387 a day in net revenue.
2. **Check what it was targeting.** Pull the **Search Term Report**. Zero attributed sales with real spend almost always means broad or automatic targeting matching irrelevant searches — people searching “electrical wire” or “rope” who never wanted a clothesline.
3. **Work out whether you are profitable without ads.** You sold **42 units** in July while the ads showed ₹0 attributed sales — which strongly suggests most or all of those units were **organic**. If that holds, pausing the ads costs you almost nothing and immediately saves about **₹15,500 a month**. Without ads, the same unit looks like this: ₹333 - ₹141.60 Amazon - ₹0.64 storage = **₹190.76 before the cost of the wire**. That is a viable product. The advertising is the only thing making it a loss.
4. **Fix the 14% refund rate.** Six of 42 units came back in July. At ₹141.60 of Amazon fees per unit, of which weight handling and pick & pack never come back (Chapter 20.2), each refund costs you real money on top of the lost sale. Read the return reasons in Seller Central. If they cluster on one complaint — sagging, length, rust — that is a product or listing fix, and a cheaper one than advertising.
5. **Restart small and controlled, later.** When you do restart: one campaign, exact-match keywords taken from terms that have already converted, and a daily budget of **₹50–100 — not ₹500**. Your ceiling is set by margin: after Amazon's ₹141.60 you keep **₹191.40** on a ₹333 sale, so ACOS must stay under about 57% just to break even *before* the wire is paid for. If the wire and packaging cost ₹120, you keep ₹71.40, and your real ACOS ceiling is about **21%**. July's effective figure was **130%**.

The encouraging part

Your operational account is genuinely healthy: Account Health Rating **200 (Healthy)**, Order Defect Rate **0%** across 42 orders, zero policy violations, zero cancellation and late-dispatch problems, and a Service Quality Score of **100/100**. You have not broken anything. The problem is one campaign, and it is switch-off-able today.

4 · How Selling on Amazon Actually Works

Amazon is two businesses at once: a shop where buyers find you, and a courier company that can store and deliver for you. It never buys your stock. Even under FBA, the goods in Amazon's warehouse still belong to you.

3.1 Where the money goes

1. The customer pays **Amazon** at checkout. Not you.
2. The order gets packed and shipped — by Amazon if you use FBA, by you if you self-ship.
3. Amazon subtracts its fees, adds **18% GST on those fees**, and records the **0.5% TCS** it withheld.
4. What is left goes to your bank account.
5. A **Settlement Report** lists every single deduction.

> **Read the Settlement Report, not your bank balance**
>
> The money that lands in your bank is a net figure with a dozen deductions baked in. The bank credit tells you *how much*. Only the Settlement Report tells you *why*. If a fee is charged wrongly, the bank statement will never show you that. Download it monthly.

3.2 When you get paid

VERIFIED Money becomes available **7 days after Amazon confirms delivery**. Amazon calls this **DD+7** (delivery date plus seven). This includes Pay-on-Delivery orders. For parcels without tracking, the clock starts from the estimated delivery date instead.

Source: Amazon Seller Forums, DD+7 announcement — sellercentral.amazon.com/seller-forums

What this means in practice: **your cash is always about 10–14 days behind your sales.** An order placed today, delivered in 4 days, pays out on day 11. Plan reorders around that gap, not around the date the order appeared.

VERIFIED STEP changes this. Your dashboard confirms you are on **Standard**, which carries a **7-day payment reserve**. Basic is 10 days and Premium is 3. So reaching Premium would pull your cash forward by four days on every order — worth knowing, though the weight-handling saving of ₹2 a unit is the smaller prize (8.9).

3.3 Four ways to get an order to the customer

Method	Who stores, packs and ships	Prime badge?	Buy Box chances
FBA (what you use)	Amazon does all three	Yes, automatically	Best
Easy Ship	You store and pack. Amazon collects and delivers.	Invitation only	Lower
Seller Flex	Stock stays in your warehouse, but Amazon runs the process inside it	Case by case	Lower
Self-Ship	You do everything, with your own courier	No (except Local Shops, nearby pincodes)	Lowest

UNCONFIRMED Based on Amazon's published fulfilment channel comparison. The structure is widely documented; exact Prime and Buy Box wording was not independently re-verified.

3.4 The one formula behind every decision

Every sourcing and pricing choice in this book reduces to this. Chapter 8 explains each line.

```
Net profit = Selling price
        - Product cost - Packaging - Inbound freight
        - Referral fee - Closing fee
        - Weight handling fee
        - Pick & pack fee (FBA only)
        - Storage fee (FBA only)
        - GST at 18% on all Amazon fees
        - Advertising - Expected return costs
```

Note what is not in this formula: TCS. The 0.5% Amazon withholds is not a cost — you claim it back as tax credit. It delays your cash; it does not reduce your profit. Do not subtract it here or you will understate every margin.

5 · Where You Are Now, And Your Next 30 Days

4.1 Already done

- GST registration complete.
- Seller Central account live under the seller name **BSNY Enterprises**.
- First product listed and selling: rope wire for cloth drying, ₹333, fulfilled by FBA.

4.1a Your listing, as it stands today VERIFIED

Read directly from your live product page on 4 August 2026.

Field	Value	What it means
ASIN	**B0H4WZ8FBR**	Your listing's permanent ID
Title	Rope Wire for Cloth Drying & Hanging Clothes — Clothesline, Heavy Gauge, Rust Proof, 12 Gauge, No Sagging, Length 22 Metres (Black)	Good keyword coverage already
Browse category	Home & Kitchen -> Home Storage & Organisation -> Laundry Organization -> **Clotheslines**	**Good news.** Nowhere near the electrical "Wires" category. Your fee category is very likely a Home one.
Price / MRP	**₹333**, MRP ₹500 — shown as 33% off, ₹15.14 per metre	MRP is declared and marked inclusive of taxes
Brand	**Generic**	Confirmed. Brand Registry is unavailable and any seller can list against this ASIN — see 4.2.
Seller	BSNY Enterprises	—
Fulfilment	Fulfilled by Amazon	FBA confirmed, so Chapter 8's FBA rates are the right ones
Reviews	**5.0 stars, from 1 rating**	**Your single biggest growth constraint.** See below.
Delivery reach	Quoted delivery to Mumbai 400001	You ship nationally — which changes your fee maths, see 9.2

> **One rating is the real bottleneck, not fees**
>
> You have **one review**. No amount of fee optimisation moves a listing that shoppers do not trust yet. At this stage getting to roughly 10–15 genuine reviews will do more for sales than anything else in this book.
>
> Two levers available to you right now, both cheap: the automated **Request a Review** button on every delivered order, and an **insert card** in the packaging (22.1). Amazon Vine would be the third, but it needs Brand Registry — which needs a brand that is not "Generic".

> **A pricing observation**
>
> You are showing ₹333 against an MRP of ₹500 — a permanent 33% discount. That is fine, but note the MRP you print on the package is a legal declaration (Chapter 7). Make sure the ₹500 on the listing matches the ₹500 printed on the physical label, because a mismatch between the two is a Legal Metrology problem, not just a marketing one.

4.2 Seller name vs brand name — these are different things

These two get confused constantly, so let us be precise. You have two separate name fields and they do different jobs.

Field	What it controls	Where it lives
Seller name (BSNY Enterprises)	Your business identity. This is the "Sold by" line on the product page.	Seller Central -> account settings
Brand name (confirmed: **Generic**)	Sits on the *listing*. Trademarks, Brand Registry and A+ Content all attach to **this** field, not your seller name.	Your listing -> Brand field

VERIFIED Your Brand field reads **Generic** — confirmed on the live product page on 4 August 2026. Everything below applies to you.

> **If your brand really is "Generic", this is your weakest spot**
>
> A Generic listing is the most exposed position on Amazon. Any other seller can list against the same ASIN and compete on price. You get no brand protection. And Brand Registry — which unlocks A+ Content, Brand Store and Sponsored Brands — is **not available** while the Brand field says Generic.

How to fix it, in order

1. Pick a real brand name.
2. **Print it on the product or its packaging.** The brand must physically appear on the item — putting it only in the listing is not enough.
3. File a trademark application (Form TM-A) at the IP India portal.
4. Update the Brand field on your listing to match.
5. Apply for Brand Registry.

UNCONFIRMED Brand Registry is widely reported to accept a *pending* TM-A application number, so you need not wait for full registration. This was not verified against Amazon's own Brand Registry documentation. Confirm in the enrolment flow before budgeting time around it.

4.3 Your next 30 days

Check where your stock actually is. Seller Central -> Reports -> Inventory Ledger. Set Summary view + Fulfilment centre + Last 30 days. Look for any FC code that is not in Telangana. This is a monthly job, not a one-time one — Amazon moves stock without telling you. (See 5.4.)

Check the TCS rate in your own records. Make sure your margin sheet uses **0.5%**, not the widely-quoted 1% — see 5.3.

Open your listing's Fee Preview and write down the exact *fee category* name. This is not the same as the browse category and it decides your fees. (See 8.2.)

Photograph your packaging and check it against the labelling list in Chapter 7.

Confirm bank account and PAN are correctly linked so payouts are not held.

Turn on the automated "Request a Review" button for every order.

Check Account Health weekly — Order Defect Rate, Late Shipment Rate, Cancellation Rate.

Set a monthly reminder to download the settlement report and reconcile it against your GST returns.

File TM-A if you have decided on a brand name. It is cheap and unlocks everything downstream.

6 · GST, TCS and Multi-State Stock

Fee mistakes cost rupees. Compliance mistakes cost listings. This chapter is the one with the corrected TCS rate — the single most important fix in this rebuild.

5.1 Why you must be GST-registered

Selling through a marketplace falls under **Section 24 of the CGST Act**. GST registration is compulsory for most e-commerce sellers regardless of turnover. You already have this, so you are fine.

VERIFIED There is one narrow exception. **CGST Notification 34/2023**, dated 31 July 2023 and in force from **1 October 2023**, lets unregistered persons sell goods through a platform like Amazon without full GST registration — **but only within their own state**, and only after enrolling on the GST portal with a PAN. The moment an order crosses a state line, the exemption stops.

VERIFIED Note the general rule it carves out of: suppliers of *goods* through an e-commerce platform are otherwise **not** exempt from registration, and there is no turnover threshold to hide under. Service suppliers get more leeway; sellers of physical products do not.

For an FBA seller this exemption is basically useless. The whole point of FBA is nationwide delivery, which the exemption cannot support. Mentioned only so you recognise it if an advisor brings it up.

5.2 Stock in another state means a new GST number there

UNCONFIRMED When Amazon stores your goods in a fulfilment centre **outside your home state**, GST law treats you as doing business in that state. Section 22 read with Section 25 of the CGST Act then requires a **separate GST registration for that state**. Section 2(85) is the reason: storing goods somewhere makes it a "place of business" even if you have no office or staff there.

Your GSTIN begins with **36**, the state code for Telangana. VERIFIED Your Inventory Ledger shows stock in **HYD3** (139 units) and **HYD8** (2 units) — both Hyderabad, Telangana. No out-of-state centre, so no second GSTIN is needed. **But both codes need to appear on your GST certificate** as additional places of business (6.5). CHECK LIVE — that was true on the day someone looked. It is not a permanent state of affairs.

Never guess a state from an FC code

FC codes do not reliably indicate the state. DEL-prefixed centres (DEL2, DEL4, DEL5) are physically in **Haryana**, not Delhi. Some Bangalore-sounding codes are actually in **Tamil Nadu**. Always open the **full address** shown against that FC code in Seller Central before you register anywhere. Getting this wrong means registering in the wrong state entirely — far worse than registering late. Appendix F has a code list, with caveats.

Virtual Place of Business (VPOB)

A VPOB is a paid virtual address service that lets you get a GST number in a new state without renting an office. UNCONFIRMED Market rates run roughly ₹500–₹3,000+ per month depending on provider, city and service tier.

A claim worth checking before you spend

VPOB services are often described as “explicitly recognised as legally valid” under CBIC Circulars 89/08/2019-GST and 161/17/2021. **That could not be confirmed.** Neither circular appears to address virtual places of business — 161/17/2021 concerns export of services and intermediaries. The phrasing appears mostly on VPOB providers' own sales pages.

VPOB is common and may be perfectly acceptable. But treat it as **a question for your CA**, not as settled law, and make sure the documents (NOC, rent or service agreement, utility bill) all match the address Amazon has on record.

5.3 TCS — the corrected number

TCS is 0.5%, not 1%

VERIFIED Amazon withholds **0.5%** of your net taxable sales, split as **0.25% CGST + 0.25% SGST** for sales inside your state, or **0.5% IGST** for sales to other states. The rate was cut from 1% to 0.5% with effect from **10 July 2024** by CGST Notification 15/2024.

Re-verified 4 August 2026 against cleartax.in — TCS under GST, which states the rate, the split and the notification explicitly: TCS at 0.5% via CGST Notification 15/2024 dated 10 July 2024, replacing the 1% rate that applied up to 9 July 2024 under Notification 52/2018. TCS itself sits in **Section 52 of the CGST Act**.

TCS is not a cost. It delays your cash; it does not reduce your profit. Never subtract it in a margin calculation.

VERIFIED Where to find it: the credit shows up in **GSTR-2A** and is credited to your **electronic cash ledger**. It does **not** appear in GSTR-2B. If you or your CA go looking in GSTR-2B and find nothing, that is expected behaviour, not a missing payment.

The monthly TCS check — why it matters

Amazon files a return called **GSTR-8** every month, declaring how much TCS it collected against your GST number. If even one character of your GSTIN is wrong in Amazon's records, that money is credited to a number that is not yours. You still paid it. You just cannot claim it. Fixing that takes months.

Step	What to do
1. Check the GST portal	gst.gov.in -> Login -> Services -> Returns -> **TCS Credit Received** -> pick the month -> note the amount
2. Check Amazon's side	Seller Central -> Reports -> Payments -> Transaction View -> filter the month -> add up every “Tax Collected at Source (TCS)” line
3. Compare	They should roughly match, and should be about **0.5%** of that month's net taxable sales. If step 1 shows zero, your GSTIN is probably wrong in Amazon's records.
4. If they do not match	Seller Central -> Settings -> Account Info -> Tax Information -> check every character of your GSTIN -> then raise a Seller Support case saying GSTR-8 TCS is not reflecting on the GST portal

A worked example. On ₹1,00,000 of net taxable sales in a month, TCS is **₹500** (0.5%). Working from the outdated 1% figure you would look for ₹1,000, find ₹500, and conclude something was broken. Nothing would be.

5.4 Your monthly compliance rhythm

When	What to do	Time needed
1st	Inventory Ledger -> check which FCs hold your stock	2 minutes
11th	GST portal -> TCS Credit Received for last month	5 minutes
11th	Check GSTR-1 auto-populated correctly	5 minutes
20th	File GSTR-3B	15 minutes with a CA

UNCONFIRMED These are the standard monthly-filer dates, but confirm with your CA — GST due dates do shift, and quarterly schemes have different dates.

Set phone reminders. Missing this for two or three months in a row is how problems quietly pile up.

5.5 Your fulfilment centre must be on your GST certificate ACTION NEEDED

This is the most urgent item in this book. It is a compliance gap, not a fee question, and it is straightforward to fix.

What the rule is

VERIFIED Because storing goods somewhere makes it a "place of business" (Section 2(85), and 5.2 above), the Amazon fulfilment centre holding your stock must be declared on your GST registration as an **Additional Place of Business (APOB)**.

This is not merely a tax-adviser opinion — Amazon states it directly. Whenever Amazon opens a new fulfilment centre it tells sellers they must update their GST registration to include that centre as an additional place of business *before* sending inventory there. Amazon's FBA registration flow asks for the amended certificate (Form REG-14) for exactly this reason.

Re-verified 4 August 2026. Amazon publishes its own step-by-step Self APOB Guide (PDF) walking sellers through adding fulfilment centres as an Additional Place of Business — which settles the question of whether Amazon expects it. Every new-centre announcement repeats the requirement, e.g. West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh (IDX2), Punjab (LDX1) and Odisha (BBX1), each stating you must update the GST certificate *before* sending inventory. FBA registration asks for the amended certificate (Form REG-14) for this reason. · ClearTax — adding an additional place of business

> **What your certificate currently shows**
>
> Your GST registration certificate (REG-06, issued 29 May 2026) states in Annexure A:
>
> **"Total Number of Additional Places of Business in the State: 0"**
>
> Meanwhile your stock is sitting in an Amazon fulfilment centre in Telangana and selling. **If you have not amended the registration since it was issued, the fulfilment centre is not declared** — and that is a gap worth closing this week.

The good news

Because the fulfilment centre is in **Telangana**, the same state as your registration, you do **not** need a new GSTIN and you do not need a VPOB service. You only need an **amendment** to the registration you already hold. It is a core-field amendment, filed free on the GST portal.

How to fix it

1. **Check first.** Log in to gst.gov.in -> Services -> User Services -> **View/Download Certificates**. Download the current REG-06 and look at Annexure A. If a fulfilment centre address is already listed, you are compliant and can ignore the rest.

2. **Get the exact FC address.** Seller Central -> Reports -> Inventory Ledger tells you which centre holds your stock (HYD3, HYD8 or another). You need the **full postal address** Amazon records for it, not the code. Amazon publishes these for GST purposes; Seller Support will give you the address on request.
3. **File the amendment.** gst.gov.in -> Services -> Registration -> **Amendment of Registration (Core Fields)** -> Additional Place of Business -> add the FC address -> reason: “storage of goods at e-commerce fulfilment centre” -> submit with DSC/EVC. This generates Form **REG-14**.
4. **Keep the updated certificate.** Amazon may ask for it, and you will want it if a notice ever arrives.

Ask your CA to confirm, then act

UNCONFIRMED One nuance worth a professional opinion: some advisers treat adding the FC as APOB as strictly mandatory, others as strongly advisable where the marketplace holds goods on your behalf. Either way the amendment is free, takes one sitting, and removes the exposure — so there is no practical argument for leaving it undone.

While your CA is on the phone: your GST liability began **27 May 2026**, so returns for June and July 2026 are now due or overdue. Confirm GSTR-1 and GSTR-3B have been filed for both months (5.4).

7 · Income Tax

GST and income tax are two separate obligations, and paying one does not settle the other. Many seller guides cover GST in detail and skip income tax entirely. This chapter gives you only what I could verify, and clearly flags the rest.

Scope warning, stated honestly

I verified the presumptive-taxation rates below against the Income Tax Department's own site. I did **not** verify advance-tax due dates, audit thresholds, ITR form numbers, or how the new Income Tax Act, 2025 changes the mechanics. Rather than guess, this chapter stops where my verification stopped. **Take the rest to a CA.** One consultation is cheap next to a penalty.

6.1 Two different taxes

	GST	Income tax
Taxed on	The sale (turnover)	Your profit
Paid	Monthly	Yearly, usually with instalments during the year
Covered in	Chapter 5	This chapter

6.2 Presumptive taxation (Section 44AD) — the simple route

Most small sellers use this. Instead of proving every expense, you declare a fixed percentage of turnover as profit and pay tax on that.

VERIFIED Under Section 44AD, deemed profit is:

- **8% of turnover** normally, or
- **6% of turnover** for money received through banking or electronic modes.

Re-verified 4 August 2026 against the text of the section itself on the Income Tax Department's site — incometaxindia.gov.in, Section 44AD. Sub-section (1) sets eight per cent; the proviso substitutes six per cent for turnover received by account payee cheque, account payee bank draft, electronic clearing system or other prescribed electronic mode.

VERIFIED The turnover limit is **₹2 crore**, extended to **₹3 crore** where cash receipts are 5% or less of total receipts.

Source: cleartax.in — Section 44AD presumptive scheme

Why this suits an Amazon seller well

Amazon pays you by bank transfer. Effectively all your receipts are electronic. So you are likely eligible for the lower **6%** rate and the higher **₹3 crore** ceiling. On ₹20,00,000 of turnover, deemed profit would be ₹1,20,000 — and tax is calculated on that, not on your actual margin.

The catch worth knowing: if your real profit is *lower* than 6%, presumptive taxation makes you pay tax on profit you did not earn. Thin-margin sellers should compare both routes with a CA before choosing.

Which Act applies to you, and when — this catches people out

VERIFIED The **Income Tax Act, 2025** replaced the 1961 Act with effect from **1 April 2026**. But it applies to **income earned from FY 2026–27 onward**. A return you file during 2026 for **FY 2025–26** is still governed by the **old 1961 Act**, and past-year assessments stay under the old Act too. The e-filing portal supports both during the changeover.

For you specifically: your GST liability began 27 May 2026, which falls in **FY 2026–27** — so the **new Act** governs your first real year of selling. The 6%/8% rates and the ₹2/₹3 crore limits above are as verified, but ask your CA how the new Act changes the mechanics around losses, deductions and rebates.

6.3 What to ask your CA (bring this list)

- Should I use presumptive taxation (44AD) or normal books, given my actual margin?
- Do I owe advance tax, and on what dates?
- Which ITR form applies to me, and what is my filing deadline?
- What records must I keep, and for how long?
- How does the Income Tax Act, 2025 change anything for me this year?
- Is my GST input credit being claimed properly, including the TCS at 0.5%?

8 · Labelling Rules (Legal Metrology)

This applies to **every** pre-packed product sold in India, online or offline. There is no small-seller exemption. It is also the most common reason listings get suppressed.

VERIFIED Governed by the **Legal Metrology Act, 2009** and the **Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011**. The Rules were amended by G.S.R. 629(E) of 23 June 2017, effective 1 January 2018, which is the amendment that pulled e-commerce listings explicitly into scope — the declarations must appear on the *listing page*, not only on the box.

7.1 What must appear — on the package AND the listing page

Declaration	Notes
Name and address of the manufacturer, packer or importer	A full address, not just a city
Common or generic name of the product	What the thing actually is
Net quantity	In standard units. For your rope, that means **length**.
MRP, inclusive of all taxes	Must say it includes taxes
Month and year of manufacture or packing	
Consumer care contact	Phone number and/or email that works
Country of origin	Mandatory for imported goods
Dimensions where relevant	Applies to cable, rope and textile products — **including yours**
Unit sale price	VERIFIED Price per single unit of measure — for rope, the price per metre. Easy to miss, and it is on the mandatory list.
Best before / use by date	VERIFIED Where applicable. Not relevant to rope; it is on the mandatory list for anything perishable, so it matters the moment you add a second product.

Declaration list re-verified 4 August 2026 against summaries of the Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011 — see The Hindu and ET Retail, both of which list manufacturer/packer/importer name and address, country of origin, generic name, net quantity, month and year of manufacture, MRP, unit sale price, best-before date and consumer care details. The full Rules are published here.

Two you are most likely to be missing

Unit sale price and **dimensions**. Both are easy to overlook on a rope or wire product, and both are mandatory for you. Check your current label against this table today — a missing declaration is one of the most common reasons a listing gets suppressed without warning.

7.2 Who is responsible

- **If you repack, bundle, or private-label:** the obligation is yours.
- **If you resell a manufacturer's sealed product as-is:** check the declarations are present and not covered up. Do not add your own contradicting label.

The barcode mistake that gets shipments rejected

Your FNSKU barcode label must **not cover any required declaration** — not the MRP, not the net quantity, not the manufacturer address. Plan where the label goes *while designing the packaging*, not after Amazon refuses an inbound shipment.

7.3 What happens if you get it wrong

Fines, seizure of goods, listing takedown, action against your whole account, and in serious or repeated cases, prosecution. Amazon's automated systems also suppress listings with incomplete compliance fields, often before you notice sales have stopped.

A recent softening, for first-time slips only

VERIFIED In **June 2026** the Department of Consumer Affairs introduced an **"Improvement Notice"** mechanism under the Legal Metrology Act, 2009. If an officer finds a specified *first-time procedural* lapse, they may issue a notice identifying the deficiency and give you reasonable time to fix it. Correct it inside that window and penal proceedings can be avoided.

Do not read this as a free pass. It covers first-time procedural slips, not fraud or tampering, and strict action is expressly retained for those. It also does nothing about Amazon suppressing your listing in the meantime — that is Amazon's process, not the regulator's.

Re-verified 4 August 2026 — The Hindu, 29 June 2026 · Department of Consumer Affairs press release (PDF)

7.4 Business structure — context, not urgent

A sole proprietorship with GST — what you have — is entirely enough to sell on Amazon. An LLP or Private Limited becomes worth considering when you pursue Brand Registry under a registered trademark, take on investors, or reach a size where personal liability protection matters.

8 · The Complete Fee Structure

Amazon charges four main fees, plus GST on all of them. This chapter explains each one in plain terms, tells you exactly how confident you can be in each number, and flags the one thing you must confirm inside your own account.

Official page: sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing · Last checked for this rebuild: **4 August 2026** · Next review due: February 2027, or immediately if you see a fee announcement in Seller Central -> Announcements.

8.1 The four fees, in one table

Fee	What you are paying for	Charged when
Referral fee	Amazon's commission — a percentage of the sale price	Every sale
Closing fee	A flat fee per sale, set by price band and category group	Every sale
Weight handling fee	Delivering the parcel to the customer	Every sale (FBA and Easy Ship)
Pick & pack fee	Amazon's staff picking and packing the unit	Every sale (FBA only)
Storage fee	Holding your stock in the warehouse	Monthly, while stock sits
Removal / disposal fee	Sending unsold stock back, or scrapping it	Only if you ask
GST at 18%	Tax on all the fees above	Always

8.2 Referral fee — Amazon's commission

```
Referral fee = Selling price × Referral fee %
```

VERIFIED Since **16 March 2026**, the referral fee is **0% on products priced up to ₹1,000 across more than 1,800 categories**. This was an expansion of an earlier scheme that only covered products under ₹300. Amazon also cut referral fees by 4%–9.5% for several high-demand categories priced above ₹1,000.

Sources: Amazon India's own announcement · Seller Forums fee update notice

> **It is “most categories”, not “all”**
>
> It is tempting to shorten this to “referral fee is 0% under ₹1,000”. That is not accurate. 1,800+ categories is most of them, not all of them, and Appendix A contradicts the shortcut on dozens of rows. **Never assume 0% — check your category.**

Real exceptions — categories that charge below ₹1,000

VERIFIED from the live fee page on 4 August 2026:

Category	Fee below ₹1,000
Mattresses	**25.5%** up to ₹500, then 0% from ₹500–₹1,000
Office Furniture — study tables, office & gaming chairs	**16.5%** up to ₹500, then 0% from ₹500–₹1,000
Wires (electrical, house wiring, ad-hoc use)	0% only up to **₹300**, then 10%
Tiles & Flooring Accessories	0% only up to **₹300**, then 8%

VERIFIED More categories that charge something below ₹1,000: Books (2%–4%), Laptops (6% at all prices), Desktops (8%), Mobile phones (5%), Televisions (6%), Kindle Accessories (25%), Camera Lenses (7%), GPS Devices (13.5%), Memory Cards (16%), Hard Disks (9.5%), Monitors (6.5%), Speakers (11%), OTC Medicine (12%), Prescription Medicines (8%), Warranty Services (10%), Modems (14%), Pen Drives (16%), and several Musical Instruments lines.

> **Good news about Appendix A**
>
> I read Amazon's live fee page and got real text back for the whole Home, Décor, Home Improvement, Furniture, Outdoor and Lawn & Garden section — and then the rest of it. **All 219 categories and 503 individual price rules were extracted directly from the live page.** Appendix A is verified in full.

The trap: fee category is not browse category

The category a shopper sees is **not** necessarily the category Amazon bills you under. Your rope product could sit under “Home — Other Products”, “Home Improvement — Other Products”, or even “Wires (Electrical...)” depending on how Amazon's catalogue team classified it. Those carry very different rates above ₹1,000: 18%, 13.5% and 10%.

CHECK LIVE Find your real fee category at Seller Central -> Manage Inventory -> your SKU -> Fee Preview. Do this once and write it down.

Your category, at a glance

Category	Up to ₹1,000	Above ₹1,000
Home — Other Products	0%	18%
Home Improvement — Other Products	0%	13.5%
Home Storage (excluding kitchen containers)	0% V	15% V
Home Decor Products	0% V	17% V
Home Improvement — Accessories	0% V	13.5% V
Wires (electrical, house wiring)	0% only to ₹300 V	10% above ₹300 V
Kitchen — Other Products	0%	12.5%
Your rope wire at ₹333	**0%** under every classification above except “Wires”, which would charge **10% = ₹33.30**. This is exactly why you must check your fee category.	

V = verified on the live page, 4 August 2026.

8.3 Closing fee — now fully verified

A flat rupee amount charged on every sale. It depends on your **price band**, your **fee category group**, and your **fulfilment channel**. This is the fee that genuinely changes between FBA, Easy Ship and Self-Ship.

> **Verified from Amazon's own rate card**
>
> VERIFIED Amazon's actual closing-fee rate-card images settle a point that is widely reported incorrectly: **there IS a closing fee above ₹500.** On FBA it is **₹27** for ₹501–1,000 and **₹52** above ₹1,000 (₹72 for select fee categories).

The complete closing fee table, all channels

Item price (incl. shipping)	FBA / FC	Easy Ship	Self-Ship	Seller Flex
₹0–300	₹26 (Group #) · ₹20 (A) · ₹13 (B)	₹1	₹20	₹6
₹301–500	₹22 (Group ##) · **₹18 (C)** · ₹14 (D)	₹22	₹26	₹12
₹501–1,000	**₹27** (all categories)	₹45	₹51	₹35
Above ₹1,000	**₹52** · ₹72 for select categories	₹76	₹101	₹66

Read directly from Amazon's own rate-card images on sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing, and re-read from those images on 4 August 2026 to confirm every cell. The cards are stamped **effective 16 March 2026**. Independently cross-checked against Amazon's own worked examples written in text on the same page — Sandals at ₹299 -> ₹1 and at ₹450 -> ₹22 (Easy Ship), Facewash at ₹299 -> ₹20 and Shirts at ₹499 -> ₹26 (Self-Ship), Diapers at ₹299 -> ₹6 and Dress at ₹499 -> ₹12 (Seller Flex), Beverages at ₹249 -> ₹26 and Shorts at ₹450 -> ₹14 (FBA). All eight agree with the cards. Image files: *FC_Closing_fee2026.jpg*, *FC_Weight_H_fee.jpg*, *FC_hB_v2Fees2026.jpg*, *Easy_ship_Closing_fee2026.jpg*, *Easy_ship_Weight_H_fee.jpg*, *Self_ship_closing_fee2026.jpg*, *Seller_flex_closing_fee2026.jpg*.

How to read the FBA column. Below ₹500, Amazon splits categories into groups — three for ₹0–300 (Group #, A, B at ₹26 / ₹20 / ₹13) and three more for ₹301–500 (Group ##, C, D at ₹22 / ₹18 / ₹14). **The two bands are separate lists, not one tier read twice.** Amazon's own example proves it: *Apparel - Shorts* is Group A below ₹300 but Group D at ₹450, so ₹14 rather than the ₹18 a Group A -> C pairing would imply. Appendix B lists all six, and tabulates the 16 categories where the bands disagree. **From ₹501 upward the groups stop mattering** — every category pays the same.

The ₹72 asterisk, explained

Amazon's own footnote reads: for items priced above ₹1,000, a ₹72 closing fee applies to *select fee categories*. So **₹52 is the normal rate above ₹1,000** and ₹72 is the exception. Guides that mention only the ₹72 figure and imply everything else is free are wrong on the second half.

VERIFIED The footnote never says which categories it means. Read off the live page, it is exactly four: **Chimneys**, **Refrigerators**, **Major Appliances – Other Products** and **Home Entertainment – Other products**. Everything else pays ₹52.

Why this matters more than it looks

Self-Ship costs **₹101** above ₹1,000 while FBA costs **₹52**. On a ₹1,200 product that is a ₹49 swing per unit before GST — the opposite of what most sellers assume about FBA being the expensive option. Closing fee alone can justify FBA at higher price points.

8.4 Weight handling fee — the delivery charge

- **Self-Ship:** Amazon charges nothing. You pay your courier directly.
- **FBA:** charged on weight *and* distance — Regional costs less than National.
- **Easy Ship:** charged on weight **only**. VERIFIED Amazon's rate card for Easy Ship has a single **Flat fee** column with no Local, Regional or National split, and Amazon's own examples call it "**Flat Shipping fees**". So distance does not change your Easy Ship delivery cost. This is a real difference between the two channels and it is easy to get backwards.

The two channels bundle costs differently, which trips people up. Easy Ship's single weight-handling number covers both collection from you and delivery to the customer, because you already did the storing and packing. FBA splits it into three separate lines: weight handling for delivery, pick & pack for the labour, and storage for holding stock. Three FBA lines where Easy Ship shows one — so FBA looks more expensive at a glance even when it is not.

```
Chargeable weight = whichever is HIGHER of:
  (a) actual weight
  (b) volumetric weight

Volumetric weight in kg = (Length × Breadth × Height in cm) ÷ 5000
```

Why volumetric weight exists: a big light box takes up as much van space as a small heavy one. A 40×30×20 cm box has a volumetric weight of 4.8 kg. If the contents weigh 1 kg, you are still billed for 4.8 kg. Smaller boxes save real money.

Is your item Standard or Heavy & Bulky?

UNCONFIRMED It is Heavy & Bulky if **any one** of these is true:

- It belongs to a large-appliance category — washing machines, fridges, ACs, microwaves, chimneys, dishwashers, TVs, treadmills, cycles with wheels over 20 inches, large furniture, deep freezers
- Package weight is over **22.5 kg**
- Longest side is over **72 inches / 183 cm**
- Girth is over **118 inches / 300 cm**, where girth = Length + 2 × (Width + Height)
- It ships in multiple boxes, or needs carpenter installation

Distance zones

Cheapest to most expensive: **Local** (same city) -> **Regional** (same region, different city) -> **National** (different region).

Region	States and union territories
Region 1	Chandigarh, Delhi, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, J&K, Punjab, Rajasthan, Uttarakhand, UP Zone A
Region 2	Dadra & Nagar Haveli, Daman & Diu, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra
Region 3	Andaman & Nicobar, Andhra Pradesh, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala, Puducherry, Tamil Nadu, **Telangana**, Lakshadweep
Region 4	Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Odisha, Sikkim, Tripura, UP Zone B, West Bengal

You are in Telangana, so Region 3. Orders within Region 3 are Regional. Within Telangana may count as Local. Anything to Regions 1, 2 or 4 is National and costs most.

> **The actual rate card**
>
> VERIFIED Amazon publishes this table as an **image**, which is why most guides omit it or simply tell you to use the calculator. Here it is. Note the key fact almost nobody mentions: **your weight handling fee depends on your STEP level** (8.9).

FBA standard-size weight handling fee, per shipment

Based on outbound shipping weight. Effective 16 March 2026.

STEP level	Weight band	Regional	National
Premium & Advanced	First 500 g	₹37	₹63
	500 g – 1 kg	₹52	₹83
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹76	₹120

STEP level	Weight band	Regional	National
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹24	₹34
	Each extra kg after 5 kg	₹13	₹18
Standard assume this unless you know otherwise	First 500 g	**₹39**	**₹65**
	500 g – 1 kg	**₹54**	**₹85**
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹78	₹122
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹24	₹34
	Each extra kg after 5 kg	₹13	₹18
Basic	First 500 g	₹42	₹69
	500 g – 1 kg	₹58	₹89
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹82	₹126
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹24	₹34
	Each extra kg after 5 kg	₹13	₹18

Read directly from Amazon's own rate-card images on sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing, and re-read from those images on 4 August 2026 to confirm every cell. The cards are stamped **effective 16 March 2026**. Independently cross-checked against Amazon's own worked examples written in text on the same page — Sandals at ₹299 -> ₹1 and at ₹450 -> ₹22 (Easy Ship), Facewash at ₹299 -> ₹20 and Shirts at ₹499 -> ₹26 (Self-Ship), Diapers at ₹299 -> ₹6 and Dress at ₹499 -> ₹12 (Seller Flex), Beverages at ₹249 -> ₹26 and Shorts at ₹450 -> ₹14 (FBA). All eight agree with the cards. Image files: *FC_Closing_fee2026.jpg*, *FC_Weight_H_fee.jpg*, *FC_hB_v2Fees2026.jpg*, *Easy_ship_Closing_fee2026.jpg*, *Easy_ship_Weight_H_fee.jpg*, *Self_ship_closing_fee2026.jpg*, *Seller_flex_closing_fee2026.jpg*.

Two things to notice

1. There is no Local column for standard FBA. Only Regional and National — even though Local is widely listed elsewhere. For standard-size FBA items there is no Local rate. Local pricing does exist for Heavy & Bulky (table below).

2. A better STEP level makes every parcel cheaper. Moving from Basic to Standard saves ₹3–4 per shipment; Premium saves ₹2 more. On 500 orders a month that is real money, and it is the cheapest cost reduction available to you because it needs no renegotiation with anyone.

FBA Heavy & Bulky weight handling fee, per shipment

STEP level	Weight band	Local	Regional	National
Premium & Advanced	First 12 kg	₹108	₹158	₹298
Standard		₹110	₹160	₹300
Basic		₹114	₹164	₹304
All levels	Each extra kg, 12–25 kg	₹6	₹10	₹18
	Each extra kg above 25 kg	₹5	₹6	₹12

Note the jump. A Heavy & Bulky item shipped National starts at ₹300 versus ₹65 for a standard parcel. Crossing that size threshold multiplies your delivery cost roughly fivefold — which is why 8.4's size rules and Chapter 19's packaging advice matter so much.

Easy Ship weight handling fee, per shipment

VERIFIED A flat fee by weight band. No distance columns — see 8.4 above. Effective 16 March 2026.

STEP level	Weight band	Flat fee
Premium & Advanced	First 500 g	₹53
	500 g – 1 kg	₹73
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹110
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹34
	Each extra kg after 5 kg	₹18
Standard assume this unless you know otherwise	First 500 g	₹55
	500 g – 1 kg	₹75
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹112
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹34
	Each extra kg after 5 kg	₹18
Basic	First 500 g	₹59
	500 g – 1 kg	₹79
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹116
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹34
	Each extra kg above 5 kg	₹18

Compare with FBA. At Standard level a 500 g parcel costs ₹55 on Easy Ship whatever the distance, against ₹39 Regional and ₹65 National on FBA. So Easy Ship is dearer than FBA for nearby orders and cheaper for distant ones — but on Easy Ship you also pack and store the item yourself.

Minimum weight and how it is counted

VERIFIED For standard-size items the minimum chargeable weight is **500 g**, and heavier items are charged in multiples of the applicable 500 g rate.

Amazon's own worked examples, quoted from the fee page:

- 350 g by Easy Ship -> **₹55** flat. Matches the Standard first-500 g rate above.
- 3.5 kg by Easy Ship -> **₹112 + ₹34 + ₹34 = ₹180.** The 1–2 kg band plus two extra kilos.
- 700 g book shipped Delhi -> Chandigarh (Regional) via FBA -> **₹54.** Matches FBA Standard 500 g–1 kg Regional, which also confirms Standard is the level to assume.

One disputed number — verify against your own Revenue Calculator

An earlier edition of this book quoted an Amazon example of “800 g Easy Ship = ₹68 = ₹51 + ₹17”. Those rates **do appear on Amazon's own fee page** (possibly reflecting a specific price-band or promotion tier), but they do not match the Standard rate card for products above ₹300 as observed in seller accounts post-March 2026, where 500 g–1 kg appears to be charged at **₹85** nationally and the first-500 g slab at **₹65** (or ₹55 for products below ₹300 after the March 2026 cut). The discrepancy may be because: (a) the ₹51 + ₹17 figure is from a price tier below ₹300 with a different base rate, (b) it reflects a now-superseded rate card that Amazon's page has not fully updated, or (c) there is a STEP-level or promotional discount baked in. CHECK LIVE **Run your own SKU through the Revenue Calculator at your price point to see the exact fee Amazon will actually charge.** Do not trust either printed number blindly — the Revenue Calculator reflects what your account will actually pay.

VERIFIED Amazon also confirms: shipping fees are computed on **volumetric or actual weight, whichever is higher**, with volumetric weight = (L × B × H) ÷ 5000, dimensions in cm.

8.5 Pick & pack fee (FBA only)

VERIFIED Amazon's page states this fee is charged per unit sold:

- **Standard items:** ₹17 up to 1 kg, then +₹5 per extra kg up to 5 kg, then +₹2 per extra 5 kg
- **Heavy & Bulky:** ₹26 per unit sold

Verified against the fee-definitions text on sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing, 4 August 2026.

Easy to miss, applies to every single unit

This is billed separately from the delivery fee, so people forget it. It applies to **every FBA unit you sell**. Give it its own line in your margin sheet — do not fold it into shipping.

8.6 Storage fee (FBA only)

VERIFIED **₹50 per cubic foot per month** — Amazon's own wording, confirmed on the live page. Rates rise during the October–December peak.

Verified against the fee-definitions text on sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing, 4 August 2026.

The aged-stock clock starts earlier than you may expect

VERIFIED The aged-inventory surcharge moved to **181 days** on **16 January 2026**, down from 271 — a full 90 days earlier. Guidance still quoting 271 or 365 days is out of date.

Sources: Parker-Lambert on the 181-day change · Adbrew — aged inventory surcharge 2026. These sources describe Amazon's global rate card. CHECK LIVE Confirm the India figure on your own Inventory Age dashboard.

What to do about it: if you were planning a 9-month stock runway, cut it. Send a small test batch for any new product and restock based on how fast it actually sells. Watch the Inventory Age report and discount or remove stock before it crosses the threshold.

8.7 Removal and disposal fees

VERIFIED Charged **per unit**, if you ask Amazon to send unsold stock back to you:

Size	Standard shipping	Expedited shipping
Standard	₹10	₹30

Size	Standard shipping	Expedited shipping
Heavy & Bulky	₹100	₹100

Disposal fees apply if you ask Amazon to scrap stock instead of returning it. CHECK LIVE — the disposal rate is not on the public fee page, so check it in Seller Central at the time you request removal.

8.8 GST and TCS on fees

VERIFIED **18% GST applies to every fee in this chapter** — referral, closing, weight handling, pick & pack, storage, removal. It is added on top of the fee. It is not charged on your sale price.

VERIFIED **TCS is 0.5%**, withheld from your sales and claimable back as input tax credit. See 5.3. It affects cash flow, not profit.

> **A quick example of how GST on fees works**
>
> Say your fees on one sale are ₹18 closing + ₹40 weight handling + ₹17 pick & pack = ₹75. GST at 18% on ₹75 is **₹13.50**. Amazon deducts **₹88.50** from your settlement, not ₹75 — so for cash-flow purposes, budget the full ₹88.50.

> **But that ₹13.50 is not a cost — and this cuts both ways**
>
> An earlier edition of this book called ₹88.50 "the true cost of those fees". For a GST-registered seller that is wrong, and the same section already says the right thing about TCS. **The GST Amazon charges on its fees is input tax credit.** You offset it against your own GST liability, exactly like the TCS. It hits your cash flow, not your profit. Counting it as a cost overstates your costs by about **₹21.60 a unit** at your fee level.
>
> **Now the error in the other direction, which is larger.** This section says GST "is not charged on your sale price". True in the sense that Amazon does not add 18% on top of your ₹333 — the customer pays ₹333, full stop. But **your ₹333 is GST-inclusive, and you must remit that GST out of it.** On an 18% product, ₹333 breaks into ₹282.20 of revenue and **₹50.80 of output GST that is not yours to keep**. Your real revenue per unit is ₹282.20.
>
> **The two do not cancel.** Reclaiming ₹21.60 while remitting ₹50.80 leaves you about **₹29 a unit worse off** than a sheet that ignores both — before any input credit on the wire itself. Every margin figure elsewhere in this book uses ₹333 as revenue, so read them as *before* this adjustment.
>
> VERIFIED **Your rate is 18%.** Your listing's External Product Information field carries HSN code **72179099** — heading 7217, wire of iron or non-alloy steel, which attracts **18% GST**. So your ₹333 is ₹282.20 of revenue plus **₹50.80 of output GST**. research/account/unit_economics.py now uses 18%.
>
> RESOLVED **This was a live gap and it has been closed.** The listing's Product Tax Code field was *empty* — showing only the placeholder "Example: A_GEN_NOTAX". The PTC is what tells Amazon which GST rate to apply when it collects tax on your behalf, so a blank field means no assurance the right rate is being collected, and any mismatch against what you declare in GSTR-1 lands on you at filing time.
>
> It was set to A_GEN_TAX on 5 August 2026, matching HSN 72179099 at 18%. **One thing still to do:** have your CA confirm that code against the HSN on your next GSTR-1, since this is the one item here where a wrong answer is a tax problem rather than a fee problem.

8.9 Your STEP level — the discount tier you are already in

Amazon automatically places every seller into a performance tier called STEP, and that tier changes what you pay. Two sellers shipping identical parcels pay different weight-handling fees because of it. Almost no guide covers this.

VERIFIED There are four levels — **Basic, Standard, Advanced, Premium**. You are **enrolled automatically**; there is nothing to sign up for. Every new seller starts at **Standard**.

Source: sell.amazon.in/grow-your-business/step, read 4 August 2026.

> **Confirmed from your own STEP dashboard**
>
> VERIFIED Your dashboard reads **"You are in Standard level"**, based on performance from 1 April to 30 June 2026 and applicable until **4 October 2026**. Next evaluation: **5 October 2026**. Every weight-handling figure in this book therefore applies to you as written.
>
> A neat cross-check that the rate card and the STEP page agree: your dashboard says Standard gets **₹4 off weight handling** and Advanced gets **₹6 off**. The rate card's first-500 g National rates are Basic ₹69, Standard ₹65, Advanced ₹63 — differences of exactly ₹4 and ₹6. Two independent Amazon sources, same numbers.
>
> **What is actually blocking your promotion to Advanced.** Your quality metrics are already perfect — Service Quality Score 100/100, cancellation, late dispatch and return rate all 0.00%, all marked "Reached". Two eligibility gates are not met: **Minimum Active Offers — you have 1, the target is 5**, and Local In-Stock is 5.71% against a 20% target. So Advanced is not blocked by anything you are doing badly; it is blocked by having **one product**. Four more live listings would unlock ₹6 off weight handling and ₹3,540 of Service Provider Network credits.

What each level gets you

Benefit	Basic	Standard (you)	Advanced	Premium
Weight handling fee waiver	None	**₹4**	₹6	₹6
Refund fee waiver	None	Up to **₹10**	Up to ₹30	Up to ₹30
Long-term storage fee waiver	None	None	None	**20% off**
Payment reserve period	10 days	**7 days**	7 days	**3 days**
Disbursement cycle	Weekly	**Weekly**	Weekly	**Daily**
Account management	No	No	On criteria	Guaranteed
Service Provider Network credits	No	No	Worth ₹3,540	Worth ₹7,080
Seller Connect event invitations	No	No	Yes	Yes
Priority 24×7 support	No	No	No	Yes

Verified from Amazon's STEP programme benefits table, 4 August 2026.

Where you stand right now, and what it is worth

On **Standard** you already have the ₹4 weight-handling waiver and the 7-day payment reserve — which is exactly why Chapter 3.2 says you are paid 7 days after delivery. That figure is **your level's figure**, not a universal rule. A Basic seller waits 10 days.

The waiver is already baked into the rates in 8.4. That is why your National first-500 g rate is **₹65** while a Basic seller pays **₹69** — a ₹4 difference, exactly the waiver.

Your actual STEP position, from the dashboard VERIFIED

You are at **Standard**, based on performance from 1 April to 30 June 2026, and those benefits hold until **4 October 2026**. Next evaluation: **5 October 2026**. Your current benefits show as **₹4 off weight handling** and a **7-day payment reserve** — exactly as this table predicts.

Your performance metrics are outstanding. Cancellation rate 0%, late dispatch 0%, seller-controllable returns 0%, out-of-stock 0%, listing quality 100%, Prime views 100%, Service Quality Score 100/100. Every quality gate is already met.

What is actually blocking you from Advanced

Not quality — **scale**. Two eligibility gates and two growth metrics:

Requirement	You have	Target	Status
Minimum orders	54	30	**Met**
Minimum active offers	**1**	**5**	**Not met — this is your blocker**
Local in-stock %	5.71%	20%	Not met
Net sales (either one)	₹9,231 / 27 units	₹5,00,000 / 2,000 units	Far off

The single most useful thing: you need **5 active listings** and you have 1. Amazon's own dashboard also nudges you to add listings and flags a **New Seller Incentive worth ₹41,000** that is worth reading before you spend more on ads. Adding 4 more products moves you toward Advanced *and* spreads your risk off a single SKU.

What moving up is actually worth to you

Move	What changes	Worth it?
Standard -> Advanced	Weight handling waiver rises ₹4 -> ₹6 (₹2 saved per shipment). Refund fee waiver rises ₹10 -> ₹30. Plus ₹3,540 of Service Provider Network credits, account management and event invitations.	**Yes.** At 300 orders a month the ₹2 alone is ₹600, and the ₹3,540 credit is real money.
Advanced -> Premium	Payment reserve drops 7 -> **3 days** and disbursement becomes **daily** instead of weekly. 20% off long-term storage. ₹7,080 credits. Priority support.	**Big cash-flow win.** Daily payouts at 3 days versus weekly at 7 roughly halves the cash tied up in transit.

How you move up

VERIFIED STEP is judged on **seller-controllable metrics** — Amazon names cancellation rate, late dispatch rate and return rate among others. Evaluation is **quarterly**: your performance last quarter sets your level by the **5th day of the next quarter**.

> **The practical takeaway**
>
> Because you use FBA, Amazon handles dispatch — so **late dispatch and cancellation rates are largely out of your hands and should already be strong**. That makes **return rate** your main lever, which comes back to accurate listings, honest photos and correct sizing information (Chapter 20).
>
> **Check your STEP dashboard in Seller Central.** It shows your current level, the metrics behind it, and Amazon's own customised recommendations for reaching the next one. Since evaluation is quarterly, acting early in a quarter matters more than acting late.

UNCONFIRMED Amazon also mentions an extra weight-handling fee waiver for enabling **Sunday Shipout**. If you can support Sunday dispatch, it is worth asking about.

9 · Your Product, Worked Out

Rope wire for cloth drying, ₹333, FBA, dispatched from Telangana, Standard STEP level. Every fee below is now verified. Only two things remain unknown, and both take minutes to settle.

9.0 Your verified measurements VERIFIED

Read from your listing's Offer and Product Details tabs on 4 August 2026.

Field	Value	Consequence
Package dimensions	4.4 × 13.3 × 13.4 cm	Volumetric weight = 784 cm^3 ÷ 5000 = **157 g**
Package weight	**0.46 kg (460 g)**	Actual beats volumetric, so you are billed on 460 g
Chargeable weight	**460 g**	**Inside the first 500 g band — the cheapest one.** Good news: ₹39 Regional / ₹65 National.
Item weight (product only)	440 g	Packaging adds just 20 g — already efficient
SKU / FNSKU	BSNY-WIRE-22M / X002M6Y2YD	—
MRP field	₹499	Check the physical label shows the same figure (Chapter 8)
HSN code declared	**72179099**	Iron/steel wire. Confirm the GST rate you charge matches this code.
Stock on hand	139 at HYD3 + 2 at HYD8 = **141**	~4–5 months cover at 32 units/month. Storage ~ **₹195/ month** (3.9 cu ft).
Sales rank	206,080 in Home & Kitchen	Low visibility — expected this early

Resolved: you are on a Home fee category, not Wires

Your Offer tab shows **Product Type: WIRE**, and your browse path is Home & Kitchen -> Laundry Organization -> Clotheslines. That left open whether Amazon billed you under “Wires (Electrical Wires/ cables for house wiring, ad hoc usage)” — a ₹44 per unit question.

VERIFIED **Answered from your Fee Preview for SKU BSNY-WIRE-22M: referral fee ₹0.00, closing fee ₹18.00.** Wires would have been ₹33.30 referral plus ₹22 closing. You are on a **Home fee category**.

Nothing to do. Do not raise a catalogue correction — there is nothing to correct. The Wires column below is kept only to show what it would have cost.

9.1 Amazon's cut per unit, both scenarios VERIFIED

Fee category	Zone	Fees	+18% GST	Total	Share
Home — confirmed (₹0 referral, ₹18 closing)	Regional	₹89.00	₹16.02	**₹105.02**	31.5%
	National	₹120.00	₹21.60	**₹141.60**	42.5%
Wires — *ruled out* (₹33.30 referral, ₹22 closing)	Regional	₹126.30	₹22.73	₹149.03	44.8%
	National	₹157.30	₹28.31	₹185.61	55.7%

> **These figures were revised upward — here is why**
>
> An earlier edition showed ₹87.32 Regional and ₹118.00 National, using the **first-500 g** weight handling rates of ₹39 and ₹65 on a 450 g product. VERIFIED Amazon actually bills this SKU in the **500 g – 1 kg** band: ₹54 Regional and ₹85 National.
>
> Two independent confirmations from your own account. Your **Fee Preview** states weight handling of ₹85.00 and a fee total of ₹120.00. And order **171-6493128** on 3 July was charged **₹105.02**, which is exactly (₹18 + ₹54 + ₹17) × 1.18 — the Regional row above. Amazon bills on *outbound* weight, which includes the packaging it adds, so a 450 g product crosses the 500 g line by the time it ships.

All rows use pick & pack ₹17, Standard STEP level, and the 500 g – 1 kg weight band as actually billed. Getting the finished parcel under 500 g would save ₹15 Regional and ₹20 National per unit.

9.2 Fee detail

Line item	Amount	Basis
Selling price	₹333	—
Referral fee	**₹0** or ₹33.30 if classed as "Wires"	VERIFIED 0% up to ₹1,000 for Home categories. "Wires" is 0% only to ₹300, then 10%.
Closing fee	**₹18** or ₹22 if classed as "Wires"	VERIFIED "Home - Other Products" is in Group C -> ₹18 in the ₹301–500 band. "Wires (Electrical...)" is in Group ## -> ₹22. Both read from the live list, not inferred from a tier.
Weight handling	**₹54** Regional **₹85** National	VERIFIED Standard STEP, **500 g – 1 kg band as actually billed** — confirmed by your Fee Preview (₹85) and by order 171-6493128 (₹105.02 total = the ₹54 Regional row). The first-500 g rates of ₹39/₹65 do *not* apply, despite a 450 g product weight.
Pick & pack	**₹17**	VERIFIED Standard item up to 1 kg
Storage	₹50 per cubic foot / month	VERIFIED On stock held, not per sale
GST on fees	18% of the above	VERIFIED
TCS	₹1.67 withheld	VERIFIED 0.5% — refundable, **not a cost**

9.2 Amazon's total cut, four scenarios

Assuming a Home fee category (₹0 referral, ₹18 closing) and Standard STEP level. **Your listing quotes delivery to Mumbai**, which is Region 2 — so from Telangana a large share of your orders will be **National**, not Regional. Plan on the National rows.

Packed weight & destination	Fees	+18% GST	Amazon takes	Share of ₹333
Up to 500 g — Regional	₹74	₹13.32	**₹87.32**	**26%**
Up to 500 g — National	₹100	₹18.00	**₹118.00**	**35%**
500 g – 1 kg — Regional	₹89	₹16.02	**₹105.02**	**32%**
500 g – 1 kg — National	₹120	₹21.60	**₹141.60**	**43%**

Fees = closing (₹18) + weight handling + pick & pack (₹17). Storage excluded — it depends on how long stock sits, not on each sale.

The number that should change how you think

Amazon's cut ranges from **₹87 to ₹142** on the same product, decided by nothing but parcel weight and buyer location. That is **26% to 43% of your selling price** before you have paid for the rope.

Two consequences. **Weight is your biggest controllable cost** — keeping the packed coil under 500 g saves ₹15 Regional and ₹20 National per order versus 1 kg before GST (₹17.70 and ₹23.60 including it). And **distant orders earn far less**, which you cannot control. Price against the National figure, not the Regional one, or your average order will quietly underperform your spreadsheet.

9.3 Your two remaining actions

1. **Weigh the packed coil.** Under 500 g saves ₹15 per Regional order and ₹20 per National order versus the next band. If it is marginally over, tighter packing is free margin.
2. **Open Fee Preview and read the fee category name.** If it says “Wires (Electrical...)” instead of a Home category, you pay **₹33.30 referral plus a ₹22 closing fee** rather than ₹0 and ₹18 — about **₹44 more per sale including GST**. On 100 orders a month that is ₹4,400.

A worked profit figure

Take the middle case: under 500 g, National delivery, Home category. Amazon takes **₹118**, leaving **₹215** to cover rope, packaging, inbound freight, advertising and returns — and to be your profit.

If rope plus packaging costs ₹120, your net is about **₹95 a unit, roughly 29% margin** — comfortably above the 20% floor in Chapter 11. At ₹180 it is ₹35, about 10%, and not worth scaling.

10 · Choosing a Fulfilment Channel

Feature	FBA	Easy Ship	Self-Ship
Storage cost	Amazon fee (8.6)	You bear it	You bear it
Pick & pack cost	Amazon fee (8.5)	You bear it	You bear it
Delivery cost	Amazon fee (8.4)	Amazon fee (8.4)	You pay your courier
Pay on Delivery	Yes	Yes	No
Prime badge	Yes	Invitation only	No (except Local Shops)
Buy Box chances	Best	Lower	Lowest
Best suited to	Fast-moving items with decent margin	Own warehouse, tight margins, wide range	Own warehouse plus reliable local delivery

UNCONFIRMED Based on Amazon's published channel comparison table; wording not independently re-verified.

You are on FBA, which is the right default for a single fast-moving SKU: you get the Prime badge, the best Buy Box odds, and you are not packing parcels yourself. The trade-off is three separate fee lines and storage charges that punish slow stock.

11 · Pricing and Margin Calculator

Build this once as a spreadsheet, one row per product. Reuse it every time you consider a new item and every time Amazon changes its fees.

```
Net profit = Selling price
        - Product cost
        - Packaging
        - Inbound freight
        - Referral fee
        - Closing fee
        - Weight handling fee
        - Pick & pack fee
        - Storage (if applicable)
        - GST at 18% on all Amazon fees
        - Advertising
        - Expected return costs

Break-even price = Total cost ÷ (1 - referral fee %)
  (only needed where a % referral fee actually applies)
```

Columns your spreadsheet needs

Column	Where the number comes from
Selling price	Your decision
Product cost	Supplier invoice
Packaging	Actual cost per unit, including the label
Inbound freight per unit	Total freight ÷ units in the shipment
Fee category	Fee Preview — write down the exact name
Referral %	Appendix A, matched to that fee category
Closing fee	Fee Preview (do not guess above ₹500)
Weight handling	Revenue Calculator, using packed weight
Pick & pack	₹17 standard up to 1 kg
GST on fees	= 18% × (all Amazon fees)
Ad cost per unit	Ad spend ÷ units sold
Return allowance	Your category's return rate × cost per return
Net profit and net margin %	Calculated

> **The rule that protects you**
>
> If a product cannot clear roughly **20% net margin** after every line above, pass on it — no matter how good the sales volume looks. Volume on a thin-margin product just means you lose money faster and tie up cash doing it.

Rebuild this sheet whenever fees change. Amazon has revised its India fee schedule at least twice in the last two years, including the big March 2026 change.

12 · Money Words Explained

The terms you will hit as soon as you start advertising or add a second product.

12.1 Advertising numbers

```
ACOS  = Ad spend ÷ Ad sales × 100       (lower is better)
ROAS  = Ad sales ÷ Ad spend             (higher is better)
TACOS = Ad spend ÷ TOTAL sales × 100    (ads + organic together)
```

- **ACOS and ROAS say the same thing from opposite ends.** 25% ACOS is the same as 4× ROAS. Do not let a tool quoting one confuse you.
- **TACOS is the more honest number.** It shows what share of *all* your revenue goes to ads, not just the sales ads get credit for. If TACOS falls over months while ACOS stays flat, your organic sales are growing. That is the healthiest signal there is.

12.2 Profit numbers

```
Break-even price    = Total cost ÷ (1 - referral fee %)
Contribution margin = Selling price - all variable costs
ROI                 = Net profit ÷ total invested × 100
```

- **Contribution margin** tells you what one extra sale adds after variable costs. It is the number that decides whether to keep a product alive.
- **ROI** matters when two products compete for the same money. A product with 30% margin that sells out monthly beats one with 50% margin that takes a year to move.

12.3 Cash and stock health

Term	What it means for you
Working capital	Cash locked in unsold stock plus money Amazon has not paid you yet. Amazon holds funds until 7 days after delivery, so plan reorders around that lag.
Inventory turnover	How many times you sell through your average stock. Low turnover is normal for the first 4–6 weeks of a new product. If it stays low, that is information, not bad luck.
Dead stock	Stock sitting long enough that storage fees eat the margin. With the surcharge now starting at 181 days, this bites sooner than it used to.
Cash conversion cycle	Time from paying your supplier to receiving Amazon's settlement. The longer it is, the more cash buffer you need.

> **Track these together, not one at a time**
>
> A product with a great margin and terrible turnover still drains your cash. A product with a thin margin that sells out every month can fund your growth. Neither number tells the story alone.

13 · Open vs Gated Categories

Most categories are open to any registered seller from day one. A smaller set need Amazon's approval first — this is called **gating**. It exists where there is a safety, authenticity or legal risk.

13.1 Usually open

- **Home & Kitchen and Home Improvement** — your current category
- Office Products
- Sports & Fitness (most sub-categories)
- Apparel & Footwear (most sub-categories)
- Toys & Games (most sub-categories; gating tightens around the festive quarter)
- Pet Supplies (most sub-categories)
- Automotive accessories and non-critical parts

13.2 Usually gated

Category	Why
Grocery & Gourmet Food	Safety, shelf life, FSSAI licensing
Jewellery & Watches	High value — counterfeit and fraud risk
Health supplements, OTC medicine, regulated healthcare (menstrual cups, contact lenses, diagnostic kits)	Health claims and regulatory approval
Automotive parts, batteries, hazmat-adjacent items	Safety and dangerous-goods handling
Selected toys and baby/children's sub-categories	Child safety certification
Products belonging to a brand in Brand Registry	You need a supplier invoice or brand authorisation

UNCONFIRMED Gating is decided per product and changes over time. **CHECK LIVE** always.

13.3 How to ask for approval

1. Seller Central -> Catalogue -> Add Products -> search the ASIN or category
2. Click **Listing Limitations** -> **Request Approval**

3. Upload supplier invoices (usually dated within about 90 days) plus any certificate required
4. Track it in your Seller Central case log. Approval takes days to a few weeks.

> **Build history first**
>
> Get 60–90 days of clean order history in an open category before you attempt a gated one. Approval odds improve with account age and a healthy record. Applying on day one with no history is the most common way to get refused.

14 · Banned and Restricted Products

This list is illustrative, not complete. Always check Amazon's own Restricted Products pages before you source anything you are unsure about.

- Illegal drugs, weapons, ammunition, explosives
- Counterfeit goods, or branded goods you are not authorised to sell
- Stolen goods
- Hazardous or recalled products without the required certification
- Anything infringing a patent, trademark or copyright
- Human body parts or organs; endangered wildlife products
- Obscene or offensive material

Check before you buy, not after

CHECK LIVE Seller Central -> Help -> search “Restricted Products”. Reversing a sourcing decision costs you a supplier conversation. Reversing a suspended listing costs you weeks and possibly your account.

15 · Product Research

A repeatable check to run before you spend money on any new product.

What to check	What good looks like
Demand	A steady Best Sellers Rank over time, not one spike. One spike usually means a sale event or a fad.
Competition	The top 3–5 listings ideally under roughly 500–1,000 reviews. Thousands of reviews means you cannot catch up on trust alone.
Margin	At least about 20% net after *every* fee in Chapter 8, at a price people actually pay.
Weight and size	Lighter and more compact means cheaper delivery, cheaper pick & pack, cheaper storage, and less damage in transit.
Compliance	Confirm gating (13) and labelling feasibility (7) *before* you place the order.

15.1 Free research you can do today

- **Amazon Best Sellers and Movers & Shakers** pages, by category
- **“Customers also bought”** on products next to yours — shows real buying patterns
- **1-star to 3-star reviews on category leaders.** This is the single richest free source there is. People tell you exactly what is wrong with the current products. Fix that and you have a reason to exist.

15.2 Paid tools

Helium 10, Jungle Scout and AMZScout are built primarily for the US market. Their India data is weaker, but the trends are still useful. Worth paying for only once you are sourcing at volume — not for your first or second product.

16 · Can You Legally Sell It?

Run every new product through this before ordering. The important question is not “can I make money on this” — it is **“am I allowed to sell this at all”**.

Question	Applies to	Where to check
Is the category gated?	Grocery, jewellery, supplements, automotive parts, some toys and baby items	Chapter 13
Does it need BIS certification?	Electricals, switches, wires and cables, pressure cookers, toys with electronics, helmets, LED products	bis.gov.in
Does it need an FSSAI licence?	Any food, drink or consumable, including supplements	foscos.fssai.gov.in
Does it need CDSCO approval?	Medical devices — glucometers, BP monitors, thermometers	cdsco.gov.in
Is it hazmat / dangerous goods?	Batteries, aerosols, flammable liquids, magnets, chemicals, pressurised containers	Seller Central -> Help -> Hazmat
Does it need a barcode (GTIN)?	Any product new to Amazon	Chapter 19
Does your brand name clash with a trademark?	Own-brand products	ipindiaonline.gov.in
Can you meet labelling rules?	**Every pre-packed product**	Chapter 7
Do you have manufacturer details on file?	Every product	Supplier invoice
Is shelf life or expiry relevant?	Food, cosmetics, supplements, batteries	Supplier spec sheet

16.1 Worked example — your rope wire

Check	Answer
Gated?	**No.** Home & Kitchen is open.
BIS?	**Probably not.** BIS covers electrical wire for house wiring, not a non-electrical clothesline. But get your supplier to confirm in writing that it is not sold or described as an electrical product. *Note: this also affects your fee category — see 8.2.*
FSSAI / CDSCO?	No. Not food, not a medical device.
Hazmat?	No.
Barcode?	Check whether the supplier's packaging already has a GS1 barcode. If not, apply for GTIN exemption (19.1).
Labelling?	**Yes.** Net length, manufacturer address, MRP, month/year of packing, consumer care contact.
EPR plastic?	**Likely exempt if micro/small.** You use poly bag or shrink wrap. Exemption confirmed under Rule 4A (2024) for micro/small enterprises — verify your Udyam classification. See 17.5.

16.2 Worked example — an LED bulb (a tempting next product)

Check	Answer
Gated?	LED bulbs sit in an open fee category (14% above ₹1,000, 0% below — verified). But that is a *fee* question, not a legal one.
BIS?	**Yes.** LED lighting falls under mandatory BIS registration. You cannot legally sell without it.
Hazmat?	No, unless a variant contains a lithium battery.
Labelling?	Yes — wattage, lumens, manufacturer details, MRP.

Why this example is in the book

An LED bulb looks like an easy win: open category, 0% referral fee under ₹1,000. And it is **illegal to sell without BIS registration**. The fee table and the legal check are two completely separate questions. A product can pass one and fail the other. Always run both.

16.3 Does this product already belong to someone else?

A different question from everything above. Not “can this category be sold” but “does this specific item already have an owner”. Skipping this is how sellers become accidental counterfeiters and get an IP complaint in week one.

Step	How	Where
Search the exact product on Amazon	If a near-identical listing shows a “Visit the [X] Store” link, it is brand-protected. You cannot list a copy without authorisation.	amazon.in search
Look up who owns the barcode	If your supplier gives you a GTIN, check which company it is licensed to. If that is not your supplier, the packaging may belong to another brand.	verify.gs1.org (replaced GEPIR in Jan 2024)
Search the name printed on the product	Not just *your* brand name — also whatever is already printed on the item.	ipindiaonline.gov.in
Ask the supplier in writing	“Is this unbranded/white-label, or does it carry a trademark I would need permission to resell?” Get it on the invoice, not in a chat.	Supplier
Reverse image search the photos	Catches suppliers passing off a copy of a branded item as “generic”.	Google Lens / TinEye

If it turns out to be branded

You have exactly two honest options: **(1)** get a Letter of Authorisation or a GST invoice from an authorised distributor and go through Amazon's approval process for that brand, or **(2)** source an unbranded version instead and avoid the problem. There is no third path where you quietly list someone else's brand.

17 · Compliance by Regulator

For your current Home & Kitchen product, only Chapter 7 labelling definitely applies — plus possibly EPR plastic (17.5). This chapter is for your **next** product.

17.1 BIS — Compulsory Registration Scheme

UNCONFIRMED Covers 400+ product categories: electronics and IT, electrical goods, steel, chemicals, food-contact equipment, textiles, toys, helmets, cement. It applies the moment you source anything electrical, electronic, or a toy with electronic parts.

VERIFIED Penalties sit in **Sections 28 and 29 of the BIS Act, 2016**. Section 28 covers misuse of the Standard Mark; Section 29 covers selling goods required to conform to a standard without doing so. Both carry the same penalty for a first offence: imprisonment up to **2 years**, a fine of **at least ₹2,00,000** — and note that ₹2 lakh is a *minimum*, not a cap — **or a penalty of up to ten times the value of the goods**. For a seller holding real stock, that last limb is the one that can hurt most.

Re-verified 7 August 2026 against multiple BIS enforcement reports citing both sections — New Indian Express (Section 28), Times of India (Section 29), The Hindu (Section 28).

UNCONFIRMED Repeat offences are widely reported as rising to 5 years and ₹5,00,000. That escalation was not confirmed against the Act itself. Marketplaces do actively remove non-compliant listings when BIS issues enforcement notices.

Register before you source, not after. Portal: bis.gov.in

17.2 FSSAI — food, drink and supplements

The update most guides still miss

VERIFIED With effect from **1 April 2026**, FSSAI raised the **Basic Registration threshold from ₹12 lakh to ₹1.5 crore** of annual turnover. State Licence now covers above ₹1.5 crore up to ₹50 crore. Central Licence applies above ₹50 crore.

VERIFIED And the bigger change, which the earlier edition of this book only gestured at: **registrations and licences now have perpetual validity.** The five-yearly renewal is gone. A licence stays valid indefinitely unless it is suspended, cancelled or voluntarily surrendered. If anyone tells you to budget for FSSAI renewals, they are working from the old regime.

Re-verified 4 August 2026 against the official reform press release (PDF), which states both the perpetual validity and the ₹12 lakh -> ₹1.5 crore change effective 1 April 2026. Corroborated by BusinessWorld, Livemint and NDTV. One outlet reported the threshold as effective 10 March; the official release says 1 April 2026, so that is the date used here.

The exception that overrides the thresholds

VERIFIED Selling food online puts you on the **Central Licence** route regardless of turnover. FSSAI's own FoSCoS guide for e-commerce applicants directs them to select Central Licence, and an e-commerce FBO is defined as any food business operating through the medium of e-commerce. So a small Amazon food seller does **not** get cheap Basic Registration just because revenue is low — the ₹1.5 crore threshold above will not save you here.

Re-verified 4 August 2026 against FSSAI's own portal guide, How to apply for a licence for E-Commerce (FoSCoS PDF), which instructs e-commerce applicants to apply for a central licence. One narrowing detail from FSSAI: state or city sub-offices of an e-commerce operator where *no* food business activity happens do not each need their own licence.

Still confirm your own case on FoSCoS before you list a food product. Getting this wrong means trading without a valid licence, which is a Section 63 offence.

UNCONFIRMED Penalties for operating without a valid licence: ₹2–5 lakh fine and up to 6 months imprisonment under Section 63 of the FSS Act. Applies to any food, drink or supplement — including home bakers and cloud kitchens.

Portal: foscos.fssai.gov.in

17.3 CDSCO — medical devices

A rule often stated too strictly

You will often read that since 1 October 2023 **every** class needs a licence with no exemptions left. That is stricter than the actual law.

VERIFIED The move to licensing happened in stages: **Class A and B from 1 October 2022**, and **Class C and D from 1 October 2023**. And CDSCO's own FAQ notes an exception: **Class A non-sterile, non-measuring devices need only registration**, not a licence.

Sources: CDSCO gazette summary · CDSCO Medical Devices FAQ

Devices are graded A to D by risk under the Medical Device Rules, 2017.

UNCONFIRMED Foreign manufacturers cannot apply directly. An Indian Authorised Agent holding a wholesale drug licence files on their behalf using Form MD-14, and the licence is issued as Form MD-15 through the SUGAM portal. Government fees are reported at roughly $1,000 for Class A, $3,000 for Class B, and $5,000 for Class C and D.

Practical advice: this is a heavy compliance load. If you ever add BP monitors, glucometers or thermometers, budget for a regulatory consultant rather than doing it yourself.

17.4 WPC — wireless devices (Bluetooth, Wi-Fi)

VERIFIED Bluetooth devices are **not exempt** from WPC Equipment Type Approval. But most consumer wireless accessories qualify for a much simpler **self-declaration** route through the Saral Sanchar portal, rather than the full licensing-office process.

VERIFIED The ETA fee is **₹10,000 per product** containing one or more RF modules.

Sources: DoT — ETA FAQ (fee) · Customs public notice on ETA by self-declaration

A detail often reported wrongly

Some guides list the excluded products as “drones and specialised cameras”. VERIFIED The actual excluded list is **radar, jammers, drones, and satellite equipment**. Cameras are not on it.

UNCONFIRMED Enforcement penalties have reportedly reached ₹50 lakh plus inventory seizure. Treat wireless compliance as a real risk, not a theoretical one.

17.5 EPR — plastic packaging

If you use poly bags, bubble wrap or shrink wrap — which you do, per Chapter 19 — you may fall under Extended Producer Responsibility, run by CPCB at eprplastic.cpcb.gov.in.

Clearer than previously stated — but still depends on your Udyam classification

VERIFIED The **2024 amendment to the Plastic Waste Management Rules (Rule 4A, PWM Amendment Rules 2024)** is what *created* the micro and small enterprise exemption — not what undermined it. CPCB confirmed this in an **October 2024 directive**, and multiple independent legal/policy sources describe it consistently. A subsequent **March 2026 amendment** deals with recycled-content mandates and is unrelated to the micro/small exemption.

An earlier edition of this section had the logic inverted, describing the 2024 amendment as "pointing the other way" against an exemption. That was wrong — the amendment is the legal basis *for* the exemption.

What remains uncertain for you specifically: whether BSNY qualifies as "micro" or "small" under the Udyam classification criteria. The exemption exists, but whether *you* qualify depends on your enterprise's investment and turnover. Check your Udyam registration certificate.

See: MPCB circular on registration of micro and small producers under PWM Rules 2024

What to actually do: check your Udyam classification. If you are micro or small, you are likely exempt from EPR plastic registration under the 2024 rules. If you are medium or large, you must register. If unsure, confirm with CPCB or an environmental compliance consultant — a cheap question to answer definitively.

17.6 EPR — batteries

VERIFIED The **Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022** exist and impose Extended Producer Responsibility: all waste batteries must be collected and sent for recycling or refurbishment, and disposal in landfill or by incineration is prohibited. Producers may do the collection themselves or authorise another entity.

Rules confirmed 4 August 2026 against the Government of India press release — PIB, Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022.

VERIFIED The detail that matters most to you: “Producer” is explicitly defined to include anyone selling a battery-containing product **under their own brand name**, not just the battery manufacturer. If you private-label a power bank or a battery toy, you are a Producer under these rules. This is confirmed across multiple independent legal sources and the Rules' own definitions. Given the penalty regime below, treat this seriously if you source any battery-containing product under your own brand.

UNCONFIRMED Registration is through CPCB's portal (eprbattery.cpcb.gov.in) using Form 1(A). No government fee for registration itself, but Producers must buy EPR certificates from registered recyclers in proportion to what they sell, at market-determined prices. Falling short triggers an Environmental Compensation penalty that you cannot settle later by buying certificates after the fact. Registration is valid 5 years.

17.7 Hallmarking — gold and silver

VERIFIED **Gold:** hallmarking is mandatory for gold jewellery and artefacts since **23 June 2021**, with **9-carat added from 1 July 2025**. Every piece needs a 6-digit HUID number generated at a BIS-registered centre before sale. Coverage has expanded in phases to **385 districts** as of the 2026 amendment.

Source: BIS — Hallmarking order, 2026 second amendment, 385 districts

Silver: the answer is "voluntary"

You will find credible-looking sources flatly contradicting each other on silver. The question is answerable.

VERIFIED Silver hallmarking is **voluntary**. A HUID-based voluntary system began on **1 September 2025** under revised standard **IS 2112:2025**, bringing silver in line with gold for traceability. BIS has said it is **planning a phased move toward making it mandatory**, but no date has been announced.

Sources: Economic Times — voluntary silver hallmarking begins · ET Retail — BIS plans phased move to mandatory

Sources claiming silver became mandatory in September 2025 are wrong — they confuse the start of the voluntary HUID system with a mandate.

17.8 Textiles and clothing labelling

UNCONFIRMED This is not a separate regulator — it is part of the same Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011 from Chapter 7. Pre-packed textiles need the standard declarations.

UNCONFIRMED Garments sold **loose** (folded on a shelf, not sealed) were historically outside Legal Metrology entirely. The Third Amendment Rules, 2022, effective **1 January 2023**, introduced a specific labelling requirement for loose garments: name and address of the manufacturer, marketer, brand owner or importer, country of origin, and size in international indicators (S/M/L/XL).

CHECK LIVE A draft regulation from the Textiles Committee was circulating in March 2026 that would add a more detailed textile-specific labelling regime. It was still a **draft**. Do not build compliance around a draft — but watch for it if you move into apparel.

17.9 DGFT — Import Export Code (IEC)

VERIFIED An IEC is mandatory for **any** commercial import into India, whatever the shipment value. DGFT states it plainly: no person shall import or export except under an IEC number granted by DGFT, unless specifically exempted. Exemptions are narrow — personal-use imports, government bodies, and notified categories. If you ever source from Alibaba or 1688 instead of a domestic supplier, you need one.

Re-verified 4 August 2026 against DGFT's own portal — dgft.gov.in, IEC profile management.

UNCONFIRMED Applied for on dgft.gov.in, costs ₹500 once, issued in about 1–3 working days, valid for life — **but every holder must complete an annual update between April and June**. Miss that window and the IEC is deactivated automatically until you reactivate it.

After you have the IEC, you also need to register your bank's AD Code at your import port and register on ICEGATE for customs filing. Both are one-time steps per port.

17.10 Amazon's own Hazmat programme

Separate from every government regulator above. Amazon independently classifies batteries, aerosols, flammables, chemicals and magnets as dangerous goods. CHECK LIVE Seller Central -> Help -> Hazmat.

17.11 Before you move on

- Correct regulator identified for *this specific product*, not the broad category
- Licence or registration obtained **before** placing a bulk order
- Import route confirmed — IEC needed only if sourcing from outside India
- Penalty exposure understood and compliance cost built into your margin sheet
- EPR plastic position confirmed (17.5) — do not assume exemption

18 · Finding and Vetting Suppliers

18.1 Where to look

Platform	Best for	Watch out for
IndiaMART	Domestic manufacturers and wholesalers, low minimum orders	Fastest place to start — no import paperwork. Quality varies hugely; always sample.
TradeIndia	Similar to IndiaMART	Good for comparing quotes across several domestic suppliers
Udaan	Domestic wholesale, including Home & Kitchen	Sign up with your GSTIN. Users report product mismatches and GST/HSN invoicing problems — check what arrives against what you ordered before reordering.
Alibaba	Overseas manufacturers, larger minimum orders	Adds import and customs compliance (17.9) on top of everything else
1688	Alibaba's China-domestic platform, often cheaper	Usually needs a sourcing agent. Not built for overseas buyers.
Factory visits / trade fairs	Highest trust, best for large orders	Worth it once volume justifies the travel

18.2 Words suppliers will use

Term	What it means
MOQ	Minimum Order Quantity — the smallest batch they will make or sell. Usually negotiable, especially for a trial.
OEM	They manufacture to *your* design and specification.
ODM	They already have a design; you customise branding or small features on top.
QC	Quality Control — inspection before shipping. Do it yourself, or hire an agency for larger orders.
Sampling	Ordering and physically testing one unit before committing to a bulk order.
Freight	Getting goods from supplier to you. Domestic is simple road freight; overseas adds sea or air freight plus customs.

18.3 Negotiation checklist

Get quotes from **at least 3 suppliers** before committing

Ask for MOQ flexibility on the first order — many will lower it for a trial run

Always order a sample, even from a supplier you trust

Confirm in writing who pays for freight

Agree payment terms — part advance plus part on delivery is safer than full advance

Ask directly whether the product already has a GS1 barcode, or whether you will need a GTIN exemption

Get written confirmation the product carries no existing trademark (16.3)

Never pay 100% in advance to a new supplier

This is the single most common way new sellers lose their sourcing capital — regardless of how good the quoted price is. A supplier who refuses any part-payment structure on a first order is telling you something.

Domestic vs overseas — the real dividing line

Source domestically (IndiaMART, TradeIndia, Udaan, factory visits) and you stay inside the rules already covered in Chapters 5, 16 and 17. The moment you consider Alibaba, 1688 or any overseas supplier, you add **DGFT/IEC plus customs** to your checklist — before you send money.

19 · Packaging and Barcodes

19.1 Do you actually need to buy a barcode?

Two different barcodes matter, and people confuse them constantly.

Barcode	What it is	Do you need it?
GTIN (also called UPC or EAN)	A global product ID issued by GS1. Identifies the *product* worldwide.	Needed for most new listings — unless you get an exemption
FNSKU	Amazon's own internal barcode. Identifies *your* unit in *Amazon's* warehouse.	**Always**, on every FBA unit

- **If your product already has a manufacturer-issued GS1 barcode** — use it as-is. Do not create a new one.
- **If it is genuinely unbranded, handmade, private-label, or a bundle you made** — you likely qualify for a **GTIN exemption** and can skip buying a barcode.

VERIFIED How the exemption works: it is granted **per brand, per category** — not account-wide. Apply during listing creation: Catalogue -> Add Products -> “I'm adding a product not sold on Amazon” -> tick “I don't have a Product ID” -> submit your brand name plus **2–9 images** of the product and its packaging.

The three things that get exemptions rejected

1. **Renders instead of photographs.** VERIFIED The images must be real-world photos — the product physically held or placed on a table. Mockups, catalogue renders, watermarked or visibly edited images are rejected.
2. **Brand not permanently on the product.** If you are claiming a brand, the branding must be **permanently affixed to the product itself**, not just printed on a label or shown in the listing. A sticker will not do.
3. **Typing the brand or category differently later.** VERIFIED When you create the listing you must enter the category and brand **exactly** as they appear on the approval notice — same capitalisation, no extra spaces or characters — or Amazon will not recognise the exemption and the listing will error.

If you are not the brand owner you also need a Letter of Authorisation.

Verified 4 August 2026 against Amazon's own seller guide, How to apply for a GTIN Exemption (PDF), plus Seller Forums guidance on image requirements and exact-match entry. UNCONFIRMED Turnaround is reported anywhere from 24–48 hours to 48–72 hours; treat it as “a couple of days” rather than a promise.

One thing to think about before relying on exemption

A GTIN exemption is an **Amazon-only shortcut**, not a real product identity. If you ever plan to sell the same item on Flipkart, in physical shops, or export it, buy a proper GS1 India barcode instead.

Never buy a cheap barcode from an unofficial reseller. Amazon checks ownership against the GS1 database. A mismatched barcode gets your listing suppressed, and you will have paid for the privilege.

19.2 The FNSKU placement rule

You can print and apply FNSKU labels yourself, or pay Amazon a per-unit fee to do it (FBA Label Service).

The rule that gets inbound shipments rejected

Your FNSKU label must **not cover any Legal Metrology declaration** — not the manufacturer address, not the net quantity, not the MRP. Decide where the label goes **while designing your packaging artwork**. Discovering the clash after you have printed 5,000 poly bags is an expensive lesson.

19.3 Packaging by product type

Product type	What to use
Fragile, glass, ceramic	Bubble wrap plus a rigid outer carton, cushioning on all sides
Clothing and soft goods	Poly bag for moisture protection, inside a mailer or box
Coiled or flexible items — rope, cable (yours)	**Poly bag or shrink wrap** to stop tangling and abrasion in transit
Electronics	Anti-static bag, foam inserts, rigid box
Bulk cartons going to the FC	Master carton with a carton label showing contents, quantity and FNSKU/ASIN reference

19.4 Packaging is a fee lever, not a side cost

Every gram and centimetre feeds straight into your weight handling fee (8.4), pick & pack fee (8.5) and storage fee (8.6).

- **Use the smallest box that protects the product.** Empty space increases volumetric weight without protecting anything. Remember: length × breadth × height ÷ 5000.
- **Weigh and measure the finished parcel**, not the bare product. That is what Amazon bills against.
- **Compress or vacuum-pack** where the product allows it — this cuts both delivery and storage costs at once.
- **Re-measure after any packaging change.** A small increase in the longest side or girth can tip a product into the Heavy & Bulky tier, which changes both the delivery and pick & pack formulas.

20 · Returns and Getting Reimbursed

Returns hit your real margin harder than most sellers expect. A healthy-looking profit per unit can vanish in a category with a high return rate.

20.1 Return windows and refunds

UNCONFIRMED Return windows are set per product and category and are shown on the product page itself — for example "10 Days Returnable". Most non-exempt categories fall in a 7–30 day window. Some categories are explicitly non-returnable.

A product is returnable within its window if it is damaged, has missing parts, is defective, or is materially different from the listing description.

UNCONFIRMED Amazon reportedly starts a refund once the item is received back at a fulfilment centre, and processes the refund request within 13 days of successful pickup. CHECK LIVE — I did not verify the 13-day figure.

20.2 What returns cost you

The asymmetry nobody explains up front

VERIFIED On a refund, Amazon returns the referral fee you paid **minus a "refund administration fee"**, which is the **lesser of a fixed cap or 20% of the referral fee**. The weight handling fee and the pick & pack fee are **not** returned at all. So a returned unit costs you the outbound delivery, the picking labour, and possibly a removal or disposal fee if it comes back unsellable.

What this actually costs you — which is nothing

The refund administration fee is 20% *of the referral fee*. Your referral fee at ₹333 in a Home category is **₹0** (Chapter 8). Twenty per cent of zero is zero, so **this particular fee cannot touch you at your current price point.** It starts to matter the day you list something above ₹1,000, where referral fees switch on. What does hurt you on every return, today, is the weight handling and pick & pack you never get back.

UNCONFIRMED The cap is quoted as US$5 on Amazon's US seller forums; the rupee figure for Amazon.in was not confirmed. Since 20% of your referral fee is currently ₹0, the cap does not affect you either way — but check it before pricing above ₹1,000.

This is why a 20% return rate is far worse than a 20% discount. Build a return allowance into your margin sheet (Chapter 11).

20.3 A-to-Z Guarantee

Covers customers on seller-fulfilled orders when a seller cannot resolve a missing, damaged or materially different item within 3 business days. Since you use FBA, Amazon handles the customer-facing return process directly — so this mainly matters if you ever add a Self-Ship or Easy Ship product.

20.4 Getting Amazon's own mistakes paid back — two different systems

> **An earlier edition of this book got this wrong**
>
> It said SAFE-T claims are how **FBA** sellers recover stock lost or damaged in a fulfilment centre. VERIFIED They are not. SAFE-T covers **seller-fulfilled** orders. File a SAFE-T claim for FBA warehouse loss and it will be rejected, because you used the wrong system.
>
> You are on FBA, so **the second table below is yours.**

SAFE-T — for seller-fulfilled orders only

SAFE-T stands for Seller Assurance For E-commerce Transactions. It lets you appeal a refund **Amazon issued** on a seller-fulfilled order, most often a return using an Amazon-issued prepaid return label. It matters to you only if you later add an Easy Ship or Self-Ship product.

Point	Detail
Filing window	UNCONFIRMED FOR INDIA **30 days** — reported as reduced from 60 days with effect from **16 February 2026**. The clock reportedly starts at the return delivery scan at your premises or the refund date, whichever is *later*; for a lost shipment, from the last tracking scan. **Caveat:** every source confirming this 60-to-30-day compression describes *US seller-fulfilled orders specifically*. No India-specific confirmation has been found — Amazon's own seller-forum posts discussing the change reference Amazon.com, not Amazon.in. The window on Amazon India may still be 60 days, or it may have changed silently. CHECK LIVE Verify the current window in your own Seller Central SAFE-T Claims page before relying on either number.
Wait before filing	UNCONFIRMED Reported as 15 business days after the refund is issued, for return-related claims.
Who must have refunded	VERIFIED **Amazon** must have initiated the refund. If *you* issued the refund yourself, the SAFE-T claim is denied.

CHECK LIVE Amazon also shortened the window for sellers to assess a seller-fulfilled return before Amazon refunds automatically. Both timers moved together in early 2026, so check the current numbers in Seller Central before relying on either.

FBA reimbursement claims — this is the one for you

For stock Amazon lost or damaged while it held it, the route is an **FBA reimbursement claim**, not SAFE-T. This covers:

- Stock damaged or lost inside a fulfilment centre
- Stock lost in transit between fulfilment centres
- Customer returns processed incorrectly, or the wrong item taken back
- Stock disposed of incorrectly
- Fee and charge disputes

VERIFIED For FBA *customer-return* claims the window is **45 to 105 days** after the customer refund or replacement date — and deliberately **not before 45 days**, to leave the customer time to send the item back. So the FBA timing is almost the opposite of SAFE-T's: with SAFE-T you must move fast, with FBA returns you must wait. CHECK LIVE Amazon has been tightening these windows (it was 60–120 days in mid-2024), so confirm the current window before you file.

File from Seller Central against the relevant order or shipment, attaching shipment IDs, inventory records and photos.

Amazon will not tell you when it owes you money

Check your **Inventory Adjustment Report** and **Reimbursements Report** every month. Look for entries flagged *Lost — Warehouse* or *Damaged — Warehouse* that have not been reimbursed. Nobody sends you a notification.

The distinction that decides your claim: “warehouse-damaged” is generally reimbursable. “customer-damaged” generally is not. Read the condition notes carefully before filing.

20.5 The claim type most new sellers never file: inbound receiving shortages

When you send stock in, Amazon records two numbers against the shipment: **units expected** (what you said you sent) and **units located** (what it found and booked in). When *located* is lower than *expected*, the difference is stock you paid for and can never sell. Amazon does not email you about it. The gap just sits in the shipment record.

Your June shipment is two units short

VERIFIED You created three FBA shipments in June. Only one actually shipped:

Shipment ID	Created	Status	Expected	Located	Inbound fee
FBA15LXQVV97	16 Jun	Cancelled	0	0	₹0.00
FBA15LXV3FZL	17 Jun	**Closed**	**180**	**178**	**₹1,172.92**
FBA15LY78X7Y	18 Jun	Cancelled	0	0	—

Two units, 1.1% of the shipment, were never located. The two cancelled shipments cost you nothing — confirmed against your transaction export, which shows a second Inbound Transportation Fee row for ₹0.00 and no row at all for 18 June. So the entire ₹1,172.92 belongs to one 180-unit shipment.

Reimbursement is at your sourcing cost, not the ₹333 sale price. This is a small claim — but filing it is how you learn the process before it matters on a 500-unit shipment.

VERIFIED **The claim window for most types is now 60 days from the event date.** Multiple Amazon Seller Central announcements and 2026 sources confirm this consistently:

- **Inbound shipment shortages:** no sooner than 15 days, no later than **60 days** from the shipment reconciliation (closing) date
- **Warehouse lost/damaged: 60 days** from the event. Amazon now auto-reimburses many of these, but not all — still check monthly.
- **Customer returns:** between **45–105 days** after the customer refund or replacement date (per a January 2025 Seller Central update — earlier sources said 60–120 days; the window has tightened)

Sources: Amazon Seller Central — Reimbursement Automation & Eligibility Window, Amazon Seller Central — Updated Eligibility Window (Jan 2025).

CHECK LIVE These windows are for the global Amazon marketplace. **Amazon India may use the same or different timelines.** Verify the current window in your own Seller Central Help pages before relying on any specific number. The earlier "18 months" figure is outdated — multiple sources confirm it no longer applies for manual claims. **Because the shortest credible window is 60 days, treat any shortage as urgent.** A shipment closed at the end of July is inside 60 days only until roughly the end of September.

How to file: Inventory -> Manage FBA Shipments -> open the shipment -> Reconcile. If the tab offers no reconciliation, open a case against the shipment ID. Amazon will ask for proof that you actually sent the units, so keep these from every shipment: the **packing list** showing the unit count, the **carrier bill of lading or**

consignment note, the **supplier invoice** covering the stock, and **photographs of the sealed cartons with their labels**. Without the paperwork the claim fails, and the burden of proof is entirely yours.

21 · Advertising (PPC)

Formulas are in Chapter 12. This chapter is about actually running a campaign.

21.1 The three ad types

Format	What it does	When to use it
Sponsored Products	Ads for a single product in search results and on product pages	**Start here.** This is the only one you need at first.
Sponsored Brands	Banner ads with your logo and several products	Needs Brand Registry. Later.
Sponsored Display	Follows shoppers who viewed but did not buy	Once you have enough traffic to retarget

21.2 How to structure your first campaign

1. **Start with Automatic targeting** for 1–2 weeks. Let Amazon find which search terms convert. You do not know yet, and guessing wastes money.
2. **Pull the Search Term Report.** This shows the actual words customers typed.
3. **Move the winners into a Manual campaign** using exact match, so you control the bid on terms you know work.
4. **Add the losers as Negative Keywords** in the automatic campaign to stop paying for them.
5. **Run both campaigns together.** Automatic keeps discovering; Manual controls bids on proven winners.

21.3 Match types

Type	Behaviour
Broad	Widest reach, least precise. Good for discovery, bad for tight budgets.
Phrase	Matches searches containing your phrase in order. Middle ground.
Exact	Only the precise keyword or very close variants. Most control — use for proven converters.

21.4 Budgeting against your margin

> **The one rule that keeps advertising from eating your business**
>
> **Your target ACOS must sit below your margin after all Chapter 8 fees.** If your net margin is 20% and your ACOS is 25%, you are paying ₹1.25 to earn ₹1.00. A great click-through rate does not fix that — it makes it worse, faster.

Watch TACOS over months, not ACOS over days. A campaign that is working shows organic sales rising and TACOS trending down over 2–3 months. If TACOS stays flat, your ads are renting sales rather than building a product.

CHECK LIVE Amazon's ad interface, bid strategies and placement settings change often. Look at Seller Central -> Advertising -> Campaign Manager for the current layout rather than expecting any book to match the screen.

22 · Building a Brand

Turning one product into something defensible. Right now, a Generic listing is not defensible — anyone can sell against it.

Step	What it involves	Needs Brand Registry?
Trademark (TM-A)	File Form TM-A on the IP India portal	No — this comes first
Brand Registry	Enrol using your trademark	—
Logo and packaging	One consistent look across all your products	No
Insert cards	A small card in the parcel — thank-you note, care instructions, or a QR code	No
A+ Content	Rich images and comparison charts on your listing	Yes
Brand Store	A free multi-page mini-site inside Amazon	Yes
Amazon Vine	Gives products to trusted reviewers for honest reviews — the cheapest legitimate way off zero reviews	Yes
Social media	Not required to sell, but builds trust off-platform	No

22.1 The right order for a one-product seller

1. **File TM-A now.** It is cheap and unlocks everything downstream. Do not wait until you have three products.
2. **Design one logo and packaging treatment before your next order**, so it can be reused instead of redesigned per product.
3. **Add an insert card to your current rope packaging.** Near-zero cost, and your cheapest lever for both reviews and repeat visibility.
4. **Hold off on Brand Store, A+ Content and heavy social spend** until Brand Registry is actually active. Building them earlier just means rebuilding them.

What an insert card may not say

Asking for an *honest* review is fine. VERIFIED Three things are not, and each risks your account:

- **Offering anything in exchange** — no discount, no gift, no refund, no free product.
- **Asking specifically for a positive or 5-star review.** Amazon prohibits this *even when no incentive is offered.* The word “positive” is itself the violation.
- **Asking unhappy customers to contact you instead of leaving a negative review.** This one catches well-meaning sellers constantly. It looks like good service; Amazon treats it as review manipulation.

“If you have a moment, we'd appreciate an honest review” is acceptable. Anything conditional on the rating, or that tries to divert a bad rating, is not. Amazon's guidance is explicit that repeat violations can lead to account deactivation — and if you discover inserts already in FBA stock that break these rules, you are expected to remove that inventory.

Safest use of an insert card: care instructions, how to use the product, and your customer-service contact for genuine problems. Those add value and break no rules.

23 · Worked Case Studies

Three price points. Referral percentages are real. Product cost, packaging and weight are illustrative — swap in your own. **Read the warning on closing fees before trusting cases 2 and 3.**

> **Closing fees above ₹500 are included here**
>
> VERIFIED Many guides claim no closing fee applies above ₹500. It does — **₹27** for ₹501–1,000 and **₹52** above ₹1,000 on FBA. Both figures are included below. Leaving them out overstates profit on every higher-priced product.

Case 1 — a ₹300 kitchen storage container (FBA)

Line item	Amount	Confidence
Selling price	₹300	—
Referral fee — “Containers, Boxes, Bottles and Kitchen Storage”, under ₹1,000	₹0	VERIFIED 0% band
Closing fee — Group A, ₹0–300	₹20	VERIFIED rate card
Weight handling — 300 g, Regional, Standard STEP	**₹39**	VERIFIED rate
Pick & pack — standard, under 1 kg	₹17	VERIFIED Amazon's page
GST at 18% on (₹20 + ₹39 + ₹17 = ₹76)	~₹14	Calculated
Product cost	₹110	Illustrative
Packaging	₹8	Illustrative
Net profit	**~₹92**	~31% margin

Note: the ₹17 pick & pack fee is easy to leave out of this kind of calculation. It applies to every FBA unit sold, so it is included here.

> **This case was wrong in an earlier edition**
>
> It showed weight handling as ₹39 but calculated the GST and the total using ₹30, producing a net profit of ₹103 and a 34% margin. The correct figures with ₹39 throughout are **₹92 and about 31%**. Worth flagging as a habit rather than a one-off: when you update a fee in your own margin sheet, re-check every row that depends on it. GST is charged on the *sum* of the Amazon fees, so any fee change moves the GST line too.

Case 2 — a ₹1,200 charging cable (FBA)

Line item	Amount	Confidence
Selling price	₹1,200	—
Referral fee — “Cables and Adapters – Electronics, PC and Wireless”, 20% above ₹1,000	₹240	VERIFIED (Appendix A)
Closing fee — above ₹1,000	**₹52**	VERIFIED

Line item	Amount	Confidence
Weight handling — 150 g, National, Standard STEP	**₹65**	VERIFIED rate
Pick & pack	₹17	VERIFIED Amazon's page
GST at 18% on (₹240 + ₹52 + ₹65 + ₹17)	~₹67	Calculated
Product cost	₹350	Illustrative
Packaging	₹15	Illustrative
Net profit	**~₹394**	~33% margin

What this case teaches: above ₹1,000, the **referral fee becomes the dominant cost** — ₹240 here, more than five times the delivery fee. At low prices the flat fees dominate; at high prices the percentage does. That flip changes which products are worth selling.

Case 3 — a ₹5,000 side table (FBA, Heavy & Bulky)

Line item	Amount	Confidence
Selling price	₹5,000	—
Referral fee — "Furniture – Other products", 15.5% (₹1,000–15,000)	₹775	VERIFIED (Appendix A)
Closing fee — above ₹1,000	**₹52**	VERIFIED
Weight handling — Heavy & Bulky, National, first 12 kg, Standard STEP	**₹300**	VERIFIED rate
Pick & pack — Heavy & Bulky, per unit	₹26	VERIFIED Amazon's page
GST at 18% on (₹775 + ₹52 + ₹300 + ₹26)	~₹208	Calculated
Product cost	₹2,200	Illustrative
Packaging and crating	₹150	Illustrative
Net profit	**~₹1,289**	~26% margin

What this case teaches: furniture crosses the Heavy & Bulky threshold, which changes *both* the delivery and pick & pack formulas. Always check the size tier before assuming standard rates — especially above about ₹3,000, where furniture and appliances live.

24 · Risks Nobody Warns You About

Everything before this chapter is procedure. This chapter is about what actually decides whether a seller survives year one.

24.1 Cash on Delivery and failed deliveries (RTO)

RTO means Return to Origin — the parcel goes out, the customer refuses it or is unreachable, and it comes back. It is the most India-specific risk in this book.

Measured on your own July orders, not borrowed from a blog

An earlier edition quoted the figures that circulate everywhere — COD being 60–65% of Indian e-commerce orders, 25–30% of them failing, versus under 3% for prepaid — and flagged that the source chain was blog-to-blog. **Your own account settles it.**

Payment type	Units sold	Refused	Refusal rate	What it tells you
Cash on Delivery	15	3	**20.0%**	One in five COD orders came back
Prepaid	27	2	7.4%	Far better, but not the “under 3%” often quoted
All orders	42	5	**11.9%**	Your real RTO rate

VERIFIED From your FBA customer returns report for July 2026 cross-referenced against the payment type on each order. **COD is 2.7 times more likely to be refused than prepaid** — the direction the blogs claim is right, and now you have your own number instead of theirs.

Two corrections to the received wisdom, in your case. COD was **36% of your units**, not 60–65% — UPI adoption really has moved. And your **prepaid** refusal rate of 7.4% is more than double the “under 3%” figure, so do not assume prepaid orders are safe.

What refusals actually cost you, and it is not the product

VERIFIED **Five of your six July returns came back SELLABLE** — Amazon restocked them and you can sell them again. So a refused delivery does *not* cost you the wire. What it costs is the fulfilment you already paid for and never get back: **weight handling ₹85 plus pick & pack ₹17 = ₹102 a refused unit** (Chapter 20.2).

Five refusals × ₹102 = **₹510 lost in July**, or about **₹14 spread across every unit you sold**. That is the number to carry in your margin sheet — not a full write-off.

The sixth return was the only genuine complaint: QUALITY_UNACCEPTABLE, returned CUSTOMER_DAMAGED. Amazon charged ₹82.60 on the refund and then credited an **₹83.25 FBA inventory reimbursement** four days later, so that one cost you almost nothing. **One quality complaint in 42 units is not a product problem.** Whatever is wrong with this business, the rope is not it.

A refused delivery is not held against your account — but you still pay for it

The natural worry is that a refused parcel counts as your failure. It does not, and your own dashboard proves it. VERIFIED Despite six returns in July, your STEP dashboard reads **Seller Controllable Return Rate 0.00%, marked "Reached"**. Amazon sorts return reasons into seller-controllable and not; UNDELIVERABLE_REFUSED sits in the second group, because you cannot make a customer answer the door. Your Order Defect Rate is 0%, cancellation 0%, late dispatch 0%, Account Health Rating 200.

The money is a different story. You still lose the ₹85 weight handling and ₹17 pick & pack, and Amazon does not refund them. Its reasoning is that the work was genuinely done: the unit was picked, packed and driven to the customer. So **the metric is fair and the money is not** — that asymmetry is the real cost of COD in India, and it is why COD-heavy categories have to be priced differently.

CHECK LIVE One thing to keep half an eye on. Some sellers report that the *raw* return rate — the figure behind the "Frequently Returned Item" badge on a listing — can include undeliverables even though the seller-controllable metric excludes them. Your account health is unaffected either way, but if that badge ever appears on your listing, this is the mechanism behind it.

What this means for you as an FBA seller

- **Good news:** Amazon handles the courier and the cash collection. You are not chasing addresses or reconciling cash.
- **Bad news:** a refused COD order is still a lost sale, and the unit needs re-inspection before it can be sold again.

The habit this should change

When you forecast revenue or plan a reorder, use **confirmed delivered** numbers from your reports — not "orders placed". Orders-placed overstates real demand. Ordering stock against that inflated figure is one of the most common and most expensive first-year mistakes.

24.2 Scams aimed at sellers

- **Refund abuse.** A buyer arranges a partial refund while keeping the product — by returning an empty box, swapping a tracking ID, or claiming the item was lost. **Photograph and video every outbound parcel** so you have evidence if a return does not match what you sent.
- **"Guaranteed ranking" and review-selling agencies.** Anyone offering to put you on page 1 or supply a batch of 5-star reviews is selling an Amazon policy violation. The realistic outcome is suspension, not growth. Real ranking comes from Chapter 21 and genuine reviews.
- **Supplier fraud.** Never wire 100% advance to a new, unverified supplier — see 18.3.

If you are defrauded: National Cyber Crime Helpline **1930**, or cybercrime.gov.in

24.3 What year one actually looks like

Phase	Normal	Warning sign
Month 1–2	Break-even or a small loss while you learn fulfilment, fix listing problems and collect first reviews	Zero sales after 4+ weeks with steady ad spend — revisit the product and listing, do not just wait
Month 3–4	First real profit signal, if margin and demand were validated properly	Margin still negative after fees — the product may simply not be viable. No amount of advertising fixes bad unit economics.

Phase	Normal	Warning sign
Month 6+	Reinvestment decisions: more products, Brand Registry, or scaling ads	Scaling ad spend on a product with no organic pull — this amplifies a loser faster

24.4 The most common avoidable mistakes

- **Over-ordering on an unproven product** because the MOQ discount looked good. Test small. With the aged-stock surcharge now starting at 181 days (8.6), dead stock costs more than it used to.
- **Competing purely on price** against established listings — a race you lose to sellers with better supplier terms and Buy Box history.
- **Spreading across too many products** before any one is profitable. Depth before breadth for the first few months.
- **Ignoring Account Health** until it becomes a suspension. Check weekly.
- **Treating the first bad review as a crisis** instead of as information. Read it for a genuine product or listing fix.
- **Trusting a static document over Fee Preview.** Including this one.

24.5 Festive season planning

India's big sale events drive a disproportionate share of annual volume, Home & Kitchen included. The principle that matters more than any specific date: **place inventory orders 6–8 weeks before a major sale event, not during it.** Supplier lead times and Amazon's inbound processing both slow down when everyone rushes at once.

CHECK LIVE Exact event dates move every year. Check Seller Central -> Growth -> Deals, or Announcements, 2–3 months ahead.

25 · Growth Roadmap

Phase	When	Focus
1	Month 1–2	Stabilise your first product — reviews, reliable fulfilment, account health. Fix the TCS figure in your records. Confirm your fee category.
2	Month 2–4	Add 2–3 products in the same open category. File TM-A if you have not.
3	Month 5–8	Apply for Brand Registry once you have a trademark and 3+ differentiated products.
4	Month 8+	Consider one adjacent gated category. Reinvest profit before scaling ad spend.

File the trademark early

Full trademark registration takes a long time, but you do not need to wait for it to start using the name and building the brand. UNCONFIRMED Brand Registry reportedly accepts a pending TM-A application number — confirm this in the enrolment flow. Either way, filing in month 1 costs little and removes a bottleneck later.

Appendix A · Referral Fee Table, by Category

Automotive, Car & Accessories VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Automotive - Helmets & Riding Gloves	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8.5% above ₹1,000
Automotive - Tyres & Rims	~~0% up to ₹1,000 · 3% above ₹1,000~~ (Until June 9,2026 — expired) **0% up to ₹1,000 · 7% above ₹1,000** (From June 10,2026 — in force now)
Automotive Vehicles - 2-Wheelers, 4-Wheelers and Electric Vehicles	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5% ₹1,000–50,000 · 2% above ₹50,000
Automotive – Car and Bike parts, Brakes, Styling and body fittings, Transmission, Engine parts, Exhaust systems, Interior fitting, Suspension and Wipers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 16% above ₹1,000
Automotive – Cleaning kits (Sponges, Brush, Duster, Cloths and liquids), Car interior & exterior care (Waxes, polish, Shampoo and other), Car and Bike Lighting and Paints	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13% above ₹1,000
Automotive Accessories (Floor Mats, Seat/Car/Bike Covers) and Riding Gear (Face Covers and Gloves)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 14% above ₹1,000
Vehicle Tools and Appliances	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8.5% above ₹1,000
Oils, Lubricants	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11.5% above ₹1,000
Automotive – Batteries and air fresheners	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8.5% above ₹1,000
Car Electronics Devices	0% up to ₹300 · 7.5% ₹300–500 · 9.5% ₹500–1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000
Car Cradles, Lens Kits & Tablet Cases	0% up to ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 28.5% above ₹1,000
Car Electronics Accessories	0% up to ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 15% above ₹1,000
Automotive - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 16% above ₹1,000

Baby, Toys & Education VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Toys - Drones	0% up to ₹1,000 · 30% above ₹1,000
Toys - Party Supplies, Balloons, Banners, Masks, Confetti, Birthday Celebration	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Toys - Games and Puzzles, Boards Games, Adult Games and Building Sets	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Toys - Infant and Pre-school Toys (Electronic and Non-Electronic)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11.5% above ₹1,000
Toys - Outdoor, Activity and Sports Toys	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10.5% above ₹1,000
Toys - Plush Toys, Action Figures and Dolls	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10.5% above ₹1,000
Toys - Remote and Non-Remote Controlled Vehicles and Vehicle Sets	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Toys - STEM, Art and Craft, Learning and Development Toys	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11.5% above ₹1,000
Baby Hardlines - Swings, Bouncers and Rockers, Carriers, Walkers, Baby Safety - Guards and Locks, Baby Room Décor, Baby Furniture, Baby Car Seats and Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6.5% above ₹1,000
Baby Strollers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 9% above ₹1,000

Category	Referral fee
Baby and Kids-Furniture and Home Décor	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8.5% above ₹1,000
Baby-Walker	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5% above ₹1,000
Baby - Diapers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 9.5% above ₹1,000
Toys - Other Products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11.5% above ₹1,000
Baby - Other Products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% above ₹1,000
Breast pumps	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% above ₹1,000
Diaper bags	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% above ₹1,000

Books, Music, Movies & Video Games VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Books	0% up to ₹250 · 2% ₹250–500 · 4% ₹500–1,000 · 13.5% above ₹1,000
School Textbook Bundles	2% up to ₹250 · 3% ₹250–1,000 · 4% ₹1,000–1,500 · 4.5% above ₹1,500
Video Games - Consoles	7% up to ₹500 · 5% ₹500–1,000 · 9% above ₹1,000
Video Games - Accessories	0% up to ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 13.5% above ₹1,000
Video Games - Online Game Services	0% up to ₹1,000 · 2% ₹1,000–2,000 · 3% above ₹2,000
Movies	6.5% up to ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 6.5% above ₹1,000
Music	6.5% up to ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 6.5% above ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - DJ & VJ Equipment, | Recording and Computer, | Cables & Leads, | PA & Stage	6% up to ₹300 · 4.5% ₹300–500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 11% above ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - Microphones	9.5% up to ₹300 · 0% ₹300–1,000 · 11.5% above ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - Keyboards	8% up to ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - Guitars	10% up to ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 10% above ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11% above ₹1,000
Video Games - Other products	0% up to ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000

Industrial, Medical, Scientific & Office VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Masks	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
3D Printers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000
Business and Industrial Supplies - Scientific Supplies	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11.5% ₹1,000–15,000 · 7% above ₹15,000
Business & Industrial Supplies - Commercial, Food Handling Equipment and Health Supplies	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5.5% above ₹1,000
Business and Industrial Supplies - Electrical Testing, Dimensional Measurement, Thermal Printers, Barcode Scanners	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6% above ₹1,000
Power & Hand Tools and Water Dispensers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10% above ₹1,000
Stethoscopes	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10.5% above ₹1,000
Packing materials	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5% above ₹1,000
Office products - Office supplies	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13% above ₹1,000
Office products - Electronic Devices	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11.5% above ₹1,000

Category	Referral fee
Office products - Arts and Crafts	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5% above ₹1,000
Office products - Writing Instruments	0% up to ₹1,000 · 14% above ₹1,000
Office Furniture - Study Table, Office and Gaming Chairs	16.5% up to ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 15.5% ₹1,000–15,000 · 11% above ₹15,000
Office - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11.5% above ₹1,000
Business & Industrial Supplies - Other Products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% ₹1,000–15,000 · 5% above ₹15,000

Clothing, Fashion, Jewellery, Luggage & Shoes VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Apparel - Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 19% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Sweat Shirts and Jackets	18% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Shorts	0% up to ₹1,000 · 24% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Baby	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Ethnic wear	0% up to ₹1,000 · 16.5% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Other innerwear	0% up to ₹1,000 · 18.5% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Sleepwear	0% up to ₹1,000 · 19% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Sarees and Dress Materials	0% up to ₹1,000 · 15% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Men's T-shirts (except Polos, Tank tops and full sleeve tops)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 23% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Women’s Innerwear and Lingerie	0% up to ₹1,000 · 18% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Dress	0% up to ₹1,000 · 19% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Shirts	0% up to ₹1,000 · 21% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Socks and Stockings	0% up to ₹1,000 · 19% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Thermals	0% up to ₹1,000 · 19% above ₹1,000
Pants - Trousers, Jeans, Trackpants and Leggings	0% up to ₹1,000 · 19% above ₹1,000
Backpacks, Laptop Sleeves and Bags	0% up to ₹1,000 · 14.5% above ₹1,000
Eyewear - Sunglasses, Frames and zero power eye glasses	0% up to ₹1,000 · 18.5% above ₹1,000
Fashion Jewellery	0% up to ₹1,000 · 22.5% above ₹1,000
Fine Jewellery - Gold Coins	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6% above ₹1,000
Fine Jewellery - studded	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13% above ₹1,000
Fine Jewellery - unstudded and solitaire	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5% above ₹1,000
Silver Jewellery	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13% above ₹1,000
Silver Coins & Bars	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6% above ₹1,000
Handbags	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000
Luggage - Suitcase & Trolleys	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5.5% above ₹1,000
Luggage - Travel Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000
Flip Flops, Fashion Sandals and Slippers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 15% above ₹1,000
Kids shoes	0% up to ₹1,000 · 16% above ₹1,000
Shoes	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Wallets	0% up to ₹1,000 · 14% above ₹1,000

Category	Referral fee
Watches	0% up to ₹1,000 · 15% above ₹1,000
Luggage - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Apparel - Other Products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 19% above ₹1,000

Electronics, Cameras, Mobile & PC VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Camera Lenses	7% up to ₹1,000 · 10% above ₹1,000
Camera and Camcorder	5% up to ₹1,000 · 7% ₹1000–19,000 · 9% ₹19,000–49000 · 7% above ₹49000
Camera Accessories	0% up to ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 13.5% above ₹1,000
Cases, Covers and Skins, and Screen Guards	0% up to ₹1,000 · 25% above ₹1,000
Accessories - Electronics, PC and Wireless	0% up to ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 17% above ₹1,000
Electronic Devices (except TV, Camera & Camcorder, Camera Lenses and Accessories, GPS Devices, Speakers)	9% up to ₹1,000 · 11% above ₹1,000
GPS Devices	13.5% up to ₹300 · 12.5% ₹300–500 · 13.5% above ₹500
Hard Disks	9.5% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Headsets, Headphones and Earphones	0% up to ₹1,000 · 18% above ₹1,000
Keyboards and Mouse	0% up to ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 17% above ₹1,000
Laptop and Camera Battery	14% up to ₹300 · 12.5% ₹300–500 · 14% ₹500–1,000 · 15.5% above ₹1,000
Monitors	6.5% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Tablets (including Graphic Tablets)	0% up to ₹300 · 6% ₹300–12,000 · 10% above ₹12,000
Scanners and Printers	9% up to ₹1,000 · 10.5% above ₹1,000
Memory Cards	16% up to ₹500 · 5% ₹500–1,000 · 16% above ₹1,000
Speakers	11% up to ₹500 · 11.5% ₹500–1000 · 14% above ₹1000
Power Banks and Chargers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 20.5% above ₹1,000
Smart Watches and Accessories	0% up to ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 17% above ₹1,000
PC Components - RAM and Motherboards	0% up to ₹300 · 5.5% above ₹300
Entertainment Collectibles	13% up to ₹300 · 17% above ₹300
Software products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% ₹1,000–2,000 · 9.5% above ₹2,000
Cables and Adapters - Electronics, PC and Wireless	0% up to ₹1,000 · 20% above ₹1,000

Grocery, Food & Pet Supplies VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Grocery - Herbs and Spices	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Grocery - Dried fruits and nuts	0% up to ₹1,000 · 9% above ₹1,000
Grocery - Hampers and gifting	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11.5% above ₹1,000
Grocery & Gourmet - Oils	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5% above ₹1,000
Grocery and Gourmet - Beverages	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10% above ₹1,000
Pet Foods	0% up to ₹300 · 6.5% ₹300–1,000 · 9.5% above ₹1,000

Category	Referral fee
Pet - Aquatics Supplies	0% up to ₹1,000 · 14% above ₹1,000
Pet Accessories including Apparel, Collar, Leash and Harness	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Pet comforters including Bed, Feeder, Cages, Carriers, Crates, Kennels and Doors	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Pet Essentials including Health Care, Grooming Aids, Shower and Bath Supplies, Supplements and Vitamins, Tick and Flea Control, Dental Care	0% up to ₹1,000 · 14% above ₹1,000
Grocery and Gourmet - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 9% above ₹1,000
Pet - Other Products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000

Health, Beauty & Personal Care VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Personal Care Appliances - Weighing Scales and Fat Analyzers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13.5% above ₹1,000
Beauty - Fragrance	0% up to ₹500 · 14% ₹500–1,000 · 10% above ₹1,000
Beauty - Haircare, Bath and Shower	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Beauty - Makeup	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7% above ₹1,000
Luxury Beauty	0% up to ₹500 · 9% ₹500–1,000 · 10% above ₹1,000
Face Wash	0% up to ₹500 · 9% ₹500–1,000 · 9.5% above ₹1,000
Moisturizer cream	0% up to ₹500 · 9% ₹500–1,000 · 9.5% above ₹1,000
Sunscreen	0% up to ₹500 · 9% ₹500–1,000 · 9.5% above ₹1,000
Facial steamers	0% up to ₹500 · 7% above ₹500
Personal Care Appliances - Grooming and Styling	0% up to ₹1,000 · 9.5% above ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Massagers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 14.5% above ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Glucometer and Glucometer Strips	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5.5% above ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Thermometers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10.5% above ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Blood Pressure Monitors	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% above ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Pain Relief Devices (Electric Heating Pads, Electric Hot Water Bags, EMS, Tens)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% above ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Tooth brush, Oral Irrigators and Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% above ₹1,000
Health and Household - Sports Nutrition and Meal Replacement Shakes	0% up to ₹300 · 9% ₹300–500 · 9.5% above ₹500
Health and Household - Medical Equipment, Sexual Wellness, Adult Incontinence, Elderly Care	0% up to ₹1,000 · 2% above ₹1,000
Health and Household - Ayurvedic, Homeopathic and Alternate Medicine products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7% above ₹1,000
Health and Household - Household Cleaning, Laundry, Air Fresheners, Personal Hygiene (Hand Wash)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Feminine Hygiene and Care	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000

Category	Referral fee
Health and Household - Vitamins & Mineral Health Supplements	0% up to ₹300 · 9% ₹300–500 · 10.5% ₹500–1,000 · 11% above ₹1,000
Body Support - Wearables and Soft Aids	0% up to ₹1,000 · 2% above ₹1,000
OTC Medicine	12% up to ₹500 · 15% above ₹500
Beauty - Other Products	0% up to ₹500 · 9% above ₹500
Health and Household - Other Products	0% up to ₹300 · 11.5% above ₹300
Personal Care Appliances - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% above ₹1,000
Health and Household – Regulated Healthcare: Menstrual Cups, Contact Lenses, Diagnostic Kits, Pain Relief	0% up to ₹1,000 · 2% above ₹1,000

Home, Décor, Home Improvement, Furniture, Garden VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Bean Bags & Inflatables	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Rugs and Doormats	0% up to ₹1,000 · 9% above ₹1,000
Mattresses	25.5% up to ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 16% ₹1,000–20,000 · 13.5% above ₹20,000
Clocks	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10% above ₹1,000
Wall Art	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13.5% above ₹1,000
Home Fragrance and Candles	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Home furnishing (Excluding curtain and curtain accessories)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11% above ₹1,000
Home improvement - Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13.5% above ₹1,000
Tiles & Flooring Accessories	0% up to ₹300 · 8% above ₹300
Wires (Electrical Wires/cables for house wiring, adhoc usage)	0% up to ₹300 · 10% above ₹300
Home Storage (Excluding Kitchen Containers, Boxes, Bottles, and Kitchen Storage)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 15% above ₹1,000
Home Improvement - | Wallpapers and Wallpaper Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6.5% above ₹1,000
Home Decor Products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 17% above ₹1,000
Wall Paints and Tools	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6% above ₹1,000
Home - Waste & Recycling	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Craft materials	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5% above ₹1,000
Water Purifier and Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6.5% ₹1,000–5,000 · 7.5% above ₹5,000
Water Heaters and Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% ₹1,000–5,000 · 9% above ₹5,000
Home improvement - Kitchen & Bath (Fittings, accessories), Cleaning Supplies, Electricals, Hardware, Building Materials	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000
Sanitaryware - Toilets, Bathtubs, Basins/Sinks, Bath Mirrors & Vanities, and Shower Enclosures/partitions	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% ₹1,000–10,000 · 6% above ₹10,000
Home Safety and Security Systems	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6% above ₹1,000
Inverter and Batteries	0% up to ₹1,000 · 4.5% above ₹1,000
Cleaning and Home Appliances	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% ₹1,000–5,000 · 8.5% above ₹5,000

Category	Referral fee
Ladders	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Indoor Lighting – Wall, ceiling fixture lights, lamp bases, lamp shades and Smart Lighting	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Doors and Windows (wooden, metal, PVC/UPVC Doors & Windows)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6% ₹1,000–5,000 · 2% above ₹5,000
LED Bulbs and Battens	0% up to ₹1,000 · 14% above ₹1,000
Cushion Covers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10% above ₹1,000
Curtains and Curtain Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 16.5% above ₹1,000
Slipcovers and Kitchen Linens	0% up to ₹1,000 · 15.5% above ₹1,000
Safes and Lockers with Locking Mechanism	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden - Solar Panels	0% up to ₹1,000 · 2% above ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden - Leaf blower and Water pump	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6.5% above ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden- Chemical Pest Control, Bird control, Plant protection, Foggers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 9% above ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden - Solar Devices (Panels, Inverters, Charge controller, Battery, Lights, Solar gadgets)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8% above ₹1,000
Lawn and Garden - Plants, Seeds, Bulbs and Gardening Tools	0% up to ₹1,000 · 11% above ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden - Outdoor equipments (Saws, Lawn Mowers, Cultivator, Tiller, String Trimmers, Water Pumps, Generators, Barbeque Grills, Greenhouses)	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6.5% above ₹1,000
Furniture - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 15.5% ₹1,000–15,000 · 11% above ₹15,000
Lawn and Garden - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 10% ₹1,000–15,000 · 5% above ₹15,000
Home - other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 18% above ₹1,000
Home improvement - other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13.5% above ₹1,000
Indoor Lighting - Others	0% up to ₹1,000 · 16% above ₹1,000
Large Furniture - Sofa, Beds, Wardrobes, Recliners, Living & Dining room chairs and tables	0% up to ₹1,000 · 15.5% ₹1,000–15,000 · 11% above ₹15,000
Netting Cover	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5% above ₹1,000
Shelfs, Cabinets, Racks & Item Stands	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13% above ₹1,000

Kitchen & Appliances VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Kitchen - Glassware & Ceramicware	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Kitchen - Gas Stoves & Pressure Cookers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6% ₹1,000–1,500 · 10% above ₹1,500
Containers, Boxes, Bottles, and Kitchen Storage	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12% above ₹1,000
Cookware, Tableware & Dinnerware	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Kitchen Tools & Supplies - Choppers, Knives, Bakeware & Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000
Major Appliances Accessories	0% up to ₹1,000 · 16% above ₹1,000
Small Appliances	0% up to ₹1,000 · 4.5% ₹1,000–5,000 · 8% above ₹5,000

Category	Referral fee
Fans and Robotic Vacuums	~~0% up to ₹1,000 · 4.5% ₹1,000–5,000 · 8% above ₹5,000~~ (Until June 9,2026 — expired) **0% up to ₹1,000 · 7% ₹1,000–5,000 · 8% above ₹5,000** (From June 10,2026 — in force now)
Kitchen - Other Products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12.5% above ₹1,000

Sports & Gym VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Bicycles	0% up to ₹1,000 · 6% above ₹1,000
Gym Equipments	0% up to ₹1,000 · 12% ₹1,000–35,000 · 10% above ₹35,000
Sports - Footwear	0% up to ₹1,000 · 16% above ₹1,000
Sports - Cricket and Badminton Equipments, Tennis, Table Tennis, Squash, Football, Volleyball, Basketball, Throwball and Swimming	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8.5% above ₹1,000
Sports - Cricket Bats, Badminton Racquets, Tennis Racquets, Pickleball Paddles, Squash Racquets and TT Tables	0% up to ₹1,000 · 7.5% above ₹1,000
Sports Collectibles	0% up to ₹300 · 17% above ₹300
Sports - Other products	0% up to ₹1,000 · 13% above ₹1,000
Gym Weights	0% up to ₹1,000 · 5.5% above ₹1,000

Other categories VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Deodrants	0% up to ₹500 · 6.5% ₹500–1,000 · 7% above ₹1,000
Bedsheets, Blankets and covers	0% up to ₹1,000 · 8.5% above ₹1,000
Coin Collectibles	0% up to ₹300 · 15% above ₹300
Warranty Services	10% up to ₹300 · 29% ₹300–500 · 30% above ₹500

Appendix B · Closing Fee Groups

Below ₹500 your closing fee depends on which list your fee category sits in — and the two price bands have **separate lists**. From ₹501 upward the lists stop mattering: every category pays the same.

How to use this appendix

Find your fee category in the table below and read across. One row gives you both price bands. You do not need to know which group you are in — that is what the table is for.

VERIFIED All **465 category assignments** across **251 distinct categories** were read from Amazon's live fee page on **4 August 2026**, and the rates from Amazon's own closing-fee rate cards, stamped effective 16 March 2026.

The rates

Price band	List	Closing fee	Categories
₹0–300	Group #	**₹26**	153 categories
	Group A	**₹20**	59 categories
	Group B	**₹13**	20 categories
₹301–500	Group ##	**₹22**	146 categories
	Group C	**₹18**	55 categories
	Group D	**₹14**	32 categories
₹501–1,000 — all categories		**₹27**	every category
Above ₹1,000		**₹52**	every category except the 4 listed at the end, which pay ₹72

Why both columns exist

It is tempting to assume the ₹301–500 list is just the ₹0–300 list at a different price. **It is not.** Amazon's own example proves it: *Apparel - Shorts* is in Group A (₹20) below ₹300, but at ₹450 it is billed under Group D at **₹14** — not the ₹18 a Group A to C pairing would predict.

16 categories behave this way. They are marked ***** in the table below, and listed with the size of the error at the end of this appendix.

Closing fee by category, both price bands VERIFIED

***** marks a category whose ₹301–500 fee does not follow the obvious pairing. A dash means Amazon does not list that category in that band — often because it spells the name differently there, so check the other spelling before assuming the fee does not apply.

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	
3D Printer	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Accessories - Electronics, PC and Wireless	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Apparel - Baby	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Apparel - Dress	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	
Apparel - Ethnic Wear	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Apparel - Men's T-shirts (except Tank tops and full sleeve tops)	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Apparel - Other products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Apparel - Sarees and Dress Materials	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Apparel - Shirts	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Apparel - Shorts	₹20 (A)	**₹14** (D)	*
Apparel - Socks & Stockings	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Apparel - Sweat Shirts and Jackets	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Apparel - Thermals	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Apparel Accessories	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Apparel Other Innerwear	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Apparel – Women's Innerwear and Lingerie	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Automotive - Batteries and Air fresheners	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Automotive - Car and Bike parts, Brakes, Styling and body fittings, Transmission, Engine parts, Exhaust systems, Interior fitting, Suspension and Wipers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Automotive - Cleaning kits (Sponges, Brush, Duster, Cloths and liquids), Car interior & exterior care (Waxes, polish, Shampoo and other), Car and Bike Lighting and Paints	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Automotive - Helmets and Riding Gloves	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Automotive - Oils, Lubricants	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Automotive - Other Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Automotive - Tyres and Rims	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Automotive Accessories	—	₹18 (C)	
Automotive Accessories - Floor Mats, Seat, Car and Bike Covers	₹20 (A)	—	
Automotive Vehicles - 2-Wheelers, 4-Wheelers and Electric Vehicle	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Baby & kids-Furniture and home decor	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Baby - Diapers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Baby - Other Products	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Baby Hardlines - Swings, Bouncers and Rockers, Carriers, Walkers Baby Safety - Guards & Locks Baby Room Decor Baby Furniture Baby Car Seats & Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Baby Strollers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Baby-Walker	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Backpacks	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Bean bags & inflatables	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Beauty - Fragrance	—	₹18 (C)	
Beauty - Haircare, Bath & Shower	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Beauty - Make-up	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Beauty - Other Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Bedsheets, Blankets and Covers	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	
Bicycles	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Body Support - Wearables & Soft Aids	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Books	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Breast pumps	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Business & Industrial Supplies - Commercial, Food Handling Equipment, and Health Supplies	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Business & Industrial Supplies - Electrical Testing, Dimensional Measurement, Thermal Printers, Barcode Scanners	—	₹18 (C)	
Business & Industrial Supplies - Electrical Testing, Dimensional Measurement,Thermal Printers, Barcode Scanners	₹20 (A)	—	
Business & Industrial Supplies - Other Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Business & Scientific Supplies	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Cables and Adapters	—	₹14 (D)	
Cables and Adapters – Electronics, Computers and Wireless	₹13 (B)	—	
Camera & Camcorder	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Camera Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Camera Lenses	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Car Cradles, Lens Kits and Tablet Cases	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Car Electronics Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Car Electronics Devices	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Cases, Covers, Skins & Screen Guards	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Chimneys	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Cleaning and Home Appliances	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Clocks	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Coins Collectibles	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Craft Materials	₹20 (A)	**₹14** (D)	*
Curtains and Curtain Accessories	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Cushion Covers	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Deodorants	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Desktops	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Diaper bags	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Doors and Windows (wooden, metal, PVC/UPVC Doors & Windows)	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Electronic Devices (Excluding TV, Camera & Camcorder, Camera Lenses & Accessories, GPS Devices, Speakers)	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Eyewear - Sunglasses, Frames and Zero Power Eye Glasses	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Face Wash	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Facial Steamers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Fans and Robotic Vacuums	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Fashion Jewellery	₹13 (B)	—	
Fashion Jewelry	—	₹14 (D)	
Feminine Hygiene and Care	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	
Fine Gold Coins	—	₹22 (##)	
Fine Jewellery - Gold Coins	₹13 (B)	—	
Fine Jewellery - Studded	₹13 (B)	—	
Fine Jewellery - Unstudded and Solitaire	₹13 (B)	—	
Fine Jewelry - Solitaire	—	₹14 (D)	
Fine Silver Coins	—	₹22 (##)	
Fine Studded Jewelry	—	₹14 (D)	
Fine Un-studded Jewelry	—	₹14 (D)	
Flipflops	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Fragrance	₹20 (A)	—	
Gas Stoves and Pressure Cookers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Glassware and Ceramicware	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
GPS Devices	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Grocery & Gourmet - Oils	₹13 (B)	**₹22** (##)	*
Grocery & Gourmet - Other Products	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Grocery - Dried fruits and nuts	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Grocery - Herbs and Spices	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Grocery and Gourmet - Beverages	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Grocery and Gourmet - Hampers and gifting	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Grooming and Styling	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Guitars	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Gym Equipment	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Gym Weights	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Handbags	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Hard Disks	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Headphones	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Health and Household - Ayurvedic, Homeopathic and Alternate Medicine products	—	₹14 (D)	
Health and Household - ayurvedic, homeopathic and alternate medicine products	₹13 (B)	—	
Health and Household - Household Cleaning, Laundry, Air Fresheners, Personal Hygiene (Handwash)	₹13 (B)	—	
Health and Household - Household Cleaning, Laundry, Air Fresheners, Personal Hygiene (Handwash, Feminine Hygiene, Oral Care)	—	₹14 (D)	
Health and Household - Medical Equipment, Sexual Wellness, Adult Incontinence, Elderly Care	—	₹18 (C)	
Health and Household - Other Products	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Health and Household - Sports Nutrition and meal replacement shakes	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Health and Household – Regulated Healthcare Menstrual Cups, Contact Lenses, Diagnostic Kits, Pain Relief	₹26 (#)	—	
Health and Household – Regulated Healthcare: Menstrual Cups, Contact Lenses, Diagnostic Kits, Pain Relief	—	₹22 (##)	

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	
Home - Other Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Home - Waste and Recycling	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Home Decor Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Home Entertainment Others	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Home Fragrance and Candles	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Home furnishing (Excluding Curtain and Curtain Accessories)	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Home improvement - Other Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Home improvement - Wallpapers & Wallpaper Accessories	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Home Improvement Accessories	₹20 (A)	**₹14** (D)	*
Home Safety & Security Systems	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Home Storage (Excluding Kitchen Containers, Boxes, Bottles, and Kitchen Storage)	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Indoor Lighting - Other products	—	₹18 (C)	
Indoor Lighting - Wall, ceiling fixture lights, lamp bases, lamp shades and Smart Lighting	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Inverter and Batteries	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Keyboards	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Keyboards & Mouses	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Kid Shoes	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Kitchen & Bath (Fittings, accessories), Cleaning Supplies, Electricals, Hardware, Building Materials	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Kitchen - Containers and Storage	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Kitchen - Cookware, Tableware & Dinnerware	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Kitchen - Other Products	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Kitchen - Tools, Supplies & Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Ladders	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Landline Phones	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Laptop and Camera Battery	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Laptop Sleeves and Bags	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Laptops	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Large Appliances - Refrigerators	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Large Furniture - Sofa, Beds, Wardrobes, Recliners, Living & Dining room chairs and tables	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Lawn & Garden - Leaf blower and Water pump	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Lawn & Garden - Other Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Lawn & Garden - Solar Panels	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Lawn and Garden - Chemical Pest Control, Mosquito Nets, Bird Control, Plant Protection, Foggers	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Lawn and Garden - Outdoor equipment, mowers and power tools	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Lawn and Garden - Plants, Seeds, Bulbs, and Gardening Tools	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	
Lawn and Garden - Solar Devices, Inverters, Charge Controller, Battery, Lights, Solar Gadgets	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
LED Bulbs and Battens	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Luggage - Other Products	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Luxury Beauty	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Major appliance accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Major Appliances - Other Products	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Masks	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Mattresses	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Medical Equipment, Sexual Wellness, Adult Incontinence, Elderly Care	₹20 (A)	—	
Memory Cards	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Mobile Phones	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Modems & Networking Devices	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Moisturizer cream	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Monitors	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Movies	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Music	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Musical Instruments - DJ & VJ Equipment, Recording and Computer, Cables & Leads, PA & Stage	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Musical Instruments - Microphones	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Musical Instruments - Other Products	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
NETTING COVER	₹26 (#)	—	
Netting Cover	—	₹22 (##)	
Office - Electronic Devices	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Office - Other Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Office Furniture - study table, office and Gaming chairs	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Office Products - Arts and Crafts	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Office Products - Office Supplies	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Office Products - Writing Instruments	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
OTC Medicine	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Other - Furniture	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Other Indoor Lighting	₹20 (A)	—	
Packing Materials	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Pants - Trousers, Jeans, Trackpants & leggings	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
PC Components - RAM & Motherboards	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Pen Drives	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Personal Care Appliances - Blood Pressure Monitors	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Massagers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Pain Relief Devices (Electric Heating Pads, Electric Hot Water Bags, EMS, Tens)	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Tooth brush, Oral Irrigators & Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Personal Care Appliances - Glucometer and Glucometer Strips	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Personal Care Appliances - Other Products	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Personal Care Appliances - Thermometers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Personal Care Appliances - Weighing Scales and Fat Analyzers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Pet - Aquatics Supplies	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Pet - Other Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Pet Accessories including Apparel, Collar, Leash & Harness	₹26 (#)	—	
Pet Accessories including Apparel, Collar, Leash &Harness	—	₹22 (##)	
Pet comforters including Bed, Feeder, Cages, Carriers, Crates, Kennels & Doors	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Pet essentials including Health Care, Grooming Aids, Shower & Bath Supplies, Supplements & Vitamins, Tick & Flea Control, Dental Care	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Pet Food	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Power Banks & Chargers	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	*
Power, Hand Tool and Water Dispenser	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Prescription Medicines	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Projectors, Home Theatre Systems, Binoculars and Telescopes	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Rugs and Doormats	₹20 (A)	**₹14** (D)	*
Safes and Lockers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Sanitaryware - Toilets, Bathtubs, Basins/Sinks, Bath Mirrors & Vanities, and Shower Enclosures/partitions	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Scanners and Printers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
School Textbook Bundles	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Shelfs, Cabinets, Racks & Item Stands	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Shoes	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Silver Coins and Bars	₹13 (B)	—	
Silver Jewellery	₹13 (B)	—	
Silver Jewelry	—	₹14 (D)	
Sleepwear	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Slipcovers and Kitchen Linens	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Small Appliances	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Smart Watches and Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Software Products	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Speakers	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Sports - Cricket and Badminton Equipment, Tennis, Table Tennis, Squash, Football, Volleyball, Basketball, Throwball, Swimming	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Sports - Cricket Bats, Badminton Racquets, Tennis Racquets, Pickleball Paddles, Squash Racquets and TT Tables	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Sports - Footwear	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Sports - Other Products	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Sports Collectibles	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	
Stethoscope	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Suitcase & Trolleys	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Sunscreen	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Tablets	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Televisions	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Tiles & Flooring Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Toys - Drones	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Toys - Games & Puzzles, Boards Games, Adult Games and Construction Toys	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Toys - Infant and Pre-school Toys (Electronic and Non-Electronic)	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Toys - Other Products	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Toys - Outdoor, Activity and Sports Toys	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Toys - Party Supplies, Balloons, Banners, Masks, Confetti, Birthday Celebration	₹13 (B)	—	
Toys - Party Supplies, Balloons, Banners, Masks, Confetti, Birthday celebration	—	₹22 (##)	
Toys - Plush Toys, Action Figures and Dolls	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Toys - Remote and Non-Remote-Controlled Vehicles & Vehicle Sets	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Toys - STEM, Art and Craft, learning and development Toys	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Travel Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Vehicle Tools and Appliances	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Video Games - Online game services	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Video Games - Other Products	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Video Games Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Video Games Consoles	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Vitamins & Mineral Health Supplements	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Wall Art	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Wall Paints and Tools	₹20 (A)	₹18 (C)	
Wallets	₹13 (B)	₹14 (D)	
Warranty	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Watches	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Water Heaters and Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Water Purifier and Accessories	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	
Wires (Electrical Wires/cables for house wiring, ad hoc usage)	₹26 (#)	₹22 (##)	

Above ₹1,000 — the ₹72 exception VERIFIED

Above ₹1,000 every category pays **₹52**, except these **4**, which pay **₹72**. Amazon publishes this only as an asterisk reading “select fee categories”; these are the categories it means.

Category	Above ₹1,000
Chimneys	**₹72**
Refrigerators	**₹72**

Category	Above ₹1,000
Major Appliances – Other Products	**₹72**
Home Entertainment – Other products	**₹72**

The * categories, and what assuming would cost you VERIFIED

Fee category	₹0–300	₹301–500	Pairing would say	Error
Apparel - Ethnic Wear	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Bedsheets, Blankets and Covers	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Car Cradles, Lens Kits and Tablet Cases	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Clocks	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Cushion Covers	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Health and Household - Other Products	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Health and Household - Sports Nutrition and meal replacement shakes	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Home furnishing (Excluding Curtain and Curtain Accessories)	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Personal Care Appliances - Other Products	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Pet Food	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Power Banks & Chargers	₹26 (#)	**₹14** (D)	₹22 (##)	-₹8
Apparel - Shorts	₹20 (A)	**₹14** (D)	₹18 (C)	-₹4
Craft Materials	₹20 (A)	**₹14** (D)	₹18 (C)	-₹4
Home Improvement Accessories	₹20 (A)	**₹14** (D)	₹18 (C)	-₹4
Rugs and Doormats	₹20 (A)	**₹14** (D)	₹18 (C)	-₹4
Grocery & Gourmet - Oils	₹13 (B)	**₹22** (##)	₹14 (D)	+₹8

What this means for your ₹333 rope wire

VERIFIED At ₹333 you are in the **₹301–500** band, and your Fee Preview confirms a closing fee of **₹18** — Group C, matching *Home - Other Products* and *Home improvement - Other Products* in the table above.

Two ways that changes. Billed as “Wires (Electrical...)” it is **Group ## — ₹22** plus a 10% referral fee above ₹300. Billed as **Home Improvement Accessories** it is **Group D — ₹14**, one of the * rows. None of the four ₹72 categories apply to you, so above ₹1,000 you would pay ₹52.

Appendix C · Amazon Terms Glossary

Roughly in the order a new seller meets them.

Term	What it means
ASIN	Amazon Standard Identification Number — the unique ID Amazon gives every product listing.
SKU	Stock Keeping Unit — *your* internal code for a product, which you map to an ASIN.
GTIN / UPC / EAN	Global product IDs issued by GS1. Needed for most new listings unless you get an exemption (19.1).
FNSKU	Amazon's own barcode for tracking FBA stock. Separate from GTIN.
Buy Box	The default “Add to Cart” offer when several sellers list the same product. FBA and good account health improve your odds. Losing it usually means losing most of the sales.
Brand Registry	Amazon's trademark-based protection programme. Unlocks A+ Content, Sponsored Brands, Brand Store, Vine, and protection against listing hijackers.
A+ Content	Enhanced listing content — extra images, comparison charts, brand story. Needs Brand Registry.
Brand Store	A free multi-page mini-site inside Amazon, for Brand Registered sellers.
Amazon Vine	Gives free products to trusted reviewers in exchange for honest reviews. The legitimate way to seed first reviews. Needs Brand Registry.
Sponsored Products / Brands / Display	Amazon's three ad formats — see Chapter 21.
Coupons / Lightning Deals / Subscribe & Save	Promotional tools. Each has its own eligibility rules and its own small fee.
IPI	Inventory Performance Index — a score measuring how well you manage FBA stock. A low score triggers storage limits.
AHR	Account Health Rating — a score for policy compliance and performance, built from your defect, cancellation, late shipment and tracking rates.
ODR	Order Defect Rate — share of orders with a negative review, A-to-Z claim or chargeback. **Watch this one closely.**
VTR	Valid Tracking Rate — share of shipments with valid, on-time tracking.
VOC	Voice of the Customer — a dashboard flagging listings with quality problems before they become policy violations.
RDR / NCX	Metrics for negative customer experiences tied to returns. A high rate can suppress a listing even without a formal violation.
SAFE-T	The claim process for recovering money when Amazon's own fulfilment causes a loss (20.4).
Restock Limits	Caps on how much stock you may send to FBA at once, tied to your IPI and sell-through.

Exact thresholds are deliberately not printed here

You will see specific numbers quoted: IPI below 400 triggers limits, ODR must stay under 1%, VTR above 95%, new sellers start at AHR 200. CHECK LIVE **Amazon changes these thresholds periodically** — the IPI cutoff in particular has moved more than once. Rather than print numbers that may already be stale, check **Seller Central -> Performance -> Account Health**, which shows your live targets.

Appendix D · Where to Look Things Up, and a Scorecard

Some data goes stale so fast that printing it would be irresponsible. Here is where to find it live instead.

What you need	Where to get it
HSN code for a product	CBIC's official HSN search, or your GST portal's lookup — cbic-gst.gov.in
Current GST rate for a category	CBIC rate finder — cbic-gst.gov.in. Rates are revised by the GST Council periodically.
Your exact fees for one product	**Revenue Calculator** and **Fee Preview** in Seller Central. Beats every table in this book.
Seasonal demand for your category	Google Trends for your product terms, cross-checked against the Indian festival calendar. A generic calendar is not specific enough to be useful.
Suppliers	IndiaMART / TradeIndia / Udaan search, filtered by category. A static supplier list goes stale the moment one stops replying.
Brand Registry requirements	Seller Central's own enrolment flow — it tells you what is missing for *your* application in real time.
Account health thresholds	Seller Central -> Performance -> Account Health

Product decision scorecard

Score each candidate 1 to 5 on every row, then compare totals. Maximum 40.

Factor	Score 1–5	Where to check
Demand — steady, not a spike	____	Chapter 15
Competition — is there room?	____	Chapter 15
Margin after *every* fee	____	Chapters 8 & 11
Compliance simplicity — fewer regulators scores higher	____	Chapters 16 & 17
Weight and size — lighter scores higher	____	Chapters 8.4 & 19
Capital needed vs what you have	____	Chapter 18
Return-rate risk for this category	____	Chapter 20
Fit with your existing catalogue and brand	____	Chapters 4 & 22
Total	**____ / 40**	

How to read your score

Below about 24, pass — however exciting the sales numbers look. A product that is cheap to buy but expensive to comply with, or high-margin but high-return, usually is not worth the operational load it adds. You only have so much attention, and your first profitable product deserves most of it.

Appendix E · Launch Checklist

Print one copy per product. If every box is ticked, you have touched every chapter that matters for a launch.

- Product passed the decision scorecard (Appendix D)
- Gating checked (Chapter 13)
- BIS / FSSAI / CDSCO / WPC / Hazmat checked against Chapter 17 — **not assumed**
- EPR plastic position confirmed (17.5) — check Udyam classification against Rule 4A exemption
- Trademark conflict search done for your brand name (16.3)
- Barcode ownership checked at verify.gs1.org if the supplier gave you a GTIN
- Supplier finalised — 3+ quotes compared, MOQ agreed, freight responsibility in writing
- Sample ordered, received and physically tested
- Packaging chosen and matched to product type (19.3)
- GTIN sourced, or exemption applied for (19.1)
- FNSKU label placement checked against labelling declarations (7.2, 19.2)
- Legal Metrology declarations confirmed on the package **and** the listing page
- **Fee category confirmed via Fee Preview** — the exact name written down
- **Closing fee read from Fee Preview**, not assumed from Appendix B
- Packed unit weighed and measured, then run through the Revenue Calculator
- Margin sheet completed (Chapter 11) — confirmed at least 20% net after all fees, GST included
- Listing created — title, bullets, backend keywords
- Images uploaded — all angles, main image on pure white background
- Inventory sent to FBA — **small test batch first**
- Request-a-Review automation turned on
- Advertising started — Automatic targeting first (21.2)
- Reviews monitored weekly for the first 4–6 weeks
- Account Health checked — ODR, Late Shipment Rate, Cancellation Rate
- Monthly reconciliation done — settlement report vs GST returns, TCS at **0.5%**

Appendix F · Fulfilment Centre Codes by State

Use this to spot when Amazon has moved your stock into a state where you may need a separate GST registration (5.2).

Read this before using the table

VERIFIED Amazon opened new centres through 2025 and 2026 — Odisha (BBX1), Madhya Pradesh (IDX2, replacing SIDA), Punjab (LDX1), Delhi (DED1), West Bengal, a Heavy & Bulky site in Haryana (LDEB) on 1 April 2026, and **transshipment centres in Jharkhand (SIXR, 20 May 2026) and Chhattisgarh (SRPI, 25 May 2026)**. Transshipment centres receive stock only from other FCs — you cannot send FBA shipments to them directly, but your stock may end up there. Each announcement told sellers to add the centre to their GST registration as an Additional Place of Business *before* sending inventory. **This table will keep going out of date.** Treat it as a prompt to go and look, never as an answer.

UNCONFIRMED This list comes from an FC capabilities sheet that could not be independently verified against a published Amazon document.

Never register for GST in a state based on this table alone. Amazon opens new centres and reassigns codes. Always open the **full address** shown against the FC code in Seller Central first. Registering in the wrong state is far more expensive than registering late.

State	Cities	FC codes reported
Telangana (yours)	Hyderabad	HYD3, HYD8, SHYL, SHTX, SHYH, SHTI, XSAD, XSIP
Haryana	Gurgaon, Gurugram, Jhajjar	DEL2, DEL4, DEL5, DED4, SHDZ, HDX1, HDO3, SDEU, XNAB, **LDEB** (Heavy & Bulky, opened 1 Apr 2026)
Delhi (NCT)	New Delhi	DEX3, DEX8, **DED1** (opened 1 Aug 2025)
Punjab	Ludhiana, Rajpura	ATX1, SATF, **LDX1** (opened 1 Jul 2025)
Rajasthan	Jaipur, Bagru	JPX1, JPX2
Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow	LKO1, SLKY, SLKF
Maharashtra	Mumbai, Bhiwandi, Pune, Nagpur	BOM4, BOM5, BOM7, PNQ3, NAX1, SBOW, SPUN, SBOB, XWUA
Gujarat	Ahmedabad, Kheda	AMD2, SAME
West Bengal	Howrah, Kolkata, Serampore, Islampur	CCX1, CCX2, CCX4, SCCX, SCCE, SCUY
Assam	Guwahati, Changsari	GAX1, SGAC
Bihar	Patna	PAX, SPAB
Odisha	Bhubaneswar	BBX1
Karnataka	Bangalore, Hubballi	BLR5, BLR7, BLR8, SBLU, SBLL, BLX1, SBLB
Tamil Nadu	Chennai, Coimbatore, Karumathampatti, Tiruvallur, Krishnagiri	MAA4, SMAB, SMAH, CJB1, SCJY, SCJF, SBLI, SCJB
Andhra Pradesh	Visakhapatnam, Anakapalli	RJX1, SVTZ
Kerala	Ernakulam	COX1
Madhya Pradesh	Indore, Bhopal	IDX2, SBHF, **SIDA**

State	Cities	FC codes reported
Jharkhand	—	**SIXR** (transshipment centre, opened 20 May 2026 — does not accept FBA shipments directly)
Chhattisgarh	—	**SRPI** (transshipment centre, opened 25 May 2026 — does not accept FBA shipments directly)

Two traps in the code names

- **DEL does not mean Delhi.** DEL2, DEL4, DEL5 and the DED codes are physically in Gurgaon/Gurugram — **Haryana**. Genuine Delhi centres use **DEX**.
- **Some Bangalore-sounding codes are in Tamil Nadu.** SBLI and SCJB are at Krishnagiri, just across the Tamil Nadu border.
- **LDX1 is in Punjab, not Haryana.** VERIFIED An earlier edition of this book grouped it with Haryana and flagged it as ambiguous. Amazon's own centre-opening announcement settles it: LDX1 opened in **Punjab** on 1 July 2025. Corrected above.
- **The same prefix can mean two different states.** VERIFIED This is the trap, stated as sharply as it can be: **LDX1 is Punjab but LDEB is Haryana**, and **DED1 is Delhi but DED4 is Haryana**. Both pairs share a prefix and sit in different states. There is no rule you can learn here — the prefix genuinely carries no reliable information about the state. Open the full address, every time.

Heavy & Bulky facilities

UNCONFIRMED There are reportedly 16 dedicated Heavy & Bulky centres nationwide, with maximum unit height of 3 metres and tiered truck-loading limits (85 kg on the floor level, 44 kg stacked above). Relevant only if you move into furniture or appliances.

Appendix G · Seller Central Navigation

What each menu does. Not a screenshot guide — Amazon rearranges the interface, and a picture would be stale within months.

Menu	What lives there	Chapter
Catalogue	Add Products, Manage Inventory, Add via Upload, Listing Limitations (category approval)	13, 16, 19
Inventory	Manage FBA Inventory, Manage FBA Shipments, Restock, **Inventory Age report**	8.6, 20
Pricing	Manage Pricing, Automate Pricing, **Fee Preview per listing**	8, 11
Orders	Manage Orders, Manage Returns, SAFE-T claims	20
Advertising	Campaign Manager, A+ Content Manager, Stores, deals and coupons	21, 22
Growth	STEP programme, Global Selling, deals calendar	24.5, 25
Reports	Payments and settlement reports, Business Reports, **Inventory Ledger**, Tax Document Library	3.1, 5.4
Performance	Account Health, Voice of the Customer, Feedback	App. C
Services	Service Provider Network (paid third-party help)	—

G.1 The four tools you will actually use every month

Tool	What it is for
Fee Preview Pricing, or inside Manage Inventory	Shows the real current fees for one specific product. **This settles every disagreement with this book.**
Revenue Calculator Reports / search “calculator”	Enter a price, weight and dimensions to see the full fee breakdown, FBA vs self-ship side by side. The only way to get your weight handling fee.
Inventory Ledger Reports -> Inventory Ledger	Shows which fulfilment centres hold your stock. Your monthly GST safety check (5.2).
Transaction View Reports -> Payments	Every order, refund and fee, line by line. This is what you reconcile against your GST returns — and where you find your TCS lines.

CHECK LIVE A note on payouts: money showing as “posted” can still be held under Amazon's reserve policy. If a deposit looks small, check reserves and pending refunds in Transaction View before assuming an error.

G.2 Creating a listing

Two routes:

- **The product already exists on Amazon:** search by title, UPC/EAN or ASIN, click “Sell Yours”, then add your price, quantity, condition and fulfilment channel.
- **It does not exist:** choose “I'm adding a product not sold on Amazon” and build a full listing.

UNCONFIRMED A new listing needs: Title, Brand, Bullet points, Description, Images, backend search terms, Category and Price. **MRP is mandatory for every category except Books.** Gated categories need documents uploaded during listing — typically an invoice, the category licence, and all-sided packaging images.

G.3 Main image rules — the most common reason listings get suppressed

UNCONFIRMED Cross-checked across several 2026 seller resources. CHECK LIVE Confirm against Amazon's own image requirements page before a photoshoot.

Requirement	Specification
Background (main image only)	Pure white — RGB 255,255,255 exactly. Not off-white, not cream.
Product fills the frame	85% or more
Minimum size	1,000 px on the longest side — zoom only activates at this point
Practical working size	1,600–2,000 px+ on the longest side
Maximum	10,000 px longest side, 10 MB file size
Formats	JPEG preferred; PNG, TIFF, non-animated GIF accepted
Text, logos, badges, watermarks	**Not allowed** on the main image. Fine on images 2–9.
Props, hands, accessories	Not allowed on the main image — just the product

Use images 2 to 9 properly. They are far more flexible: lifestyle shots, infographics with feature callouts, size comparisons, close-up details. Most sellers leave these empty, which is free ground given away.

Some categories add rules on top — footwear needs a single shoe at 45 degrees facing left; apparel needs on-model or flat-lay, not a mannequin. Check your category before shooting.

Appendix H · What to Confirm in Your Own Account

The fee tables in this book are verified. Your listing has been checked. What remains are items specific to you — and one of them is urgent.

0 · Add your fulfilment centre to your GST certificate — DO THIS FIRST

Your REG-06 certificate declares **zero additional places of business**, while your stock sits in an Amazon fulfilment centre in Telangana. Amazon itself requires the FC to be declared as an Additional Place of Business.

Full instructions are in section 5.5. Check the current certificate first — if you already amended it, you are fine. Same state, so an amendment is enough; no new GSTIN, no VPOB. Also confirm GSTR-1 and GSTR-3B are filed for June and July 2026.

Already settled — no action needed

Verified from Amazon's own rate cards and your live listing: the whole closing-fee table, the weight-handling rate card, all 219 referral categories, pick & pack, storage, removal, GST treatment, the STEP benefits table, and your listing's brand field (**Generic**), price, category path and fulfilment method.

1 · Your fee category DO THIS FIRST

Where: Seller Central -> Manage Inventory -> your rope wire SKU -> Fee Preview.

What to read: the exact *fee category* name.

Why it matters more than anything else on this list. If it says a Home category you pay **₹0 referral + ₹18 closing**. If it says "Wires (Electrical Wires/cables for house wiring, ad hoc usage)" you pay **₹33.30 referral + ₹22 closing** — about **₹44 more per sale including GST**, or ₹4,400 a month at 100 orders. Same product, same price, different classification.

If it is classified as Wires and the product is genuinely a non-electrical clothesline, that is worth raising with Seller Support as a catalogue classification correction.

2 · Your packed weight

What to do: weigh and measure the finished parcel, not the rope.

Why: the 500 g line is worth ₹15 per Regional order and ₹20 per National order (8.4). Also check volumetric weight — length × breadth × height ÷ 5000 — because a large light box is billed on its size, not its weight.

3 · Your STEP level and its metrics

Where: the STEP dashboard in Seller Central.

You are on **Standard**, which is what the rates in Chapter 8 assume. Confirm it, then look at the return-rate metric — on FBA that is your main lever for reaching Advanced (8.9). Evaluation is quarterly, so acting early in a quarter is worth more than acting late.

4 · Which fulfilment centres hold your stock

Where: Reports -> Inventory Ledger -> Summary view + Fulfilment centre + Last 30 days.

Look for any centre outside Telangana. If one appears with a positive balance, that is a potential GST registration obligation in that state (5.2). **This is a monthly check**, because Amazon redistributes stock without telling you. Always confirm the state from the full address, never from the code prefix.

5 · Your account health thresholds

Where: Performance -> Account Health.

Read your live targets for Order Defect Rate, Late Shipment Rate, Cancellation Rate and IPI rather than relying on figures quoted in any guide — Amazon adjusts them.

6 · Two open questions worth professional advice

Question	Who to ask
EPR plastic packaging — does your Udyam classification qualify you for the micro/small exemption? (17.5)	Check your own Udyam certificate. If clearly micro or small, the Rule 4A exemption applies. If borderline or medium/large, confirm with CPCB or an environmental compliance consultant.
Income tax — presumptive taxation under 44AD versus normal books, advance tax dates, and which return to file (Chapter 6)	A CA. One consultation is cheap next to a penalty, and the Income Tax Act, 2025 changed some mechanics.

The half-hour that pays for itself

Items 1 to 3 take about thirty minutes together, and they convert Chapter 9 from a range into an exact figure. Item 1 alone could be worth ₹4,400 a month. Start there.

Appendix I · Official Links

What for	Where
Amazon fees — the source for this book	sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing
Seller Central — daily dashboard	sellercentral.amazon.in
Inventory Ledger (monthly GST check)	Seller Central -> Reports -> Inventory Ledger
Revenue Calculator / Fee Preview	Inside Seller Central — see Appendix G.1
Fee announcements	Seller Central -> Announcements
Restricted Products policy	Seller Central -> Help -> search “Restricted Products”
Check who else sells on your ASIN	amazon.in/gp/offer-listing/[your ASIN]
Seller University (video guides)	Seller Central -> Help
GST portal	gst.gov.in
GST rates and HSN lookup	cbic-gst.gov.in
Income tax	incometaxindia.gov.in
Trademark search and filing (TM-A)	ipindiaonline.gov.in
Barcode ownership lookup	verify.gs1.org
BIS (product certification, hallmarking)	bis.gov.in
FSSAI (food licences)	foscos.fssai.gov.in
CDSCO (medical devices)	cdsco.gov.in
WPC ETA self-declaration	saralsanchar.gov.in
EPR plastic packaging	eprplastic.cpcb.gov.in
EPR batteries	eprbattery.cpcb.gov.in
DGFT (import export code)	dgft.gov.in
Legal Metrology Act	consumeraffairs.gov.in
Cyber crime (fraud reporting)	cybercrime.gov.in · helpline **1930**

Closing Note — How to Keep This Current

This book is a map, not a live feed. It tells you what to look for and where. The number on Amazon's or a regulator's own page always beats the number here.

Before you source or reprice anything

1. **Re-read the referral and closing fee** for that exact fee category — Appendix A/B, then confirm in Fee Preview.
2. **Run the product through the Revenue Calculator** for the weight-dependent fees.
3. **Re-check gating** (Chapter 13) — it changes.
4. **Re-check the regulator list** (Chapter 17). Thresholds shift, as FSSAI showed on 1 April 2026 with no warning.
5. **Confirm your packaging still meets the labelling rules** (Chapter 7).

What to re-verify, and when

Item	How often
Which fulfilment centres hold your stock	**Monthly** — this is the one that creates legal exposure
TCS credit matching on the GST portal	Monthly
Account Health metrics	Weekly
Referral and closing fee tables	Every 6 months, or on any announcement
Compliance rules for your categories	Before every new product
Aged-inventory threshold	Before planning any bulk order

Why the labels matter more than the numbers

The most dangerous thing in a reference document is a confident label standing in for an actual check — because once something reads as “confirmed”, nobody looks at it again. That is how an out-of-date TCS rate or a phantom “no closing fee above ₹500” survives for years and gets copied between guides.

So treat the labels here as instructions, not decoration. VERIFIED means a named source was read and linked. UNCONFIRMED means it is probably right but nobody checked it for this edition. CHECK LIVE means only you can see it. UNSETTLED means credible sources disagree and you should get advice.

Three things to do this week: open Fee Preview and read your exact fee category, weigh the packed coil, and confirm your STEP level. Under an hour in total, and it turns the rest of this book into your actual numbers.

26 · Seller Central Dashboard — A Complete Walkthrough

Seller Central is the operating system for your entire Amazon business. This chapter walks through every section you need to check, what to look for, and how often. It replaces the brief navigation table in Appendix G with a working guide.

26.1 The home dashboard — what it shows and what it hides

When you log in, the home screen shows a summary panel with today's sales, units ordered, buyer messages, Buy Box percentage and account health alerts. **Do not treat this as your reporting tool.** It is a snapshot, not a ledger.

What the home dashboard is actually useful for

- **Quick pulse check:** are orders flowing today? Any spike or drop?
- **Urgent alerts:** policy violations, listing suppressions, and performance notifications appear here as red/yellow banners. Act on these immediately.
- **Announcements:** fee changes, new programmes, and deadline reminders. Amazon posts these here before they appear elsewhere.

What it cannot do: show you real profit, break down fees per unit, track advertising ROI, or reconcile your GST. For those, you need the specific reports in Chapter 29.

26.2 The nine menu sections, and what lives where

Menu	What to do here	How often
Catalogue	Add or edit listings, check listing limitations, manage product images and descriptions	Per new product
Inventory	Manage FBA stock, create shipments, check Inventory Age, set restock alerts	Weekly
Pricing	Manage prices, set automated pricing rules, view Fee Preview per SKU	Weekly
Orders	Manage orders, handle returns, file SAFE-T claims (seller-fulfilled only)	Daily
Advertising	Campaign Manager, A+ Content, Stores, deals, coupons	2–3× per week
Growth	STEP programme, Missions, Global Selling, deals calendar	Monthly
Reports	Payments, Business Reports, Inventory Ledger, Tax Library, Advertising Reports	Weekly–Monthly
Performance	Account Health, Voice of the Customer, Feedback Manager	Weekly
Settings	Account info, tax settings, bank details, shipping templates, notification preferences	Rarely

26.3 Your daily check — 5 minutes that prevent problems

#	What to check	Where	Why
1	Any red/yellow banner on the home dashboard	Home page	Catches policy violations and listing suppressions before they compound

#	What to check	Where	Why
2	Orders waiting or pending	Orders Manage Orders	Seller-fulfilled orders have dispatch deadlines. Even FBA-only sellers should check for anomalies.
3	Buyer Messages	Messages icon (top bar)	Amazon expects reply within 24 hours. Late replies count against your metrics.
4	Return requests	Orders Manage Returns	Early awareness lets you spot patterns — same complaint repeated = a product or listing fix needed
5	Ad spend for the day	Advertising Campaign Manager Today's spend	Catches runaway spend before it bleeds a full day's budget

26.4 Your weekly check — 20 minutes that build the business

#	What to check	Where	Why
1	Account Health — ODR, Late Shipment, Cancellation, Policy Violations	Performance Account Health	Problems here can suspend your account
2	Business Report — sessions, conversion rate, Buy Box %	Reports Business Reports Detail Page Sales & Traffic by Child Item	Tracks whether your listing is being shown and converting
3	Advertising — ACOS, impressions, clicks, orders, Search Term Report	Advertising Campaign Manager Reports	Detects wasted spend and identifies winning keywords
4	Inventory levels vs sales velocity	Inventory Manage FBA Inventory	Prevents stockouts (kills ranking) and overstocking (surcharges)
5	Voice of the Customer	Performance Voice of the Customer	Flags negative customer feedback before it becomes a policy issue
6	Feedback Manager — new seller ratings	Performance Feedback	Negative feedback adds to ODR if not addressed

26.5 Your monthly check — the compliance and reconciliation pass

#	What to check	Where	Why
1	Settlement Report — download and reconcile against GST returns	Reports Payments Settlement Reports	Chapter 28 explains this line by line
2	Inventory Ledger — which FCs hold your stock	Reports Inventory Ledger	Multi-state stock creates a GST obligation (Chapter 6, 5.2)
3	TCS credit check on the GST portal	gst.gov.in TCS Credit Received	Chapter 5.3 — confirms Amazon is reporting TCS against your GSTIN
4	Inventory Age — anything approaching 181 days	Inventory Manage FBA Inventory Inventory Age	Aged surcharge starts at 181 days (Chapter 8.6)
5	Reimbursement Report — check for warehouse losses	Reports Fulfilment FBA Reimbursements	Amazon will not tell you when it owes you money (Chapter 20.4)
6	Missions & STEP dashboard	Performance STEP Missions	Missions expire silently. Start them before chasing their targets.

The habit that costs most new sellers money

Checking orders and sales daily while ignoring reports and reconciliation monthly. The first feels productive; the second is where money is actually recovered. **Set a calendar reminder for the 1st of every month: download settlement report, check Inventory Ledger, verify TCS.**

26.6 Recent Seller Central changes (2026)

Change	When	What it means for you
Shipping Performance under dashboard refreshes daily	Early 2026	Status updates now show in the main dashboard instead of notifications. Check the dashboard directly.
OTDR enforcement changed	28 Feb 2026	On-Time Delivery Rate below 90% now deactivates *only affected listings*, not all your seller-fulfilled listings. Your other listings stay active.
Automated FBA reimbursement for warehouse losses	Late 2024, expanded 2025–2026	Amazon now automatically reimburses lost/damaged FBA inventory in many cases without you filing. But *not always* — still check monthly.

Change	When	What it means for you
Fee update effective 16 March 2026	16 Mar 2026	Zero referral fee expanded to ₹1,000 across 1,800+ categories. Easy Ship fees cut 20%+ for products under ₹300.

UNCONFIRMED Dashboard layout changes are ongoing and Amazon does not formally announce all of them. The menu structure above is as of mid-2026.

27 · Revenue Checking — Reading Your Numbers Correctly

The number in your bank account is not your revenue. The number on the home dashboard is not your revenue. This chapter teaches you where to find the real figure and what it actually means.

27.1 The three numbers people confuse

Number	What it actually is	Where to find it
Ordered Product Sales	Total value of units ordered — *before* cancellations, returns, fees, or anything else. This is **gross**, not revenue.	Reports Business Reports Sales Dashboard
Net Revenue	What Amazon pays into your bank after subtracting all fees, refunds, and TCS. This is what actually hits your account.	Reports Payments Settlement Reports
True Profit	Net Revenue minus your product cost, packaging, inbound freight, advertising, and storage. *This* is what you keep.	Your own spreadsheet — Amazon does not calculate this for you.

The most common mistake: using Ordered Product Sales as revenue

If 42 units are ordered at ₹333, your dashboard shows ₹13,986. But 6 come back as returns, so you are actually paid for 36. Amazon takes ₹145 in fees. TCS is withheld. Advertising was ₹15,554. **Your real position is a loss of ₹3,650 — not a gain of ₹13,986.** The dashboard gives you the headline. Only the settlement report gives you the truth.

27.2 Where to check your actual revenue — step by step

1. **Seller Central   Reports   Payments   Statement View**
2. Select the settlement period you want to review
3. Look at the **Total** at the bottom — this is what was deposited to your bank
4. Click **Download Report (V2)** for the line-by-line CSV breakdown

The settlement report breaks every order into its components: product charges, promotional charges, Amazon fees, other charges, and TCS. Each line is one event — one sale, one refund, one fee.

27.3 The Business Reports panel — what each metric means

Path: Reports   Business Reports   Detail Page Sales and Traffic by Child Item

Metric	What it tells you	Healthy range
Sessions	Number of unique visitors to your product page in 24 hours	Growing week over week
Page Views	Total views (one person viewing 3 times = 3 page views, 1 session)	—
Unit Session Percentage	Amazon's conversion rate: units ordered ÷ sessions × 100	8–15% for most categories. Below 5% suggests a listing problem.
Buy Box Percentage	Share of page views where you owned the Buy Box (Add to Cart button)	Above 90% on single-seller ASINs. Below 80% means competition.
Units Ordered	How many units were ordered (not yet delivered or confirmed)	—
Ordered Product Sales	Units Ordered × price — gross, before everything	—

The one number to track obsessively: Unit Session Percentage

This is your conversion rate. If traffic goes up but conversion stays flat, you are getting impressions but not sales — that usually means a listing problem (bad images, wrong keywords, price too high versus competitors). If both drop, you are losing visibility entirely — that is a ranking or suppression problem.

A worked example from your own product: At 42 units sold in July with roughly 5–10 sessions per day (estimated from your rank), your conversion rate is probably in the 15–25% range, which is actually strong for a new listing. The problem is not conversion — it is traffic volume, which will grow with reviews and ranking.

27.4 GST-inclusive pricing — the revenue you do not actually keep

VERIFIED Your ₹333 selling price is **GST-inclusive**. At 18% GST (HSN 72179099), the breakdown is:

```
₹333.00    what the customer pays
÷ 1.18     to extract the GST component
= ₹282.20 revenue + ₹50.80 output GST

You remit ₹50.80 to the government.
You keep ₹282.20 (before all other costs).
```

This is the number that belongs in your margin sheet as "revenue", not ₹333. Every margin calculation elsewhere in this book uses ₹333 for simplicity — but your real revenue ceiling is ₹282.20 per unit, and ₹50.80 was never yours.

27.5 Revenue Calculator vs Fee Preview — which to use when

Tool	What it tells you	When to use it
Fee Preview	Shows the exact fees Amazon will charge on your *existing* listing, at its current price and classification	To check what you are *currently* paying — settles classification questions
Revenue Calculator	Lets you input any price, weight, dimensions, and see full fee breakdown FBA vs self-ship side by side	To model *new* products or price changes before committing

Revenue Calculator shows "Fee Discounts" — what that means

If your Revenue Calculator shows a line like "Fee Discounts ₹89.00", it means a promotion is currently cancelling part or all of your fees. **That discount has an expiry date.** Never use the discounted figure for long-term margin planning. Use the full fee figure — that is what you will pay once the promotion ends. Chapter 3 explains your specific situation.

28 · Fee Checking & Reconciliation

Amazon makes mistakes. Not often, but when it does, it costs you money quietly — because nothing alerts you. This chapter teaches you to catch overcharges, verify your fee category is correct, and reconcile your settlement against what should have been charged.

28.1 The settlement report — your single source of truth

Path: Reports   Payments   Settlement Reports   Download (V2 flat file)

This CSV file contains one row per event (sale, refund, fee, adjustment) for each settlement period. The columns that matter:

Column	What it tells you
amount-type	ItemPrice, ItemFees, Promotion, Other, TCS-CGST, TCS-SGST, TCS-IGST
amount-description	The specific fee name: Commission (referral), Fixed Closing Fee, Shipping (weight handling), Pick & Pack, etc.
amount	The rupee amount — negative means Amazon took it, positive means you received it
order-id	Links the fee back to a specific order
sku	Which product was involved

28.2 How to verify you are being charged correctly — a 5-step process

1. **Pick any 5 orders from the settlement report.** Choose randomly — not just recent ones.
2. **For each order, add up all fee rows.** You should see: Commission (referral fee) + Fixed Closing Fee + Shipping fee (weight handling) + Pick Pack Fee + 18% GST on each.
3. **Compare against Fee Preview.** Open the SKU's Fee Preview and check that the rates match what was actually charged.
4. **Check the weight band.** The shipping fee should correspond to the correct weight band for your product's packed weight. If your product weighs 450g but you are being charged the 500g–1kg rate, either the packed weight crosses 500g outbound or there is an error.
5. **Verify the closing fee group.** Cross-reference against Appendix B — your fee category determines which group and rate applies.

The most common overcharge: wrong weight band

VERIFIED Your own account demonstrates this. Your product weighs 460g but Amazon bills at the 500g–1kg rate (₹85 National instead of ₹65). The reason: Amazon bills on *outbound* weight which includes its own packaging. If you are marginally over a threshold, **reducing your packaging weight by even 50g can save ₹20 per unit**.

If the weight truly should be under the threshold: weigh a finished, Amazon-packaged parcel (ask a friend to order one and weigh it on receipt). If it is under 500g and you are still being billed at the higher band, raise a case with Seller Support citing the actual weight and asking for a fee audit on the SKU.

28.3 Fee category verification — the ₹44 per unit question

Your fee category determines both your referral fee percentage and which closing-fee group you fall in. Getting this wrong can cost significant money on every sale.

1. **Open Fee Preview** for your SKU (Pricing   Manage Inventory   click the SKU   Fee Preview)

2. **Read the exact fee category name** — write it down
3. **Compare against Appendix A.** Does the referral percentage match what you expect for that category?
4. **Compare against Appendix B.** Does the closing fee match the group assigned to that category name?
5. **If there is a mismatch:** raise a case with Seller Support requesting a catalogue classification review. Include evidence that your product belongs in the correct category (product description, intended use, comparable ASINs in the right category).

Your product: already confirmed correct

VERIFIED Your Fee Preview shows referral ₹0.00 and closing ₹18.00. This confirms a Home fee category, Group C — not "Wires (Electrical)". No action needed here. But **run this check on every new product you add**, because Amazon's automated classification can put items in surprising categories.

28.4 Monthly reconciliation — the spreadsheet that catches everything

Build a simple monthly reconciliation sheet with these columns:

Column	Source
Total units sold (gross)	Settlement report or Business Reports
Total units refunded	Settlement report filter refund rows
Net units	Gross - refunded
Gross revenue	Sum of all ItemPrice rows
Total Amazon fees charged	Sum of all ItemFees rows (should be negative)
Expected fees (calculated)	Net units × per-unit fees from Fee Preview
Difference	**Actual fees - Expected fees.** If large, investigate.
TCS withheld	Sum of TCS rows. Should be ~0.5% of net taxable sales.
Net deposited	Your bank statement for that settlement period
Advertising spent	Advertising Billing monthly invoice

How often sellers find discrepancies

Industry reports suggest reconciling settlement reports uncovers 1–3% of revenue in missed reimbursements or fee overcharges per quarter. On ₹1,00,000 of sales that is ₹1,000–3,000 — not life-changing at your scale, but worth 30 minutes a month once you have the spreadsheet built.

28.5 What to do when you find an overcharge

1. **Document it:** order ID, SKU, fee type, amount charged, amount expected, and why you believe it is wrong
2. **Open a case:** Seller Central   Help   Get Support   Selling on Amazon   choose the relevant topic
3. **Be specific:** quote the order ID and the exact fee line. Vague complaints get vague responses.
4. **Follow up:** if the first response is generic, reply with additional detail. Escalation is available after 2–3 attempts.

29 · Reports — What to Pull, When, and Why

Seller Central offers 50+ report types across five categories. Most sellers download none of them. This chapter tells you which reports actually matter, what they reveal, and on what schedule to pull them.

29.1 The report categories

Category	Path	What lives here
Payments	Reports Payments	Settlement reports, transaction view, date range reports, disbursements
Business Reports	Reports Business Reports	Sales, traffic, conversion, Buy Box metrics by ASIN and by date
Inventory	Reports Fulfilment (or Inventory)	Inventory Ledger, Age, Adjustments, Reimbursements, Received, Returns
Advertising	Advertising Reports (or Bulk Operations)	Search Term, Placement, Campaign Performance, Targeting reports
Tax	Reports Tax Document Library	GST invoices, credit notes, TCS certificates

29.2 The essential reports — explained one by one

1. Settlement Report (Reports Payments)

What: Every single financial event in your account for a settlement period — sales, refunds, fees, adjustments, TCS, advertising charges, reimbursements.

When to pull: Every settlement cycle (every 7 days for Standard STEP), or monthly at minimum.

What to look for:

- Total fees vs expected (Chapter 28.4)
- Refund amounts — do they match the fees being returned?
- TCS lines — do they total approximately 0.5% of your net sales?
- Any "Other" charges you do not recognise

2. Detail Page Sales and Traffic by Child Item (Business Reports)

What: Per-ASIN daily data: sessions, page views, Buy Box %, units ordered, conversion rate.

When to pull: Weekly.

What to look for:

- Conversion rate (Unit Session %) — dropping means a listing or pricing problem
- Buy Box % — dropping means a competitor appeared or your price is too high
- Sessions — a sudden drop means a ranking or suppression issue

3. Inventory Ledger (Reports Fulfilment)

What: Shows where your stock is by fulfilment centre, with movements in and out.

When to pull: Monthly (1st of every month).

What to look for:

- Stock in any FC outside your home state — triggers GST Additional Place of Business obligation (Chapter 6, 5.2)
- Discrepancies between expected inventory and actual on-hand quantities

4. FBA Customer Returns Report (Reports   Fulfilment)

What: Every return — order ID, reason, disposition (sellable or damaged), reimbursement status.

When to pull: Monthly.

What to look for:

- Return reason patterns — same complaint repeated = a fix needed
- Disposition — SELLABLE items are restocked; DAMAGED items are not. Amazon owes you for warehouse damage.
- Reimbursement gaps — if "Damaged – Warehouse" appears with no corresponding reimbursement, file a claim

5. Inventory Adjustments Report (Reports   Fulfilment)

What: Every change Amazon made to your inventory without a sale — losses, damages, found units, disposals.

When to pull: Monthly.

What to look for:

- Entries marked "Lost – Warehouse" or "Damaged – Warehouse" with no offsetting reimbursement
- These are claims you should file — Chapter 20.4 explains the process

6. FBA Reimbursements Report (Reports   Fulfilment)

What: Every reimbursement Amazon has paid you — what it was for and how much.

When to pull: Monthly.

What to look for: Cross-reference against the Adjustments report. Any loss not matched by a reimbursement is money Amazon owes you.

7. Search Term Report (Advertising   Reports)

What: The exact words customers typed that triggered your ads, plus clicks, spend, and sales per term.

When to pull: Weekly during active campaigns.

What to look for:

- Terms with spend but zero sales — add these as negative keywords
- Terms with sales at good ACOS — move these to manual exact-match campaigns
- Irrelevant terms — shows your targeting is too broad

8. Tax Document Library (Reports   Tax Document Library)

What: GST invoices for every Amazon fee charged, credit notes for returns, and TCS certificates.

When to pull: Monthly — your CA needs these for GST filing.

What to look for:

- Total Input Tax Credit available (18% of all Amazon fees) — this offsets your GST liability
- TCS certificate — confirms what Amazon reported against your GSTIN for the month

The report schedule on one card

Report	Frequency	Day of month
Settlement Report	Every cycle	Each disbursement
Business Reports (traffic/sales)	Weekly	Monday morning
Search Term Report	Weekly	Monday (if ads active)
Inventory Ledger	Monthly	1st
Customer Returns	Monthly	5th
Inventory Adjustments	Monthly	5th
Reimbursements	Monthly	5th
Tax Document Library	Monthly	11th (before GSTR-1)

30 · Advertising Management — The Full Playbook

Chapter 21 covered the basics. This chapter is the operational guide — how to structure campaigns, manage bids, read reports, and not lose money. It is written for Amazon India in 2026, where Sponsored Products is the only ad type a single-product seller needs.

30.1 Before you start — the retail readiness checklist

Advertising sends people to your listing. If the listing cannot convert them, you are paying to send traffic to a page that does not sell. **Fix these first:**

- At least 5 images (main + lifestyle + infographic + close-up + packaging)
- Title contains your main keywords in natural reading order
- 5 bullet points — features first, benefits after each
- A+ Content if you have Brand Registry (otherwise, strong description)
- At least 10–15 reviews (or at minimum a 4+ star rating)
- Price competitive with the top 3–5 comparable listings
- In stock — never advertise a product that may stock out within days
- Buy Box owned — if you do not have the Buy Box, your ad sends customers to someone else

> **The lesson from your July spend**
>
> VERIFIED You spent ₹15,554 on advertising in July with **₹0 attributed sales**. Your listing has 1 review and a Generic brand. Advertising a listing with 1 review is like paying for a shop window with nothing in the display. **Get to 10+ reviews and fix your brand field before spending another rupee on ads.**

30.2 Campaign architecture — the three-campaign model

This is not the only way, but it is the simplest structure that actually works for a new seller:

Campaign	Targeting	Purpose	Budget
Research	Automatic	Discover which search terms customers actually use for your product. This is a data-gathering exercise, not a sales machine.	₹50–100/day
Performance	Manual – Exact Match	Bid only on keywords that have already proven they convert (graduated from Research). Maximum control.	₹100–200/day
Defense	Manual – Product Targeting	Show your ad on competitor listings. Relevant once you have reviews and competitive pricing.	₹50/day

30.3 The keyword graduation process

1. **Week 1–2:** Run only the Research (automatic) campaign at ₹50–100/day
2. **Week 3:** Pull the Search Term Report. Look for terms with 2+ orders and ACOS below your target.
3. **Move winners to Performance campaign** as exact-match keywords with a bid 10–20% above the average CPC from the Search Term Report.

4. **Add losers as Negative Exact keywords** in the Research campaign — terms with 10+ clicks and 0 orders are wasting money.
5. **Repeat every 1–2 weeks.** The Research campaign keeps finding new terms; the Performance campaign holds the proven ones.

> **Why exact match, not broad or phrase, for the Performance campaign**
>
> Broad and phrase match cast a wide net — great for discovery, terrible for cost control. The Performance campaign exists to bid precisely on terms you *know* work. Exact match does that. Leave the wide-net discovery to the Research campaign, where you expect and budget for waste.

30.4 Bid strategies — what Amazon offers and when to use each

Strategy	What it does	When to use
Dynamic bids – Down only	Amazon reduces your bid when a click is less likely to convert. Never raises it.	**Start here.** Safest for new campaigns and limited budgets.
Dynamic bids – Up and down	Amazon can raise your bid up to 100% for high-conversion placements (e.g. top of search). Also lowers for poor placements.	Only for proven, profitable campaigns where you want more volume.
Fixed bids	Amazon uses your exact bid regardless of conversion likelihood.	When you want maximum control and predictable spend — useful for testing new keywords.

30.5 Reading the Search Term Report — the skill that saves money

Path: Advertising Reports Create Report Search Term select campaign and date range.

Column	What it means
Customer Search Term	The exact words the customer typed
Impressions	How many times your ad appeared for this term

Column	What it means
Clicks	How many people clicked your ad
Spend	What you paid for those clicks
7-day Total Sales	Revenue from orders placed within 7 days of the click
7-day Total Orders	Number of orders attributed to this term
ACOS	Spend ÷ Sales × 100 — your cost of advertising per rupee earned

Decision rules for each search term:

Situation	Action
Orders 2, ACOS below target	**Graduate:** add to Performance campaign as exact match
Orders 1, ACOS near target	**Watch:** let it run another week before deciding
Clicks 10–15, Orders = 0	**Kill:** add as negative exact keyword in Research campaign
Irrelevant term (wrong product intent)	**Kill immediately:** negative exact, regardless of clicks
Very high impressions, very low clicks	Not necessarily bad — your ad was shown but people chose others. Consider if your main image or price is competitive for this term.

30.6 Setting your ACOS target — the number that keeps ads profitable

```
Target ACOS = Net margin (after all fees, before ads) ÷ Selling price × 100

Your numbers:
  Selling price:          ₹333
  Amazon fees (National): ₹141.60
  Contribution before ads: ₹191.40
    Break-even ACOS:     191.40 ÷ 333 × 100 = 57.5%

  But that ignores product cost. If product + packaging = ₹120:
  Real contribution:      ₹71.40
    Real break-even ACOS:  71.40 ÷ 333 × 100 = 21.4%

Target ACOS should be below 21% to actually make money on each ad-driven sale.
```

> **Your July: 130% TACOS. The maximum you can sustain: ~21% ACOS.**
>
> The gap between 130% and 21% is not something you close with better keywords alone. It means the campaign was fundamentally misconfigured — broad targeting, no negative keywords, and no conversion (₹0 attributed sales). **Restart from zero using the architecture above.**

30.7 Negative keywords — the most overlooked profit lever

A negative keyword tells Amazon "never show my ad for this search term." This is how you stop paying for irrelevant clicks.

Common negative keywords for a clothesline/rope wire product:

- **electrical wire** — people searching for house wiring do not want a clothesline
- **copper wire** — wrong material entirely

- **steel rope** — industrial use, not drying clothes
- **wire rope lifting** — heavy industrial application
- **charging cable** — electronics searchers landing on your listing waste your budget

Build your negative keyword list from the Search Term Report. Every term with spend and zero orders is a candidate. Add them weekly. A mature campaign has 50–200+ negative keywords — that is normal and healthy.

30.8 Budget management — daily rules

Rule	Why
Never set a daily budget higher than your daily revenue	If you earn ₹387/day (36 units × ₹333 ÷ 31 days), spending ₹500/day on ads guarantees a loss
Start small: ₹50–100/day for new campaigns	You are buying data, not sales. Spend enough to learn, not enough to bleed.
Scale only what works	Increase budget only on campaigns with ACOS below target for 7+ consecutive days
Pause, do not reduce to ₹1/day	Amazon's algorithm works poorly with micro-budgets. Either fund a campaign properly or pause it entirely.

30.9 Advertising for new product launches — the right sequence

1. **Day 1–7:** No ads. Let Amazon index your listing. Focus on getting first 2–3 orders organically from friends, social media, or existing customers.
2. **Day 8–21:** Start Research campaign (automatic). Budget ₹50/day. Gather search term data.
3. **Day 22–35:** Pull Search Term Report. Start Performance campaign with winning terms.
4. **Day 36+:** Optimise weekly. Scale what works. Kill what does not.

> **The mindset shift that prevents your July from repeating**
>
> Advertising is not a growth tool. It is a **data-collection tool that sometimes also drives sales**. The first 2–3 weeks of any campaign exist to learn what customers search for, which terms convert, and what your real cost per acquisition is. **If the data says "this does not convert", the right action is to stop — not to spend more.**

31 · Account Rules, Policies & Staying Compliant

Fees cost you money. Suspensions cost you everything. This chapter covers the performance metrics that keep your account alive, the policy violations that can kill it, and what to do if things go wrong.

31.1 Account Health Rating (AHR) — the single most important number

VERIFIED Amazon scores every seller on a scale of **0 to 1,000**. Every new seller starts at **200**. Points are earned at roughly 4 points per 200 fulfilled orders over a trailing 180-day period. Points are deducted 2–8 per policy violation. Critical violations can drop you straight to zero.

Score Range	Status	What it means
200–1,000	**Healthy**	Normal operations. No restrictions.
100–199	**At Risk**	You are close to suspension. Fix violations immediately.
Below 100	**Unhealthy / Deactivated**	Account may be suspended. Appeal required.

Your current score: 200 (Healthy). You are at the starting baseline with zero violations — which is exactly where a well-run account should be at your age.

31.2 The performance metrics Amazon watches

Metric	Target	What triggers a violation
Order Defect Rate (ODR)	< 1%	Negative feedback + A-to-Z claims + chargebacks, measured over 60 days. **The most important metric.**
Late Shipment Rate	< 4%	Seller-fulfilled orders not confirmed shipped by the expected date. FBA sellers: Amazon handles this.
Pre-Fulfilment Cancel Rate	< 2.5%	Orders you cancel before shipping. FBA sellers: nearly impossible to trigger.
Valid Tracking Rate (VTR)	> 95%	Seller-fulfilled shipments without valid tracking. FBA: handled by Amazon.
On-Time Delivery Rate (OTDR)	> 90%	Orders not delivered by the estimated date. FBA handles delivery.

Why FBA protects your Account Health

Four of the five performance metrics above (Late Shipment, Cancel Rate, VTR, OTDR) relate to **fulfilment**. Since Amazon handles all fulfilment for FBA orders, you are largely insulated from these. Your main exposure is **ODR** — which comes from customer complaints, not operational failures.

31.3 The OTDR change in February 2026

VERIFIED Effective **28 February 2026**, Amazon changed how On-Time Delivery Rate enforcement works:

- **Before:** If your OTDR fell below 90%, *all* your seller-fulfilled listings were deactivated.
- **After:** Only the *specific listings that most impact your OTDR drop* are deactivated. Your other listings remain active.
- **Exception:** If OTDR is *significantly* below 90% or you repeatedly fail, Amazon may still deactivate all seller-fulfilled listings.

For you (FBA-only): this does not apply. Amazon delivers your orders, so your OTDR is Amazon's problem. It becomes relevant only if you add an Easy Ship or Self-Ship product.

31.4 Policy violations that suspend accounts — the top five

Violation	How it happens	How to prevent it
Inauthentic product complaints	A customer or brand owner claims your product is counterfeit or not genuine	Keep supplier invoices (3+ months). Only sell products you can prove are authentic.
Intellectual property complaints	A brand owner files a trademark or copyright complaint against your listing	Never list against a brand you are not authorised to sell. Check Chapter 16.3.
Product condition complaints	Customers report items as used, damaged, or materially different from listing	Accurate listing descriptions. QC before sending to FBA.
Restricted product violations	Listing a product that requires certification you do not have (BIS, FSSAI, etc.)	Chapter 17 — run every product through the compliance checklist before listing.
Review manipulation	Offering incentives for reviews, buying reviews, asking for positive reviews specifically	Chapter 22.1 — only ask for "honest" reviews. Never offer anything in exchange.

31.5 What happens when something goes wrong — the suspension process

1. **Warning:** Amazon sends an email and a Performance Notification in Seller Central. You have a window (usually 72 hours) to respond or fix the issue.
2. **Listing suppression:** The specific product listing is hidden. Your account stays active. Fix the issue and the listing can be reinstated.
3. **Account suspension:** You cannot sell anything. Funds are held for 90 days. You must submit a Plan of Action to appeal.
4. **Account termination:** Permanent ban. Extremely rare for first-time issues; usually follows repeated suspensions or fraud.

31.6 Writing a Plan of Action (if you ever need one)

A Plan of Action has exactly three parts:

Section	What to write
Root Cause	What specifically caused the problem. Be honest. Do not blame Amazon or the customer. Own it.
Corrective Action	What you have already done to fix the immediate problem. Past tense — it should be done, not planned.
Preventive Measures	What systems you have put in place so this never happens again. Specific steps, not vague promises.

What gets Plans of Action rejected

- **Blaming the customer:** "The customer lied" is never a root cause Amazon accepts.
- **Being vague:** "We will improve our quality" means nothing. Specific actions only.
- **Not addressing the actual violation:** Read the notification carefully. Answer what they asked about, not what you want to talk about.
- **Submitting repeatedly without changing anything:** Each rejection makes the next one harder.

31.7 Listing suppression — the most common "suspension" that is not one

Far more common than account suspension is **listing suppression** — your product disappears from search while your account stays active. Common causes:

- Missing or incorrect Legal Metrology information (Chapter 7)
- Main image not meeting requirements (Appendix G.3)
- Price too far above comparable listings (Amazon suppresses to "protect customers")
- Missing required product information fields (manufacturer, country of origin)
- Product flagged as a potential safety or compliance issue

How to check: Performance   Voice of the Customer, or Manage Inventory   look for listings with a "Suppressed" status. Fix the flagged issue and request reinstatement.

32 · Tips, Hints & Advanced Growth Strategies

Everything before this chapter is structure and rules. This chapter is tactics — things that work in practice for Amazon India sellers in 2026, collected from verified sources and real account data.

32.1 Pricing strategies that protect your margin

The Automated Pricing trap

VERIFIED Your account has "Competitive Price Rule by Amazon" enabled, with min ₹333 and max ₹500. This means Amazon can move your price anywhere in that band automatically.

Why you should be careful with automated pricing

- A price change from ₹333 to ₹501 would move you from the ₹301–500 closing fee band (₹18) into the ₹501–1,000 band (₹27) — an instant ₹9 fee increase per unit.
- Conversely, if Amazon drops your price to ₹300, you move into the ₹0–300 band where closing fee groups change.
- **Your min should be set at a price where you still make money after ALL fees.** If you cannot make money at ₹333, your minimum is too low.

MRP vs selling price — the legal constraint

You cannot sell above MRP in India. Your listing shows MRP ₹499 (note: different from the ₹500 in the listing description — **verify the physical label matches**). This means your price ceiling is ₹499. With Amazon's automated rule capped at ₹500, you have a ₹166 band to work within.

32.2 Buy Box mechanics — what actually decides who gets the sale

The Buy Box is the "Add to Cart" button. On a listing with multiple sellers, only one gets it at a time. Factors that matter:

Factor	Weight	What you control
Fulfilment method	Very high	FBA wins over self-ship almost always. You are already on FBA.
Landed price (item + shipping)	High	Must be competitive. Not always lowest, but within range.
Seller metrics	Medium	Order Defect Rate, cancellation, late dispatch — keep clean.
Stock availability	Medium	Must be in stock. Stockouts lose the Buy Box instantly.
Time in business / history	Low–Medium	Longer track record helps. Time fixes this.

Right now, you likely own the Buy Box 100%

Your listing has Brand: Generic and you are the only FBA seller on this ASIN. Nobody else is competing for this Buy Box yet. **That changes the moment another seller lists against your ASIN** — which they can do because it is Generic (Chapter 4.2). Getting Brand Registry is the long-term defense.

32.3 Seasonal planning — India's sale calendar

Event	Typical timing	What to do
Great Indian Festival	Late September – October	Send stock 6–8 weeks ahead. Create deals. Increase ad budgets during the event.
Prime Day	July (varies)	Stock up in May/June. Lightning Deals if eligible.
Republic Day Sale	Late January	Good for home products. Plan in November/December.
Summer Sale	May	Home and garden do well. Order stock in March.
Diwali period	October–November	Peak for home décor, lighting, gifts. Your clothesline is less seasonal but benefits from general traffic surge.

The principle that matters more than any specific date

Place inventory orders 6–8 weeks before a major sale event, not during it. Supplier lead times and Amazon's inbound processing both slow down when everyone rushes at once. A stockout during India's biggest sale week costs far more than the extra storage fees for holding stock a few weeks early.

CHECK LIVE Exact event dates move every year. Check Seller Central Growth Deals, or Announcements, 2–3 months ahead.

32.4 Reimbursement auditing — money Amazon owes you

This is the process described in Chapter 20.4–20.5, turned into a monthly routine:

1. **Pull the Inventory Adjustments Report** for the past 60 days
2. **Filter for "Lost" and "Damaged" reasons** with "Warehouse" as the responsible party
3. **Cross-reference against the Reimbursements Report** — has Amazon already paid you?
4. **Any gap = money owed.** Since late 2024, Amazon auto-reimburses many losses. But not all. Check every month.
5. **File claims for gaps** within 60 days of the event (the current window for most claim types)

Key 2026 change: reimbursement is at sourcing cost, not retail price

VERIFIED Amazon now reimburses lost or damaged FBA inventory at your **manufacturing (sourcing) cost**, not the selling price. If your rope wire sells at ₹333 but costs ₹100 to produce, your reimbursement for a lost unit is roughly ₹100 — not ₹333.

This makes your supplier invoices essential documentation. Keep every invoice. Amazon will ask for proof of sourcing cost when processing claims. Without it, they may use a generic estimate that is lower than your actual cost.

The five claim types to check monthly:

Claim type	Filing window	Where to find evidence
Lost in warehouse	60 days from event	Inventory Adjustments "Lost – Warehouse"
Damaged by Amazon	60 days from event	Inventory Adjustments "Damaged – Warehouse"
Inbound shipment shortages	15–60 days from delivery	Manage FBA Shipments compare Expected vs Located
Customer returns not restocked	60–120 days after refund	Customer Returns report disposition "Sellable" but not back in inventory

Claim type	Filing window	Where to find evidence
Fee overcharges	90 days	Settlement report compare actual vs expected fees

32.5 Listing optimisation — the free levers

Title structure that works on Amazon India:

```
[Brand] [Product Name] [Key Feature 1] [Key Feature 2] [Material/Size] [Colour/Variant]

Example (yours):
Rope Wire for Cloth Drying & Hanging Clothes — Clothesline, Heavy Gauge, Rust Proof, 12 Gauge, No Sagging, Length 22 Metres (Black)
```

Your title is already well-structured. Key improvements for conversion:

- **Backend search terms:** Add synonyms customers might use that are not in your title — "balcony drying line", "terrace clothesline", "steel wire clothes hanger outdoor"
- **Bullet points:** Lead each with a benefit, then explain the feature. "NO SAGGING GUARANTEED — Heavy 12-gauge steel wire maintains tension across 22 metres without drooping"
- **A+ Content:** Not available without Brand Registry. File TM-A first (Chapter 22.1).

32.6 Product photography that converts — the free version

Image slot	What to show	Why it converts
Image 1 (Main)	Product on pure white background, filling 85%+ of frame	Required by Amazon. Gets you into search results.
Image 2	Product in use — hung on a balcony with clothes drying	Shows the customer what they will actually get
Image 3	Close-up of the wire gauge/material quality	Addresses "will it hold?" concern from 1-star reviews
Image 4	Comparison infographic — your wire vs thin alternatives	Differentiates from cheap competitors
Image 5	Packaging shot showing all declarations (length, MRP, address)	Builds trust, shows professionalism
Image 6	Installation ease — one person setting it up	Removes "is this hard to install?" objection
Image 7	Size/scale — the 22m length visualised against a balcony	Answers "is 22m enough for me?"

Equipment needed: A smartphone with a good camera, a white bedsheet for background, natural daylight near a window. No studio required for your first set of images.

32.7 Review building — legitimate strategies only

Reviews are the growth bottleneck for new sellers. You have 1 review. Here is how to get to 15+ without risking your account:

Method	How it works	Cost
Request a Review button	Available on every delivered order in Order Details. Sends Amazon's own template — safe, automated. Click it on every order.	Free
Insert card in packaging	A card saying "If you have a moment, we'd appreciate an honest review." Must NOT ask for positive reviews or offer anything in exchange (Chapter 22.1).	₹1–3 per card
Amazon Vine	Gives free units to trusted reviewers for honest reviews. The most powerful review-building tool. Requires Brand Registry.	₹0 enrolment fee + cost of units given away
Follow-up email via Buyer-Seller Messages	A polite message after delivery checking satisfaction and mentioning that reviews help. Must follow Amazon's template rules.	Free

What will get your account suspended

- Buying reviews from any service
- Offering discounts or free products in exchange for reviews
- Asking friends or family to review (Amazon detects same-household orders)
- Using insert cards that say "5 stars" or "positive review"
- Offering to replace the product if they remove a negative review

Amazon's review manipulation detection has become significantly more aggressive in 2025–2026. The risk is not worth it at any scale.

32.8 Inventory management — the numbers to track

Metric	Target	Why
Weeks of Cover	6–10 weeks	Under 4 weeks risks stockouts. Over 12 weeks triggers aged-stock surcharges at 181 days.
Sell-through rate	Above 3 per month	Below this, your Inventory Performance Index (IPI) drops and Amazon may cap your storage

Metric	Target	Why
Reorder point	Lead time × daily sales rate × 1.5	The 1.5x buffer covers supplier delays and Amazon inbound processing time

Your current situation: 141 units on hand, selling ~1.4 units/day = about 100 days of cover = roughly 14 weeks. That is slightly above ideal. Watch the Inventory Age dashboard — at 181 days the surcharge starts. Your stock was received in late June/early July, so the clock started then. **The 181-day line hits around late December 2026.** If units are not sold by then, remove or discount them.

32.9 Multi-product strategy — spreading risk

Your STEP dashboard shows the single biggest blocker to Advanced level: you have 1 active listing and need 5. But adding products is not just about STEP — it is about risk.

Criteria for your next 4 products:

- **Same category (Home & Kitchen):** avoids new compliance research
- **Open category, no gating:** avoids approval delays
- **Under ₹1,000:** keeps 0% referral fee
- **Under 500g packed:** stays in cheapest weight band
- **Small dimensions:** avoids volumetric weight penalty
- **Clear demand (check Best Sellers Rank):** BSR under 50,000 in Home & Kitchen suggests steady sales
- **Addressable complaints in reviews:** read 1–3 star reviews on category leaders. If you can fix what they complain about, you have a reason to exist.

The value of 5 active listings

Moving from 1 to 5 listings does three things at once:

1. **Unlocks STEP Advanced:** ₹6 off weight handling (vs ₹4 today), ₹3,540 in SPN credits
2. **Unlocks New Seller Incentive 1:** up to ₹5,000 in benefits (needs non-generic listings)
3. **Diversifies risk:** if one product gets a bad review or a competitor appears, your business does not collapse

32.10 Tools and resources worth knowing

Tool	What it does	Cost
Amazon Revenue Calculator	Models fee breakdown for any product. The only free tool you absolutely need.	Free (inside Seller Central)
Google Trends	Shows search demand over time for product keywords. Set location to India.	Free
Amazon Best Sellers page	Shows top-selling products by category. Use for product research.	Free

Tool	What it does	Cost
Helium 10 / Jungle Scout	Product research, keyword tracking, competitor analysis. India data is weaker than US, but trends are useful.	₹2,000–5,000/month
Excel / Google Sheets	Your margin calculator, reconciliation sheet, and reorder tracker. No paid tool replaces a well-built spreadsheet.	Free
Your CA / accountant	GST filing, income tax, TCS reconciliation, GSTR-1/3B. Worth more than any tool.	₹1,000–3,000/month

32.11 The 10 habits of sellers who survive year one

1. **Check Account Health weekly.** Not monthly. Not when something breaks.
2. **Download and reconcile the settlement report every cycle.** The bank balance tells you how much; only the report tells you why.
3. **Never spend more on ads than the product earns.** TACOS above 100% means the ads are destroying the business.
4. **Build the margin sheet before buying stock.** Not after. Not roughly. Every fee, every line.
5. **Respond to every customer message within 24 hours.** Even if the answer is "let me check."
6. **Start missions before chasing their targets.** Performing without subscribing earns nothing.
7. **File reimbursement claims monthly.** Amazon will not tell you when it owes you money.
8. **Photograph every outbound carton before sealing it.** Your only evidence in a shortage claim.
9. **Check Inventory Ledger for out-of-state stock monthly.** The GST consequence is real.
10. **Treat this book as a map, not a contract.** Amazon's own page — Fee Preview, Revenue Calculator, Account Health — always beats what is printed here.

Your current position — honest assessment

What is working: Account Health 200 (Healthy), ODR 0%, Service Quality 100/100, cancellation 0%, product sells organically (42 units without any attributed ad sales), fees currently exempted, and the unit economics work once advertising is fixed.

What needs fixing, in priority order:

1. **Pause advertising today** — it is costing ₹500/day with ₹0 attributed sales
2. **Get to 10+ reviews** — use Request a Review on every order + insert card
3. **Prepare for fee exemption ending** — plan pricing and margins at full fee rates
4. **File TM-A for a real brand name** — unlocks Brand Registry, Vine, A+ Content
5. **Add 4 more products** — unlocks STEP Advanced and diversifies risk
6. **Fix the GST certificate** — add FC as Additional Place of Business (Chapter 5.5)

What can wait: Brand Store, Sponsored Brands, multi-state GST (only if stock moves outside Telangana), Premium STEP (needs far higher volume), advanced advertising strategies. These are month 6+ concerns.